Labyrinthe

The current Age of primus

Races and peoples/Places

Updated to October 2019



Being a compendium of background and playable races/characters and miscellaneous rules from an ever evolving gameworld

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Introduction

As the world of Primus grows ever on, so too do the options available for you, the player. From Hollowtooth Goblins to Shadowy Draconians, it seems fitting that the game continues to expand with every Almanac. Herein lies the collection of additional races and rules introduced to the game up to the October 2018 edition, for ease of reference. Some are backgrounds for a bit of extra flavor, created through various extended lengths and campaigns throughout the decades. Others have additional rules for use within the Labyrinthe setting. And some of the rules introduced over the years, such as reincarnation, have been included here.

Please note, where entries refer to “recent” happenings, that these extracts are taken across years and years of Almanacs. What was recent then, may not be so recent now! The background here is drawn from publications from across the years, and so may be out of date!

Thank you to Martin for his efforts editing all these years, and the myriad of contributors who have added so much flavor and variety to our little corner of the fantasy universe.

Angelsea

Representatives of House Aichen recently secured the services of a number of mercenaries in order to act on behalf of the House in journeying to an island off the coast of Bildteve named Angelsea.

The Census reports of the Empire has listed Angelsea as part of the Estates of House Aichen for many years, but given its remote location and the difficult sea passage required to reach the island the land there had been devoid of leadership and mercenary contact for decades.

Amongst those travelling to Angelsea were Magistrate Locke, Bren, Fade of the Lady of Stars, Bill, Cloud, Branwen, Eliane and Sir Gareth of Mortai, Harrumph and Nuruki.

The locals here had survived these years through determined toil and labour, the influences of the supernatural were largely lost to them without the influence of the mercenary caste. Unfortunately, the two main settlements on the island had fallen into a bloody and long-running feud which had prevented the locals from prospering as they should.

The heroes were able to quickly determine the cause of this dispute, and dispatched the dark evil responsible. They also uncovered the remains of a ruined manor house together with a shrine to the old Chaos Gods. As one of the only remaining focuses of the old gods this shrine had attracted hideous creatures of old legend to the area, which were successfully purged.

On finding that the manor house had once benefited from a place spirit of its own, the group managed to re-awaken the spirit and through devoted care over a number of days they were able to instruct the spirit in the use of supernatural powers in order to enable it to defend itself from unwanted attention from outsiders.

Shrines to the churches of The Lady of the Stars and Mortai were established prior to the group handing control of the island to a Marshal in the employ of House Aichen.

More recent reports have shown that the raging storms around the island are still an issue, making travel to and from the island hazardous. The islanders have continued to work together and seem to have put their old disputes behind them. Small scale disturbances have been recorded, mainly between islanders discussing differences of opinions regarding religion, particularly those who have started to follow one or other of the churches with established shrines. A small number of locals have begun worshipping the storms claiming that they have brought them the spirit of Angelsea who can wield its power. Despite these occurrences we are pleased to record that the locals have begun receiving the full support of House Aichen, and local taxes are now being collected.

New characters from Angelsea have stats as per a normal Labyrinthian human

Barony of Greyshore

Located on the coast south of Scarlene Greyshore is a coastal barony whose primary industries are fishing & sheep farming. The worship of Tsu Ling is understandably strong here – there are several shrines & groups of monks and the current baron is known to be a paladin of the faith. There are relics of older beliefs – shrines to older, darker sea gods that had to be placated, not revered, but their worship has been long suppressed.

Orcs of the Cambrai tribe live in the hills inland – their witchdoctors are famed for powers of earth which they grant to their warriors. Sometimes they raid the barony but know to expect a forceful response from the baron if they do. Young orcs have short memories however.

Many caverns & tunnels run under the land – the main occupants are the Svart (dark) Alfar – their clans here are named after gemstones.

The Amethyst clan are mainly craftsmen & traders – often send on the surface seeking wool & leather in return for metals and worked goods.

The Ruby clan are quite militaristic and have often raided the surface world – they have only lately recovered from the losses inflicted on them by mercenaries hired by the baron – sometimes they themselves hire out as mercenary warriors.

The Emerald clan are a devious bunch – many Ruby clan raiders or Amethyst sellers of shoddy goods have been found to be Emerald alfar in the past.

Sometimes Algoids – humanoid sea creatures – come ashore to trade – they have found that the seaweed like scrapings from their skin have curative properties upon the land-dwellers – akin to bandages treated with herbs. In return they seek goods that can survive underwater – curiosities and works of art are often popular.

Within the barony are locations that act as the focus of elemental powers within the area. Established by one of the baron's ancestors, they can be commanded by him in times of trouble. Mages often seek them out to learn magics of that colour or as part of appropriate rites.

The focus of water lies within a shrine to Tsu Ling, fire at "The Inn of the Warmest Hearth" (a place famed for its appropriately spicy food), earth an ancient oak within the lands of the Cambrai orcs and air at the Pillar of Storms, high on a deserted hillside.

The Cairn of Light and Dark alternates between the two by day and night and sits atop an ancient hill fort.

People from Greyshore are totally normal labyrinthian humans, dark alfar or orcs. Anyone wanting to play an Algoid should submit a points application

Barony of Tarneth

Located to the west of Selaville, just south of the Broken Lands, high in mountainous terrain. The barony of Tarneth is most famous for a sacred lake in which the goddess Border is said once to have bathed. Legend has it that any woman who bathes there will soon be blessed with a child. Legend also has it that this is also the origin of the Starring Dead – whose gaze paralyses like that of a ghoul – it is said that two lecherous shepherds watched the goddess bathe – blinded by her beauty they fell off a cliff to their deaths. Thanatar, as the great enemy of Border, raised them as undead, the first of that kind. The secret of raising the starring dead has since been known to that cult – the body of one who died due to seeing something they should not have is an existential starting point.

The rivers around the lake flow with blessed water and green magics are particularly strong here – the baron, Lord Caeron Orborne, is a green warlock with a warlock's direct approach to problem solving. The River Warden – a samila like being – is aware of all that happens on or near the rivers and warns the baron of troubles.

Many followers of Border come here on pilgrimage – some stay at the abbey the baron supports and many locals have taken that faith. Similarly, a not insignificant number of green mages have learned their arts here. It is said that for a long time the Orborne family kept a balrog imprisoned, until a company of mercenaries uncovered how to slay it permanently. For that, and for their many other valiant deeds defending the barony from the forces of Thanatar, the baron named them the Knights of Tarneth.

Filtholme

Within the barony lies a small swampy valley where herbs grow particularly well. A small group of herbalists have gathered here and sell potions of many kinds. They are guarded by a large number of indentured servants of those who have become addicted to their potions.

The Gold Dragon Inn

A happy and most pleasant place, famed for the legendary quality of its food. The baron often arranges to meet mercenaries here.

The Leering Gargoyle Inn

A very different type of place to the Golden Dragon. A low-down dive, home to every kind of scoundrel, where inquiring questions are looked on very unkindly. The management changes on a regular basis. It is thought the baron tolerates it for keeping the troublemakers in one place

The Outhgill Clan

A hill farming clan of families, with patches of land spread throughout the barony. Generally somewhat amoral, but rarely actually evil, they are not above an odd bit of cattle raiding. They practice a form of ancestor worship within their clan. Used to have a long feud with the Kirbys, which has now been settled and the clans are firm allies.

Some years back, the sons of the Outhgill family head were hunting in the deep woods near their land. They found a pleasant grove populated by extremely pleasant dryads. After a while they returned home, thinking little of it. Some time later, there was a knocking upon the door of the family's hall. Left there in baskets, with little explanation, were several of the offspring of this union. They were however taken in and brought into the family. Given the degree of intermarriage going on within these hill clans, many of the family now have traits associated with the children of the pines. Lead by an old and semi senile man called Austell Outhgill.

The Kirby Clan

Another clan much like the Outhgills. They also farm and occasionally raid and also worship their ancestors. They used to have a long running feud with the Outhgills, now resolved. At one time they were allied with a nearby orc tribe. A particularly successful joint raid upon the steading where the Outhgills had a number of illicit stills led to a spectacular party where, with beer goggles firmly in place, a degree of intermingling took place. Once this had happened and both sides had become accustomed to the idea, there were quite a number of intermarriages between the Kirbys and their orc friends, so there are many half orcs in the clan, although the original orc clan has left the area. Their head is an old human called Ezekiel Kirby.

People from the barony of Tarneth can give up their political guild slot & be well equipped with a dose of holy water OR fill up to 3 specialist slots with handbook green glyphs if a mana user.

The Outhgill & Kirby clans ancestor worship takes the form of simple membership of independent priests (as Words from Above) – their ancestral spirits are not particularly potent.

THE UNDEAD HOUSES

Within the Highlands there are six primary 'houses' of noble knights, which are, by and large, undead. Each house has a strict hierarchy consisting of a head and then three lords or ladies immediately beneath them. Below them come a number of powerful knights, seneschals, squires, their entourage, retainers and then their rank & file. The houses are for the most part very old, certainly older than Kesselharn to which they are bound, and there are many feuds both new and long standing. Many of these stem from the times when the houses were alive, before their descent into undeath. Alliances are made and broken, sometimes swiftly, as houses ally with one another and seek to move against either each other or the surrounding lands. Ultimately all perceive the 'Empire', or at least the current ruling elite of the land as invaders, who by their oaths with Kesselharn they seek to destroy or depose. There is no known timescale to their oaths though, and this leaves plenty of room for inter-house bickering, planning, plotting and scheming.

There are also smaller minor houses, but these play a relatively small part in the ongoing power struggles and forays within the highlands and the surrounding area. That said, they may, for the discerning, be the perfect 'in' to take control and move against the bigger players. Much, as it always does, will depend on the actions of the mercenary community.

Within the highlands the six major houses are known by both colloquial or common names as well as their heraldic names and titles. Names, for the most part are either full or partially shielded from scrying, though adventurers, specifically the church of Mortai have had some success in acquiring such.

The significant houses and their ongoing involvements in the area and with the mercenary community are detailed below. Much is yet to be discovered and much more is known by a handful of individuals who happen to have ventured forth within the area. The highlands are a big place, pitted with crags and peaks, home to lost castles and dank barrows. It is a place where one can reap great rewards, but also suffer terrible losses. It is a place of timeless feuds and seething battles, both with blade and power.

HOUSE THYRLL – THE HOUSE OF WAX & THE HOUSE OF WETHERLAINE

In life the house used to have large estates throughout what is now the highlands, and in part the fens. On those estates they were famed for the keeping of bees and the manufacture of candles, honey and other waxworks, more arcane in nature. It is from this that they acquired the name the “house of wax”. They were, and still are, particular notorious for their waxwork simulacrums who were rumoured to be responsible for the deaths of several important figures amongst other houses and are said to infest the echelons of several key houses and organisations.

Historically the house has had long running feuds with the House of Ash, either over land, or ideology, or simply because that is the way things have always been. There are several known incidents where one has murdered important members of the other, and such continue to this day.

In recent times the house is known to have alliances with at least one faction of the House of Splinters, and is rumoured to have secret alliances or strings within several of the others, though such has not been confirmed. They’ve fought a long running border war with the House of Ash and in Octuar and have had several run-ins with the Church of Mortai.

To date, the most well known and infamous of the house is the woman known as “The Caged Lady”. A potent necromancer and mage of dark magics who seems able to hide and cage the names of the undead who serve her, as well as her own and those other lords of the house.

Of their rank and file, ghostly swords known as “Faceless Blades” are commonly employed, along with a range of waxwork simulacrums and more common undead but formed of bodies cast from wax as opposed to dead flesh.

Update from the end of IM1011

Little has been heard from the House of Wax other than rumours reported by members of the Frontline guild that they had successfully assaulted the forces of Cael'a'tan in the eastern borderlands, and created a waxwork simulacrum of one of his acolytes Isidro Marques. It is believed that the notorious necromancer, commonly referred to as The Caged Lady was responsible. What exactly the House intend to do with such simulacrums is as yet unclear, and their actions may yet prove to be both a blessing in disguise or, some suspect, part of some larger as yet unapparent nefarious scheme. The House always was one for the long game, particularly where subtle politics are involved.

Update from the end of IM1012

For several decades House Thyrll was considered to be a deceptive, rogue entity; an enemy of the Empire, and a set of individuals and retainers who worked solely for their own interests. It transpired as of Mai IM1012 that, though perhaps that had been the case for some years it no longer was. The House, enslaved by the tyrant Rodric Nastenrul, father of Storm & Marten, served as little more than his puppets during the Chaos Wars and after. It was only in the most recent years that the House began its first tentative steps to freedom, which culminated with the Rite of Shoravall, the death of Rodric and the slaying of the patron demon Thyrll, forged from the soul of Teras Thyrll, the head of the house, to bind and shackle them.

Since Mai, the House has been working long and hard with the Empire, and in particular House Athanyn to restore faith and trust. They also provided significant information into the Myronese magiarch Cael'a'tan and his acolytes, into who's ranks they had infiltrated. The House is a staunch advocate of peaceful solutions to problems, or at least removing the leaders of problems, rather than the innocent populous enslaved beneath them. They were strongly opposed to the Chaos Wars, the actions of Kesselharn and indeed their resultant 'resistance' was what led to several notable figures being assassinated and the house being enslaved.

Ancient fey blood & the powers of water are strong in some of its now living members, due to the bloodline of Lord Almorus Wetherlaine (one of the three early founders of Bildteve & Kesselharn, who disappeared foreseeing a grave & dark future; it was his legacy, his rite of Shoravall which eventually saved the house & a number of citizens of Bildteve). Lord Wetherlaine's daughter Elizabeth married Teras, and their daughters Rosalin & Almarissa carry the blood of the Wetherlaine line very strongly. Those so blessed are exceptionally long lived and barely age.

The House's centre of power is in Vexialla Hollow, where the ancient fey throne of Paralyne's Seat resides, though day to day dealings are conducted at Castle Thyrll, further to the south. It's notable that the Houses of Thyrll & Wetherlaine are very closely mingled in the later generations, with the line of Wetherlaine having very few members within it. They remain autonomous Houses in name only, with the reality being that the two are near enough one and the same. Tradition in the family line, and the inheritance of Wetherlaine's legacy means that those who inherit a significant proportion of the fey blood of the Wetherlaine line use the family name of Wetherlaine, and those who inherit proportionally more of the human line of Thyrll, use that name.

The most well known of the house is Almarissa Wetherlaine, often known as The Caged Lady. Once a potent necromancer and mage of dark magics who seemed able to hide and cage the names of the undead who serve her, as well as her own and those other lords of the house, it appears as of Mai IM1012 she has lost her former necromantic powers.

Others of note are Lord Teras Thyrll, an old man, from whom the patron demon Thyrll, the Faceless Blade, was formed and forged by Rodric Nastenrul during the mid IM950's, when he massacred the House and enslaved them in undeath. As of Mai 7th IM1012 the House has been returned to life and looks set to enjoy good relations with both the Church of Mortai and the Empire.

Members of House Thyrll must be Human, and may be of evil alignment only. May be any priest, wizard or scout subclass. Members gain immunity to info fxs of their primary powerbase ¼ levels. This takes 10 seconds concentration to enact, and lasts 5 mins. They may purchase immunity to info spells/miracles/fx of their

primary powerbase @50% of the normal cost. All members are automatically ostracised, and may not join guilds.

From the beginning of IM 1013

LRP Rules have changed reflecting game play and are now as follows

Existing characters can continue with the old House Thyrll stats (as above), becoming renegades who stayed loyal to the traitor Aldaren Mox (a 'plant' in the house who worked for Rodric & was responsible for many wickedness attributed to the house), or gain the new rules (below). Those existing who retain their existing stats are still ostracised. Those new, are not.

Characters may be of any alignment, and must pick a family line. Neither line can join a social guild, as most of their time is spent helping rebuild the reputation of the House.

The Line of Thyrll – as human. They gain an innate discipline ¼ levels (based on their refusal to ever be shackled & enslaved again).

The Line of Wetherlaine – as human, and of any class a human can be, but gain aquatic elf innates by level. They lose a level of base life.

House Yllren – The House of Chains

Of the six main houses, that of Chains is the only one of which it's notables are not undead. Instead the entire house and all within are cursed to live and die but never find peace or rest; doomed to die again and again and again in endless servitude. Their chains are held by an individual known as Yllren, who in history was known also as Kesselharn's Spite and who's name their house now holds. How the members of the house came to be shackled under his will and whim is currently unknown by outsiders.

In relation to the other factions, the house have little or no alliances, and neither does it have particular feuds. The souls of the already dead provide little succour to Yllren and he would not oppose the other houses of Kesselharn; the Magiocracy he so loved and bound his vindictive and spiteful life to. The other houses also in part fear that of chains. They are in no hurry to turn against Yllren and see their own souls shackled. That, and the lords of the house are rumoured to be most potent indeed. They, unlike their kin, still learn, still evolve, are not bound to the forms of undeath so rigidly defined. Their forms are transitory, brief; they live, they fight, they die, and each time they return they have learnt from before; faster, stronger, more potent. They, for want of a better word; evolve, whereas the undead knights are bound, endlessly to what they were, what they are, rather than what they will be.

All, without exception, are well known to be extremely potent swordsmen and women. Few of the lords of the house have been met in recent times, but it is known that the head of the house, one known as Lord Nydor, or The Prince in Chains, is not present in the highlands. Rumours are that he was last sited at a demonic carnival upon another world, having at least briefly escaped from some of the chains that tether him to Yllren, if not the curse that binds him. Why he is known as the Prince in Chains, nobody really knows, and even he seems to have forgotten (or at least is unwilling to speak of such). A lightning fast and exceptionally skilled swordsman, he's been known on more than one occasion to behead a man while still standing twenty or more paces away. The souls of those he kills rise up and are chained to him, adding to the weight upon his accursed soul.

Update from the end of IM1011

As described briefly under House Allockra, the Church of Mortai successfully defeated the demon Yllren, Kesselharn's Spite and freed the Swordsmen of Humakt and a number of others, from his chains. The House was then attacked and its lands taken by the forces of House Allockra, but not before the great chains that

held the City of Chains aloft collapsed, sending the suspended island and buildings crashing into the vast chasm below. Of the demons forged from the souls and memories of the Swordsmen, they are no more, though it is likely that some minions still remain.

The Swordsmen, free, were safely returned to Arvalath's Cradle where they are resting and recovering from their imprisonment of decades. Asmalev Thell, the swordsman known as Nydor, Avatar of Humakt, once freed, gave up his mantle and returned the power he wielded unto Mortai, such that the last sparks of Humakt's power would flow to his successor. In doing so he gave up his own long life, being finally gifted the freedom to rest, at least for a while, with the aid of the angel Cloud. As he departed he plunged the legendary sword Death (that which all images and shards of such are summoned from) into the Sarcophagus within the Cradle, leaving it pure and unsullied by the taint of Yllren, there to wait for his successor to draw it forth in the name of Mortai.

From the start of IM1012

Existing members of the house of chains may choose to have been freed, and swap to the new base stats for the house of swords (further below), OR to have been re-enslaved by some minor minion of Yllren (or Allockra, or another figure of their choosing), or indeed continue to serve his ideals and causes through choice, and remain as they are.

Chains (Yllren) are all Human, and may be of any alignment. They may be of any class capable of wielding a sword (all the time, rather than just via summoned weapons, etc.). Cannot use any weapon other than a single sword type, chosen at creation (c.f.Weapon Master). Their chosen weapon counts as 'Trusty and Old' while they are wielding it (no dis-benefit to loss). They are all permanently cursed (but with no stat benefit or disbenefit), which cannot be removed by any means, and are immune to beneficial blesses and curses. Cannot buy any (or benefit from any form of temporary) immunity to any form of domination effect before T11.

Requires single black line makeup over one eye.

House Corvack – The House of Splinters

House Corvack is strongly associated with the flourishing powers of nature within the highlands. Nature, that is, of a rather hostile bent; initially wild and dangerous, then corrupted through undeath by the house. It is a house that of its lord's own devising is split and fractured into several different independent splinter factions, each of which live in dark, isolated, hard to reach places, and each of which pay him homage, fealty and respect.

This strategy is both wise and potentially dangerous. It makes the house harder to entirely corrupt or win over, but more easy to conquer each smaller faction. The lord though is more worried by internal conquests than those from outside as the house in it's living history had a history of rulers being overthrown and deposed; hence the current split. Often factions would entirely break away from one another after some petty squabble became blown out of all proportion, only to stay divided, hating the other many years later after the initial disagreement has been entirely forgotten. It is these kinds of disputes along with it's association with woods and nature that gave the house it's title.

As a gathering of druidic coven they were a group of murderous traitorous bastards in life. In death they are even more so.

They're opposed to House Bamael, primarily because of it's historically wanton ritual burning of swathes of land and their blatant disregard of nature. In undeath, they still oppose Bamael, hating them because they've always hated them, but hating them just a little less than each other, and each other just a little less than outsiders.

In recent times it is rumoured that the faction under Lord Marsden, paid fealty to the House of Wax and fell under it's will and whim. Rumours also speak of Marsden's death at the hands of unknown outsiders, others

that he is alive and well, forging ever stronger pacts with the Caged Lady of Wax.

Update from the end of IM1011

A full third of the House fell with the death of Lord Marsden, around a year ago. Since then the House of Wax have been seen to control waxwork simulacrums of Marsden and effectively command those former forces of the House of Splinters in his place. In the southern highlands, Manor Kloss was attacked by the House of Ash, prior to Vanity's rebellion and the Manor was dragged into the ground by enormous vines and tree roots, crushing and killing all of the Ash forces attempting to take it. Of the Manor there is no sign, and people are unsure whether Lord Kloss has fallen, or is secure and safe within the bowels of the earth.

Splinters (Corvack) are human of non-goodly alignment. They may be pure priests, armoured priests, druids or forest guardians. Life scales are as alfar. All, may 1/day after 30 seconds prayer to the house cast a basic druidic evocation up to 3rd level, (c.f. draw on EP) or a 1st to 4th basic priestly miracle of own alignment (c.f. True Believer).

House Bamael – The House of Ash

House Bamael, of all the houses is probably the most openly aggressive. It seeks to conquer both the surrounding houses and the lands extending from there across the Empire. If the house isn't at open war with another house it's because they haven't got around to attacking them yet, or they've yet to obliterate the house whos lands provide a buffer between them.

Their ongoing feuds with the Houses of Wax and Splinters are relatively constant and until recent times were very much going in their favour. Only the alliance between Wax and part of Splinters allowed them to hold the line and retaliate. What is was left was a bloody stalemate where each sent it's rank and file against the other while simultaneously attempting subtle raids behind enemy lines in the case of Wax or ritual strike in the case of Ash. This changed significantly with the involvement of the church of Mortai.

In recent times they have lost much. Firstly, they lost the significant ritual stronghold of Arvalath's Cradle and then a month later saw one of their lords slain and his ritual chamber at Oleth's Folly destroyed, blown apart in a cataclysmic explosion. The Church of Mortai is said to have been responsible for all three such incidents, though the latter two appear to be blamed on Wax if the retaliatory strikes are anything to go by.

Aggressive and hot tempered, the most common tools of Ash are coruscating flame, and creatures made from flowing ash or the bodies of the burnt and charred dead.

Known lords of the house include the ritualist and general Lady Vanity, and the now deceased ritualist Lord Chovul.

Update from the end of IM1011

At the dawning of IM 1011, the Lady Vanity of Bamael launched several attacks, both ritual and military, against the city of Bildteve. Mercenaries succeeded in stopping these attacks and she was rumoured to have been slain by the angelic host of Purlain in and around Gothiel. It transpires that such a death was part of a planned ascension and she has risen to take the mantle "The Lady Oblivion". Several groups, notably those who travelled to Eruldine, and the Church of Mortai, have encountered her shadowy realm and those who now follow her. She, and her prophets, over the early parts of the year spread word throughout the lands of Bamael that Oblivion would free them all, that the people should put their past behind them, discard it and their worries to Oblivion and embrace a new life. The oppressors of House Bamael would fall, and the loving arms of Oblivion would free them.

In early summer IM1011 Duke Bamael was found dead by the side of a road, guards and attendants strewn around. A single precise wound pierced through his chest and branded onto his skin were the words "All is

Vanity". A letter was discovered from Vanity to the Duke stating that unfortunately his services were no longer required. As far as can be told, Vanity and her Seneschal, have all but taken over the lands of House Bamael, with a single small tract of land deep in the southern highlands their final bastion. For all intents and purposes a new house has risen where Ash has fallen; The House Oblivion.

Priests of Mortai have been seen talking to the locals within the Ash Wastes trying to convince them from following Vanity and Oblivion. They have had some success, but many still believe her to be a saviour from the iron fist of Duke Bamael and continue in their worship. The charismatic and talented orator Charlotte Oleth, once pacted and indebted to the Duke, is said to be the most active preacher and speaker for the Lady Vanity, and her closest confidante. Vanity herself, has been seen wearing a new pendant around her neck, seemingly wrought from a tiny splinter of a strange white marble.

Ash (Bamael) - Ashen Man/Woman – may be of any evil alignment only. May be warriors, red wizards or pure priests. As per human except has life as fire elf if warrior or wizard or life as ancient folk if priest. Gains fire elf innates by level. Are automatically ostracised. Must have pale grey makeup.

House Rekthenan – The House of Sand

House Rekthenan is a strange beast. On one foot it is strongly aligned with the loosely pro-Imperial Church of Night & Day, while on the other actively seeking out ways to depose the current hierarchy due to it's pacts and oaths to Kesselharn.

Of all the houses that of sand is spread most widely across the Empire and has the most diverse set of resources it can call upon. The circumstances of it's forming and the decree to which it seems closely tied are all deeply shrouded in mystery. If anyone knows outside the house itself, they are keeping staunchly silent.

The house is currently known to be mostly entrenched in a drawn-out war with a place called Scathis Vale, hidden deep within the Broken Lands. Why it is involved in such and what connection that place has to the house nobody knows. As to the highlands it is a voice of stoic unity, attempting to forge alliances between the houses and advocating they should work far more strongly together. Whether this is because their armies are tied up in their war with the Vale, or because they truly wish some form of unity, will remain a mystery.

As well as the expected selection of undead, the house is also known to call on a vast array of creatures made of black and white sand. These, for the most part, are engaged in actions throughout the Broken Lands and within Scathis Vale, though some number of the more potent creations guard their subterranean manor house within the highlands barrows.

The only well-known figure of the house is the diminutive, confident and charismatic Illivah Wyre. Of notable influence across the houses he, perhaps alone amongst the lords, is well respected and liked by almost all of them. Of those within the highlands he is one of the few to openly proclaim his heraldic title, "Shield of the Glass Lord".

Update from the end of IM1011

Little has changed within the House of Sand over the past year. Lord Illivah Wyre is still as charismatic as ever, and his creatures of sand continue to wage war with the people of distant Scathis Vale. Sources do report growing discontent between the Church of Night & Day and the House though, given the schism of the faith that divides Night & Day as followed by The House, and Night & Day as followed by the Church. Those shrines under the sway of Illivah follow tenants that worship the eternal war between night & day, light & dark and decree that such will never cease. This clearly, is not the view point of the main body of the Church.

Sand (Rekthenan) are human, and must be either lawful neutral or true neutral in alignment. They may be grey wardens, guardians of the balance or wizards. Grey wardens and guardians of the balance may not cast

or utilise neutral miracles in any way, but instead split their spirits into equal goodly/evil pools, which they may cast freely from without the need to alternate. The only church/faith can be a member of is Night & Day or Dead Heroes. In all other ways they are as published.

If Wizards, they are dual 1st colour light/dark (cannot cast/gain cold or poison spells – may only use light or dark based spells) but they may never acquire a second colour nor use any colour of magic (even by item) other than light or dark.

House Allockra – The House of Whispers

Of all the houses that of whispers is the least known and least public. It thrives on intrigue and mystery, sowing the seeds of friendship and doubt at the same time, living on the knowledge and secrets of others. It never threatens, to do such would be far too crude; rather it simply lets others know that they know, and that things would be far easier, far better, were things done their way.

Recent rumours involve them in actions against the farfolk reeds of the northern borders of the highlands regarding a strange lament of that race, written by their ancestors at the time they left for Borthek. Other than that, little is known.

Update from the end of IM1011

House Allockra remains as mysterious as ever, though in recent months we have finally seen one of their schemes come to light, and be at least partly thwarted by the Church of Mortai. In their efforts to free the Swordsmen of the House of Chains the Church learned much from a journal gained from the archaic libraries of the House of Whispers (if you can call hundreds of souls & their torn apart memories bound into ethearic books a library, that is). This journal though, written by Arvalath (of the Cradle that bears his name), was the only real book on display, and it appears that it was left so for them to find and take, for its pages could only be opened or read by those followers of Humakt or Mortai, his successor. It seems now that Allockra himself was enslaved by the demon Yllren of Chains, long ago at the whim of Kesselharn, and in freeing the Swordsmen and destroying Yllren, the Church freed Allockra also, and for the first time in many longs years permitted him to act against his most hated foes; the Swordsmen of Humakt.

Weakened after their newfound freedom, the forces of Allockra moved swiftly in an attempt to cut the swordsmen down, and end the age long battle between Iristan Allockra and Asmalev Thell (Lord Nydor, The Prince in Chains) once and for all. Thankfully due to the quick action of the Church such forces failed to slay the Swordsmen and they were taken to safety within the confines of Arvaleth's Cradle to rest and recover, their memories returning as the accursed chains upon them lifted. Allockra however succeeded in taking the lands belonging to the House of Chains, and by doing so has seemingly gained significant influence in the western highlands.

What steps Allockra will now take given his new found freedom, is hard to say, but no doubt they will be very carefully planned, and several layers deep in complexity. The full story of Iristan Allockra, Asmalev Thell and the Swordsmen, as described in Arvalath‟s Journal can be found on the wiki.

Whispers (Allockra) - Human. N or E in alignment. May be seers/mystics or armoured/pure/hermit priests. Cannot join any guilds, and have they have one less level of life than normal, but gain equivalent benefits to those of the Circle for use of neuronics/spirits.

The House of Swords - new from IM1012

The newly formed House of Swords is the name given to the group formed of the twenty-nine living swordsmen, formerly of Chains, and their new recruits and apprentices. All, now free, have pledged their lives to Mortai, and the House has quarters within Arvalath's Cradle.

Freed swordsmen have the following stats They are all Human, and may be of any goodly alignment. They may be of any class capable of wielding a sword (all the time, rather than just via summoned weapons, etc.). Cannot use any weapon other than a single sword type, chosen at creation (c.f.Weapon Master). Their chosen weapon counts as "Trusty and Old" while they are wielding it (no dis-benefit to loss).

The only church they may join is Mortai, but gain ley believer to it for free if desired and may buy an innate true believer for 60ptson table 6

They may not "suffer an undead to live" – unless on a plane of undeath. They lose half points for the day's play if there is an undead they could practically have fought that they retreat from. Does not apply to situations where fighting would be utterly pointless – such as limitless undead from a generator that cannot be removed or an undead the character has no practical ability to harm.

Requires single black line makeup over one eye.

Other Factions

There are, of course, factions other than the undead houses within the Highlands. The most notable of such are detailed here.

The Bildteve Cartographer's Survey

An organisation, of which a society of cartographers is just one of many thinly veiled covers. A covert and secretive band of people who've sworn their lives to the cause, they are identified by the circular small glass broach they wear on their chests. Some would say that they report nominally to the Inquisition, but most in the know believe that they tend to act mostly under their own authority and mandate as handed to them by a previous incumbent of the throne. The Inquisition certainly would be hasty to deny any involvement with the group, but then, they would.

There are no particular joining requirements except the willingness to swear a ritually binding oath of life service to the cause, whatever that may be; once a member, always a member; nobody leaves, except via a ditch. That said, it's meant that those who have sworn the oath have a powerful unity and bond between them, come from all different walks of life and with a wide array of different talents. There's no discrimination, no dissent and all know that everyone can be relied on and use their talents for the betterment of the group and whatever or whoever it is they work for.

Player characters may choose to join this group – this replaces their political guild and they may not be a member of any other political guild whilst so doing. They gain tell time and direction, disguise skill and immunity informational effects of their primary powerbase. If outlawed however they lose these benefits, and may never apply any form of immunity to discern outlaw.

Creduin's Fury (Afora'nir'Creduin)

Creduin's Fury are a group of mostly druids who follow the great spirit Creduin, the Summer Sun, of the far north. They pledge allegiance to him and to the High King who stands above. Nobody knows, really, who the High King is. Some claim to have seen him, some to have met him or be blessed by him (the latter is certainly true), but nothing firm or reliable. Perhaps he's merely a myth, though that seems unlikely, or perhaps he works unseen, preferring to touch the world though the great place spirits that rule beneath him – notably Creduin, and historically Anthuinn, though his power now lies with King Sigurd. Some have claimed that the High King is actually the place/realm spirit of Primus, and of the theories, though it feels a little off, is perhaps the one that makes the most sense.

This particular group of Creduin's followers have been based in the Highlands for some while, having moved down as a tribe about 30-40 years ago. They generally kept themselves to themselves, striking down the

undead that came too close, for they have no love for them, and making offerings and blessings to the Summer Sun.

In recent times however, since more of the ancient houses became active again, they've been having a tough time. With the war between Wax, Ash and Splinters, the land has been carved up and the druids find themselves very much in the middle of a fight they don't entirely have the resources to fight. Much of their old land has been taken, corrupted and invaded by the tides of undeath. So much so, in fact, that they've taken to wandering all year round, moving from camp to camp seeking rest, shelter and ways to combat the undead on at least even keel.

In recent months they have formed a tentative alliance with the Church of Mortai, or at least it's druidic and non- angelic member(s), but in late Octuar had to flee a combined attack by the houses of Wax and Splinters. The attack was believed to be in revenge for providing haven to those of Mortai when perused by the Caged Lady.

Druids, alfar, scouts with loner tendancy and rangers may choose to join or be members of Creduin's Fury. This replaces their political guild and they may never then join or be a member of a political guild. They gain sun's healing and ¼ level scorching ray as per seasonal elves. They may buy double innates (also doubling regen rate) for 80pts on table 3 and triple for 100pts on table 7.

The Farfolk

A number of reeds live and thrive in the north-western borders of the highlands in the region around the river Curno. They mostly keep themselves to themselves but trade with those that pass through and are considered good company. The most well known of the reeds are The Painted Sky, The Burning Tree and The Winter Snow, though there are at least a handful of others.

The Church of Mortai

Active only in recent months the Church of Mortai has made some significant inroads into the undead menace within the highlands, but still sees itself with much work to be done. Notable achievements include the slaying of Lord Chovul of Ash and Lord Marsden of Splinters along with the destruction of the ritual chamber at Oleth's Folly. Having claimed and purified the stronghold of Arvalath's Cradle it now forms a central point from which they can venture forth against the houses.

Notable Places of Import

Arvalath's Cradle

Arvalath's Cradle is an old ritual site of significance for the Kesselharn Magiocracy. It was a location where they performed many necromantic rites and forged their undead armies. The Cradle sits on the southern tip of the highlands as the stand currently and was until a short while ago under the control of the House of Ash.

The Cradle takes its name from the Glorianave Magiarch Arvalath Thell, a potent priest of Humakt who designed the cradle as a chamber for one vast rite of devastation against the undead legions of Kesselharn. Alas, that his plan was discovered prior to enacting any such grandiose rites and in a fierce, but always one-sided battle, he was slain within his cradle. The magiarchs of Kesselharn bound his soul to the cradle and in doing so corrupted it for their own use. It has remained thus, to the present day.

In recent months the Church of Mortai have reclaimed the cradle from the forces of Ash, freed the tortured soul of Arvalath and consecrated it as a shrine to their Lord. It now serves as a strong point of both offense and defence for those of the faith within the Highlands.

Update from the end of IM1011

The Cradle itself was greatly empowered by the return of Death, the freedom of the Swordsman and the release of the divine spark of Humakt back to Mortai. A mile radius golden haze now flows around it which is death to any of the unliving who set foot within it. Above the Cradle the ghostly image of a huge angel can be seen if one looks carefully, wings wrapped around so as to encompass the Cradle in its entirety. To the truly keen of sight, the angel appears to have a thin sword like cut over one eye.

Oleth's Folly

Site of the former House of Ash ritual chamber before it's destruction at the hands of the Church of Mortai. It takes its name from Charlotte Oleth, a mistress of the Duke of Ash who signed an oath binding her and her entire family and their descendents into eternal servitude. Why she did such is yet to be fully realised.

Castle Thyrll

The towering castle that serves as the seat of power for the House of Wax. Known to be well defended and sited upon an ancient barrow it was recently broken into by the Church of Mortai while it's notables were away at a meeting of the houses in the north and its usual residents evacuated to avoid ritual strike by the House of Ash.

Sepulchre Gully

A thin narrow gully that serves as the major pass between the lands of Ash and Wax.

Salev's Crag

A windy cleft that runs from the village of Salev's Fall in the south of the Highlands north and thence through tunnels to the foot of Arvaleth's Cradle. Recently the village of Salev's Fall and the foot of the cleft were overrun by forces led by Lady Vanity of the House of Ash.

Manor Kloss

A manor in the far south-western tip of the Highlands rumoured to have been destroyed by it's incumbent rather than let it fall into the hands of the House of Ash. Letters indicate that the house was torn apart and dragged into the depths of the earth by the roots of a great tree killing many of the invading soldiers within.

Manor Allockra

A large manor house with many secret tunnels, winding corridors and dusty libraries, said to be the seat of the House of Whispers. It is known that at least one meeting of the houses has been held there in recent months. Rumours abound as to the secrets held within it's dusty tomes.

The Barrow Blight

A region of unexplored barrows and dells in the central part of the northern highlands. Said to be exceptionally dangerous in that nobody who's ever gone to investigate has returned.

Rekthenan Manor

To the north and east sits Rekthenan Manor, the seat of the House of Sand. More fortress than manor, it sits between two steeples of rock, the bulk of it's rooms and passages deep beneath the surface.

Mittlenacht

Beneath the mountains to the north and around the Barrow Blight runs a thin strip of mittlenacht. None have investigated it fully to date.

Curno Foss

A mountain peak and boiling mountain stream said to be inhabited by packs of ghostly ghouls who lurk within other undead, ready to pray upon unwary travellers.

Briar's Cross

This Talthar Abbey is situated on the southern side of the borders between the Empire and the Baronies. Not far from Caer Talthar it is dedicated to training men, and women, that seek to fight against the Spiter and drive back the Sunless.

While the Abbey is dedicated to the faith it is open to any that wish to join the forces that battle against the Foe, providing they are willing to at least get along with those that live here.

It is different in appearance to most of the Talthar Abbey's in that it is made of simple bunkhouses that form a large courtyard, situated so the Abbey could stand against attack if needed. While there are still chambers for prayer and contemplation it is far more Baronial in its martial practicalities than other religious buildings might be.

Characters trained in Briars Cross are as normal Labyrintheans with the following changes: They must be goodly or neutral. They gain a discipline innate as per monastic. They gain ley believer to the church of Talthar from 1st level, however Lay believer must be purchased as the 1st ability post 8th at a reduced cost of 20pts (unless they are a priest of Talthar, in which case they do not have to buy ley believer). They may not join a church other than Talthar They may not join a social guild

The Broken Lands

During the year IM1014 the young mercenaries of Primus participated in and led an undertaking of great peril, the conclusion of which established far reaching consequences.

Before the year commenced Captain Lathaniel Brahm from Fort Bessen at the northern-most edge of civilisation, adjacent to the Broken Lands, discovered an attack was planned against the Shaman of the Broken Lands. Although estranged from the tribes Lathaniel believed them to still be integral to the long term wellbeing of the Broken Lands and employed some young mercenaries to investigate.

They discovered a plot by some winter elves of dark heart led by a powerful mage named Winters Scorn to destroy the Shaman completely and then try and take control of the tribal creatures of the Broken Lands. The young mercenaries lost many of their friends in the ensuing battles but managed to repel (but not destroy) the aggressors and saved the Shaman from their fate. This act led to the Shaman's trust of the young mercenaries and the following undertaking that was asked of them.

Although ostracised from their tribe the shaman still remained attached to their former clans and wanted to leave the Broken Lands safer for them through the creation of a huge ritually empowered moot to draw the tribes together.

A 'human' traveller of the Broken Lands called the Gatherer offered to act as an intermediary between the Shaman, Lathaniel and the young mercenaries due to the Shamans' reclusive nature.

The Gatherer's first piece of guidance was that the mercenaries approach and gain the support of all of the main tribes in the Broken Lands as without their support the endeavour was in all likelihood doomed to failure. The mercenaries worked tirelessly throughout the entire year encouraging the tribes to sign up to supporting the creation of the moot through a mixture of earning the tribes respect or forcing them into submission as required. But eventually each of the main tribes fell to their wiles and a pact between the tribes to create the moot was formed.

Yet still there was more to do. They needed to appease and then gain the support of the place spirit of the Broken Lands simply named Totem. The mercenaries gathered his lost aspects the fetishes of the Bear, Owl, Snake, Fish and finally the Mask. As these all became joined the Totem manifested itself and gave those gathered as individuals its blessing and then cast its blessing upon the moot as well although one of the fetishes had been lost...

As the dawn approached the mercenaries, under the watchful eye of both the Shaman and the Gatherer prepared the rite to create the moot. They gathered the last ritual components, gained the support of the Trolls and with the assistance of the Shaman created the bridges that linked the tribes and all corners of the Broken Lands to the Great Moot.

Finally, with all the pieces gathered over such a long time the heroes of the tribe placed them in their ritual places and as the last sparks of starlight and the silver light of the moon shone down upon the mountains the Totem once again became manifest. In its hands it held the missing fetish and begged to be released. The mercenaries struck the Totem down as it had bidden them and with its fresh crimson blood flowing like a river across the ground the Great Moot was done.

OOC Details

Some new tribal options are now available but each of them with the restriction that they cannot join imperially aligned guilds.

Tribal creatures from these tribes can only be Warriors or Pathfinders unless otherwise noted below (No Shamen or Witchdoctors to be started as they are all currently NPC's).

ORCS

Orcs may be started from the following tribes with the following changes from normal:

The Lost
More civilised than orcs have any right to be and in touch with using their minds.

New Starting Class Option: Orcs of the Lost can only be Psi Masters or Spies. Life scales are as the human equivalent.

The Broken Crown
Orcs of the Broken crown are loyal to the church of the Tryst.

New Starting Class Option: Orcs of the Broken Crown can only be Wayfinders or Spirit Warriors and must be members of the Church of the Tryst.

Members of the Broken Crown are unable to read spiritual runes (despite normal way finder requirements), which means they cannot use scriptures of the faith.

The Thrice
New Starting Class Option: Orcs of the Thrice can only be Warlocks or Rogues. They can only cast Elemental (Black, White, Red, Green, Blue, or Brown) spells, and not grey mana.

Life scales are as the human equivalent.

Members of the Thrice are unable to read mana glyphs (despite normal rogue restrictions). This means they cannot use Teaching scrolls.

The Bloodcrushers
A brutal and combat related tribe. Members must be within the warrior bracket and may only Multi-race Uruk-Hai.

Children of Bragyl
Goblins that are Children of Bragyl gain the ability to call upon their Ancestral Knowledge. They may buy Minor and Major prayers as a Wayfinder, but a max of 1 of each per 3 tables (round up).

The Hollow Bone
Goblins of the Hollow Bone are spiritless.

New Starting Class Option: Goblins of the Hollow Bone can only be Forest Guardians (life as Goblin pathfinder) or Leywalkers (life as Silverfolk Spy).

Cave Fangs
Warriors can replace a warrior specialist skill with the scout skill Well Equipped (Poison).

Members of this tribe may buy Touched by Venom as is they were members of the Buladajin.

GOBLINS

Goblins may be started from the following tribes with the following changes from normal:

OGRES

The Blackened Kow or Og's Fallen

Ogres from either tribe may re-enact the Great Feast 1/Day (must eat real food continuously for 5 minutes). After doing so they gain the benefit of a Regen Elixir for the following hour (damage to the abdomen always counts as 'worst location' unless completely healed). However, they are at -1 level of resistance while the Regen Elixir is running due to feeling overfed.

TROLLS

The Trolls of the Broken Lands do not belong to a tribe and instead are either solitary creatures or live in small family units. However, the trolls of the Broken Lands all harken back to earlier days and have awareness and understanding of mystical bridges beyond normal troll intelligence.

They may purchase the below on table 7 for 100 points, and can buy a maximum of 3.

Walk the Worlds bridges - 1/Day they may perform a ritual that must either use an existing bridge or recreate one during the rite. This bridge can be used as a portal from one place to another but everyone crossing the bridge must pay a toll to the troll that is consumed and destroyed in the ritual.

This bridge in essence shortens the distance between two points rather than transportation but otherwise works exactly as the evocation 'Travelling the World Tree'

Each Troll can choose their own 'toll' dependant on their nature but some suggestions are:

Toll Troll - 500 Grulls per head

Blood Troll – 12 TBLP of blood per head

Power for the road – A single point of mana, spirits, or Earthpower must be given. This can be paid by someone other than the traveller.

(Anyone can choose another toll but these must be agreed by the GSM and signed onto the card).

Cathedral of Night and Day

The Decree of Day & Night

In IM332 the Master of Primus Hadrell issued his infamous Decree of Day and Night – Despite worries over Hadrell's sanity, the Decree was considered permanent and irrevocable in its existence. From this day forward Life would proceed cyclically, swaying back and forth continuously in an attempt to maintain a balance in the light and the dark. Never would Primus be able to be a sanctuary and haven, always would the foci seek to bring new powers to play should an imbalance occur. The Lands of Primus would remain in strife and war until both good and evil could learn to live in harmony and in equal balance. Until that day new threats would arise to trouble the people.

The Church of Day & Night

The "Church" of Day and Night (if indeed church is the right word – think more "ideal") is a much-forgotten faith (if indeed faith is the right word – think more "way of life/concept") that was formed in the wake of the Decree of Day and Night – issued by the then Master of Primus, Hadrell.

It was made up primarily by what today are known of as Grey Wardens, but not exclusively so – also encompassing many talented in arts of either goodly or evil powers. Many of these trained to use such natural gifts by the "Church" (much like the Circle now "collects" talented youths) – and some who found the organized religions too restrictive. It was not restricted to those with spiritual talents - in fact encouraged any power users to follow this way of life – and actively preached and encouraged the balance of all things, the elements, the spirit realm and similar.

Their basic principle was not only "Balance is Best", but "Balance is Essential". As such as well as the Cathedral situated in the Broken Lands, there were several other places of import or "temples" situated around the Empire forming a "Web of Balance" – with the Throne of Glass at the Centre. Its purpose simply to ensure that the power that was channelled through the Nagrech would be equally balanced by its opposite to ensure that the primal equilibrium was maintained and no one power or source held undue sway over the other.

The Cathedral had a renowned Reliquary, a room that was able (when the Cathedral is fully consecrated) to contain artefacts of immense power – basically things that upset the balance of things too much!

Whilst many of the goodly and evil faiths denied The Decree and the idea of eternal balance as a fallacy, the Church of Day and Night accepted it as part of the new fabric of Primus. They believed that as more power was channeled to Primus, it became increasingly important to ensure this cosmic balance was maintained. For every good, a little bad, for every bad – a little good.

As such in an attempt to regulate this, they formed a set of tenets that revolved around serving the spirits of light during the day through healing and benediction, and at night, through ritual, they would draw the powers of darkness towards them and seek them and contain them – lest they wreak destruction upon the innocents of Primus. While at the same time it was of course vital to ensure the elements, both natural and arcane were also kept in this harmonious balance.

In Modern Times

Today it is little known by its original name, and much of its history has been lost through the passing of time, and the results of the Night of Levity – that is to all except those who follow this way of life, or indeed those that actively seek out such information – indeed many individuals in the third age who hark on about the importance of balance are generally the victims of nay-sayers calling them fence sitters or idealists ("a world where good and evil lives side by side, yeah right – you been around the tamarisk again 'aven't you mate!")

Location

The Cathedral is located on the frontier of the Broken Lands around three leagues west of Fort Rose in the Sellaville territories. The founders of the Church chose this location for two reasons. Firstly, the Broken Lands is a remote and wild part of the Empire where they could go about their business without the interference of the respective faiths of "light" and "dark". Secondly, this part of the Empire is completely unaffected by the Mittlenacht – ideal if your main aim is ritual stability on Primus!

Members of the Church of Night and Day may be grey wardens or guardians of the balance. They have stats as per a normal member of their class, however the ethos above (specifically using powers of light to aid and containing (as in warding in) evil to prevent it causing destruction) replaces the role-play restriction of acting evil when with a goodly party and goodly when with an evil party.

Grey knights & true neutral hermit priests may also be members of the faith, but their stats are unchanged

The Dark Phoenix

As the Dawn on 1014 approached the Empire gathered its forces. A year had been spent battling against the forces of Merrick and the Dark Phoenix. Merricks rituals of protection and empowerment had been located and destroyed. The spies within the Inquisition were found and their plans revealed. The mercenaries travelled to attack the last of the Dark Phoenix's rituals, manipulating the rebirths of mercenaries across Primus. The battle into the keep was brutal, indeed Merrick himself stood against them confident in his last ritual of protection. Even his near unkillable might was not enough however and the mercenaries took the chambers and destroyed the ritual. From there they began to unravel the Dark Phoenix last plan, to halt the turning of the year.

As they battled other threats, Demons, Vitae Hunters, the Crimson shrew, and more they slowly unravelled each of the rituals that covered Primus, most with success. Alas the ritual within the Jade Empire was completed to unknown consequences.

The brave heroes travelled to hidden chambers to find the Amulets the leader of the Dark Phoenix planned to use to ascend to greater power and disrupted his ritual.

Then with minutes left till the Dawn turned the most powerful of the gathered mercenaries were drawn away to defend Halgar from the assaults of Demonic forces. Entering the chamber those that remained found the rituals of the Dark Phoenix and began to unravel it. With seconds of the year left the final words of 1014 were heard echoing across Primus, return to the land of the living, and the world was reborn afresh and renewed.

The inquisition can report that while Merrick fled all other forces of the Dark Phoenix have been located and either killed or apprehended for trial. There was also a surge of power over Phoenix Watch as the dawn turned, home of the Knights of Renown.

System updates

It is now possible to start Phoenix Touched individuals again.

If they are mana users with a colour (EG wizard, power master etc.) then they must be Red (So could not be a power warrior). They are unable (even if evil) to use evil spirits. They must have red/gold flaming marketing on their skin. In a change they can now join guilds freely.

The only multi-race available to them is High Elf, and this is purchased at half elf cost. It should be noted they are not "Elves" it instead represents the embracing of the power of the Phoenix within them.

Immunity to freeze and cold cost 50% more to buy, and they cannot ever have better than ½ effect supernatural cold.

Demon Touched

At the dawning of IM 1012, all across the empire, spreading from Halgar, dark clouds of power were seen. Rain began to fall and thunder storms struck every corner of the Empire. The storm raged throughout the night following the Dawn and when the morning sun broke the leaves of the trees had been burnt, as if touched by acid. The air smelt of sulphur, and there was an unseasonal humidity in the air. Within days it became clear that a great evil had been released and while it may have been defeated the creatures that fled the hells with it had not.

Across the Empire people were reporting sighting of demons at every turn. Wagons were being attacked, farms ransacked, and small hamlets destroyed. It was clear that unless this was stopped them the demons would continue to rampage and grow in strength. Some began reporting strange marks appearing on their skins, or even horns beginning to grow. A few individuals seem to have been possessed outright. Was this truly the end of days?

Demon touched – Any character may choose to be "Demon Touched" when started. The exact nature of this is updated every Almanac. You cannot choose to stop being Demon Touched standardly. You must take the advantages and disadvantages.

Factions of Deci

JS Armouries

Head: Jander Sunstar, aka The Forge

Power Base: Industrial, Military

Motto: Everyone deserves at least one chance.

“I believe that you should treat all with fairness and respect regardless of their past reputations until they prove themselves unworthy. Everyone deserves at least one chance.” Jander Sunstar

Jander Sunstar, one-time commander of the Shadow Legion, Ex-Lord Knight of the Knights of the Land, Ex-Magistrate General of the Empire, Ex-Quarter Marshall of the IMC, Legend, Primal Deity and one-time Governor of Deci is possibly the most underrated and misunderstood of the major powers in Deci by those outside of the city. His quiet, unassuming nature and simple determination to get on with the job at hand without fuss combined with his long retirement from the daily Mercenary path has left him somewhat overlooked by the current crop of mercenaries, but his influence within Deci and his legacy across the Empire as a whole should not be forgotten or underestimated.

This great man of principle has long worked to drag Deci step by step up from the gutter into a place where people can be proud to live with, if not necessarily good lives then productive ones. Whilst Master Halfblack took upon himself to restore the city’s guilds and rejuvenate Deci’s trade, Sire Sunstar transformed the two main heavy industries of Deci, that of its mines and that of its foundries and Warsmiths.

The sheer amount of hard work he put in behind the scenes is often completely unappreciated and a lack of understanding for the huge amount that he has done has in part lead to his reputation as a force for good being tarnished amongst certain mercenaries and those in the far-off halls of Halgar who decried him for seemingly allowing evil to flourish in the city or failing to stop Argoth’s ascension to power during his tenure as Governor. However, these people fail to understand the nature of the city and the impossibility of certain things or to even realize just quite how much he had already tempered Argoth’s actions and just how much worse things could have been without his calm but dominating presence.

For instance, Jander’s guidance transformed the warsmiths from following a path that would have lead to them simply churning out daggers to one where Deci is the Empire’s single largest supplier of arms and weapons and an asset of growing significance with the conflicts that threaten the security of the Empire.

His leadership diverted the Deci Miners from following their ancient Traditions and Observances that would have seen them become little more than thieves and raiders of other people’s hard work and has instead moulded them into becoming actual workers of mines.

In the same manner as he changed the nature of the Warsmiths and the Miners Jander’s time as Governor was characterised by a slow but steady transformation of the character of the people. His years of work granted him an understanding and familiarity with the city, which whilst not rivalling that of its Vizier, Master Halfblack, was sufficient to understand how things needed to be done to accommodate change and the rate at which things could be done without rebellion or disaster. Following his stepping down as Governor to pursue his primal calling as The Forge and thus handing the Poisoned Chalice of Governorship to Earl Majius he has remained within the King’s court as Defence Minister, a position which in the traditionally large council of Deci oversees the Stadtus' and Commisent’s efforts to organize the cities defence.

His near indestructible Forged Republican Laminar has a reputation as one of the ultimate life savers and it is said that the lives of many men have been saved through wearing it and even the course of battles altered by its protection. The Empress herself wears a special suit of armour he made for her and a number of the Primal Deities wield Dawnblades, weapons of the gods forged for them in the death of one year and given life by the

birth of the next.

Of the luminaries of Deci Jander is the one closest to the common working man, it is not for him to surround himself with the swaggering Thugs of The Sleek, the arrogant Assassins of The Murder, the pampered lackeys of the King or the sly Factors of Halfblack Holdings but to get his hands dirty side by side with the Wastrel and Guilded of the city alike.

As a smith and a miner, two hard working trades, he very much represents the common man. Consequently, his War Host is a very unusual affair, it is more correctly termed a Guild Mark since that army he commands is in fact made up from membership of a number of the city's guilds which he has integrated himself into and earned their respect and to some degree allegiance. He was for two year's running in IM 1009 and IM 1010 Sire of the Warsmiths guild, something highly unusual amongst The Hundred, who favour an annual change in their leadership at each Final Dawn. Although he stepped down from this role at the Final Dawn IM 1010.

It was this Guild Mark that he took into battle against King Blackjack, representing the guilds who had suffered quite badly at his hands and although ultimately nearly every single guildsman who stood and fought died at that terrible climax of the civil war in the city the wiser amongst the guilds understand it was needed.

As a result of his striking lack of the airs and graces you might expect from a demigod and legend of his stature and due to his plain and simple example Jander's people are honourable, hard working no nonsense souls. He and his are very much the moral steel and fibre of an otherwise dark and quite frankly horrific city. The faith of the Forge is very strong in the city and wherever you find decent people in the city you do not need to mine deep before finding Jander's influence behind such.

Characters able to join guilds may join this faction with the head's permission. The head may remove them as members simply by putting up a notice or a public post on the Labyrinthe forum. Whilst a member they may choose to battle-board the following benefits in place of their social guild if desired. Characters may not be a member of more than one such faction. Members of JS Armouries may battle-board up to two apprentice crafted or one journeyman crafted weapon, shield or suit of armour. These can be used by other characters on that dungeon if desired.

Followers of the Murder

Head: Don Argoth III, aka The Murder

Power Base: Criminal, Supernatural

The Argoth Principle: Never let little problems become big problems

"Do you know why I stay at the top? Because I never let little problems become big problems." The Murder

The rise of a lowly Drowe by the name of Argoth through the ranks of Asgui's Sin Lads in the city of Deci is a long one. He is infamous for a great many acts, few of which have ever been conclusively tied to him. Few factions in Deci of Mercenary origin can claim the longevity of action in the modern city greater than that of Argoth III. He is one of Deci's most infamous sons and even amongst the powerful Mercenaries of the Empire his name commands fear and begrudging respect. His rise to power in the city has not been a typical one but it culminated in him becoming the Primal Force of Murder, the dark hand of Primus. It is said that, at the behest of The Lord Inquisitor, it was at his hand that the Primal Spirit of the 2nd Age met its end as required to allow the start of the 3rd Age.

One of Argoth's first acts to consolidate power in Deci was to destroy the Mocker Lord known as The Fatman and unravel or subsume his once pervasive criminal organisation within the city. Once achieved little stood in the way of his expansion within Deci.

Of course, no mention of Deci would be complete without mention of the equally infamous Poison Club, the

expansive demesne of Argoth that at its height in the city became a secretive, powerful and even a sentient entity, within which is supposed to lie his ritual chambers, Hallowed Temple and all manner of similar structures.

Whilst geographically originating in Cheapside the Poison Club grew to such size it swallowed up a fifth of the city to became the Poison Quarter. A meta-quarter that squatted over the industrial South Quarter of the city otherwise known as The Slurries. It was from the poisonous smog and effluence of Deci's heavy industries that the Poison Quarter drew nourishment and sustained its foul lifeforce just as the chaos and conflict of the city fuelled Argoth's power.

The Poison Quarter proved itself adaptable and highly adept at recognising those it should permit entrance and those enemies of Argoth's that it should bar. It was said to be able to block the Kallah at the whim of The Murder and rumoured to, at its heart, be proof even from the gaze of the City Spirit. No mean feat given that Ulis Tamary was quite possibly the most powerful of the City Spirits and occasionally referred to as "The single most dangerous man on Primus".

Those with the skill of infiltration are said to have reported that the Poison Quarter's wardings and secrets were the equal or even greater than those of the Inner City of Halgar. The nature of the Poison Quarter being such that the very streets would morph and change their structure over the course of a night. Those who sought to infiltrate the quarter could pass right through without ever finding a street leading to those hidden places rumoured to be concealed within and a path they took one day might not even exist the next.

Argoth was able to fully assume the primal power of The Murder by his seeming assassination of Ulis Tamary at a Final Dawn with his infamous Knives. A set of ancient relics from Golden Scarlene and a tool that facilitated the dispatch of beings otherwise warded from such death. Over the years the exact nature of the events of this assassination proved somewhat convoluted as astonishingly, it has begun to look as if the contract placed on Ulis was done by none other than Ulis himself for reasons of his own...

Over the years Argoth lived up to his name as The Murder, and following an insult by Fidgit, the Governor of Eartholme, who mistakenly accused him of petty theft from Eartholme's coffers and refused to apologise lead to a series of events that threatened to disrupt the Empire and proved the Senate impotent by a series of powerful and growing ever more deadly ritual strikes against the city of Eartholme. The result lead to a rift between Eartholme and Deci, Eartholme and the Senate and Deci and the Senate. The Council of Eartholme, though quite able to unleash their own ritual strikes against Deci refused to do so since Governor Fidgit wisely and mercifully viewed that the citizens were, in the most part, innocent of Argoth's actions.

Argoth also unleashed a terrible rite against the City of Keys, although in this he was greatly thwarted by the presence of the Tranquil, who absorbed the rite to protect his own followers, of whom a great many existed in the city and who's Disciple in the city would later undo much of the damage inflicted.

The Senate took the view that all those of power in Deci were complicit in Argoth's acts regardless of the fact that they too were just as powerless to stop The Murder as the Senate itself. In an attempt to force the hand of the powers of Deci the Senate threatened House Majius and Master Halfblack who proved in their own ways as resistant to Senatorial influence as Argoth himself and effectively called the Senate's bluff. For to these powers the Senate represented a distant and far off irritation whilst Argoth represented a daily, ever present and lethal threat. They had families, retainers and employees to protect and were well aware that their own people would suffer terrible retribution if they were to act directly against Argoth.

Eventually Argoth's acts of terrorism lead to the tithes brought by Countess Alcaster of Eartholme against Deci that caused some hardship for the people but ultimately proved unenforceable and once more left the Senate, at least in the eyes of the people of Deci, looking less than authoritative.

At the Final Dawn of IM 1007, in a manner reminiscent of the disappearance the Silverweavers the previous year, vast swathes of the City of Deci disappeared, most notably the Mocker's Kingdom and several of the city's darker pinnacle guilds. Along with these parts of the city a sizeable proportion of the citizenry disappeared along with the Mocker King and Argoth. Where they have gone can only be guessed at but the Poison Quarter and those structures tied to The Murder disappeared with it at the same time. It was rumoured

that Argoth had grown tired and bored of the petty politics of mortals and felt himself beyond the attentions of his enemies and now turned his dark gaze to greater goals...

At the Final Dawn of IM 1008 after what seemed like a year's absence The Murder reminded the Empire that he still existed by fulfilling a single contract at the end of the year. The Entity Known as The Great Beast sought to subsume the Spirit of Primus and by doing so would come to dominate the nature of Primus. Unable to resist the summons of The Great Beast the World Spirit Primus presented itself like a lamb to the slaughter but unknown to The Great Beast one small portion of Primus did resist and it crept up to defend its world; that being The Murder who slew The Great Beast. Hardly an act of altruism as it was rumoured that a contract had worth 100,000C had been paid through the Druids of Trovil to put an end to the threat and abomination represented by The Great Beast.

The carnage that reigned in the city caused by the Murder cults of first Bhaal, then Argoth and Blackjack, a Disciple of The Murder, has now mostly burnt itself out of the city. And although relative peace exists in the city none would ever imagine that despite his seeming silence that The Murder does not still watch over the darkness of Deci and only a fool would not check the shadows for signs of his presence...

*Characters able to join guilds may join this faction with the head's permission. The head may remove them as members simply by putting up a notice or a public post on the Labyrinthe forum. Whilst a member they may choose to battle-board the following benefits in place of their social guild if desired. Characters may not be a member of more than one such faction. Followers of the Murder gain 2 * Lucky ideas that may only be used to work out the best way to kill something. Any character taking this option is Ostracised as per cutthroat.*

Stab Street

Head: Sire 'Berry, aka Trundleberry, aka Black Hat, aka The Hat

Power Base: Information Broker, Cheapside Gang

Symbol / Gang Patch: Black Hat on a circular green background

Sire 'Berry of Stab Street must be the most unusual of Deci's powers. How Trundleberry, a quiet little goblin came to such prominence in Deci as to earn the social standing and title of Sire is amazing in itself. The fact that this was within Cheapside, is even more remarkable.

For most it's actually quite difficult to even say how long Sire 'Berry has been of influence in the city, his generally unassuming goblin nature has seen him fare well and his quiet climb to power has left many with the feeling that he has always been there in "A Stab In The Back, 1 Stab Street, Cheapside, Deci, Primus, The Exostance".

Sire 'Berry originally made his name in Deci as a Gobball during the time of the great Gobball revival lead by Blueblottle, the Elemental Lord of Twilight, one-time Stadtus of Deci. He was one of the most successful Gobballs ever and retired not without a pile of grulls, a growing reputation in Deci and a somewhat strange armoured contraption...

He married and settled down with his wife, now known simply as Ma Berry, and a growing litter of Ratfolk stepsons. One could easily be forgiven for thinking that just about every ratfolk in Deci calls themselves one of Sire 'Berry's stepsons despite the fact that neither he nor Ma 'Berry actually have children

The Stepsons proved to be very, very useful to Sire 'Berry for three main reasons. Firstly, like their cousins in Thimon, the Ratfolk are incredibly skilled with their paws in the making of curiosities and luxury items and Sire Berry put them to good use in "A Stab In The Back", the little shop he opened which later expanded to take up an entire street and formed the now infamous Stab Street, known throughout the Empire as the place to get

the finest daggers.

Secondly, The Stepsons over time formed up a little gang, a gang answering to the wealthy and socially respected Sire 'Berry and armed with the finest shivs in the city. Soon the gang grew to be probably the most powerful and respected force in Deci. Fortunately, Sire 'Berry's Goblin instincts have left him wary of causing trouble or starting fights, at least those of the straight up kind and over time Stab Street has come to be seen as a place of neutrality in Cheapside. It is rumoured that even now the five Kallah Lords of Deci regard Stab Street, if not specifically the actual location, as a place where they can meet safely without falling under the jurisdiction of another or threat of interference from the other powers of Deci.

Thirdly, the rats have sharp eyes and sharp ears and over time Stab Street has become a hive of information. It is said, as least by the good goblin, that if you seek information then in Deci there is no place better than Stab Street. Many of the curious amongst the vitaed and mighty have sat in The Golden Rooms, Stab Street, getting a shave and listening to the gossip and news on something they seek to know about in Deci. A clean shave long being acknowledged in Deci as the best way to demonstrate the quality of a blade.

With the construction of the Horned Serpent and the destruction of the rats at the hands of the Serpents that followed in its wake the only rats to be found in the city are concentrated in Stab Street, they having lost their position as vermin, replaced by serpents in Deci's hierarchy. Something that no doubt further consolidated Sire 'Berry's position in Cheapside as the Rats and Ratfolk, Stepsons or not, took sanctuary in Stab Street.

During the destructive reign of King Blackjack Sire 'Berry navigated a tricky path with Stab Street on the edges of Kingdom Cheapside. Whilst the gangs would uncharitably see Sire 'Berry as treacherous and a turncoat for serving the King as an advisor and then refusing to fight for him it is perhaps fairer to note that he whispered many words of restraint to King Blackjack to restrict his worse excesses, besides, what choice did he have, a Goblin against an Orc? Not something that has ever gone well in the grand scheme of things for the Goblins of Primus.

With the fall of King Blackjack there was a collective holding of the breath of the denizens of Cheapside as rumour went round that Sire 'Berry would look to claim the crown that had fallen. Fortunately, Sire 'Berry was wise enough to understand that such kingdoms are built and maintained through constant conflict and he saw no reason to go to war with what were basically his customers. After a little flexing of his fists, where a few "disrespectful" gangs had been concerned, he left Cheapside in peace and the gangs breathed a sigh of relief as they returned to their turfs and minor disputes.

Stab Street remains a place of neutrality in Deci, where one can get a decent shave, hear juicy gossip, purchase a curse from Ma 'Berry or acquire the finest of daggers all watched by the Stepsons and lorded over by the shrewd Sire 'Berry.

Characters able to join guilds may join this faction with the head's permission. The head may remove them as members simply by putting up a notice or a public post on the Labyrinthe forum. Whilst a member they may choose to battle-board the following benefits in place of their social guild if desired. Characters may not be a member of more than one such faction. Residents of Stab Street gain a pair of concealable, well made daggers and gain blade sharpening, as per the scout skills.

Halfblack Holdings

Head: Anath Halfblack

Power Base: Financial

Motto: Prepare for the Worst, Hope for the Best.

"If you shake hands with Anath make sure you count your fingers afterwards. He is willing to bend the truth

and twist interpretations in order to manipulate things in his favour - a true Merchant. A frighteningly clever manipulator, he may not be behind every financial or economic problem but it may be best to assume he is" Count Drago, Governor of Keys

Master Halfblack is somewhat unusual as a Mercenary in that he is one of the few rich in vitae who has taken a path to power based on being an economic force. He is a member of the Mercantile Caste and his Merchant Holding is fairly typical of that caste. However, unlike most Merchants, who secrete themselves away in their holdings, estates or city sponsored Guildhalls, he has a fairly high profile, matched only by the more Baronial Merchants Sire Thor in Takalia and Sire Haruld in Thimon.

For over a decade he has served as Finance Minister to the City of Deci, honing his skills and becoming intimately familiar with the cultural nuances of the confusing, entropic and seemingly contradictory city. It has been said that whilst no one can expect to ever understand the entirety of the nature of Deci, Master Halfblack is at least one who knows what it is he does not understand and his knowledge of the Laws of Tradition that form Deci society is unrivalled.

He has long been acknowledged as being the architect behind the growth of a city that if left to its own devices has an unerring tendency to follow a path of self destruction. He has managed to navigate some tricky situations with a knack for coming out relatively near the top of the pile each time. Often proving that what initially appears to be defeat as ultimately being victory and his ability to act upon plans layered within plans and coated with contingencies means he is rarely unable to turn a situation to either his or the city's advantage.

His skills at planning combined with his financial accumen has both made and saved the city of Deci vast sums of money and his personal loaning of money has brought him much by way of subtle influence and power.

Whilst Merchants are primarily buyers and sellers of goods each has their own particular specialisation, his is finance and money lending. However, like all Merchants, even if the monies gained from such pale into insignificance compared to their more secretive and subtle investments, he deals in commodities. Commodites are what Merchants do "for the sake of peace and prosperity" and each Merchant tends to favour specific bundles.

Being based in Deci it is only natural that his foremost commodity is metal. However, with the presence of JS Armouries in the city, he enjoys a not poor trade in Arms and Weapons. Additionally, King Knock Knock, his great Auction Hall, caters to the Mercenary Caste with artefacts and helps fuels his trade in objects of rarity and value.

Over more recent years his personal businesses became tightly integrated within the fabric of the city and a factor in the city's growing financial stability. The Invisible Quarter, his personal demesne, has become so tied to the city that the Mercantile Quarter has, in local parlance, become known simply as The Invisible Quarter and is a financial force to be reckoned with, not just in Deci but increasingly across the Empire.

His pet project, Forgetown, founded in IM 1007, has proved a great success and an indicator of his capacity for forethought and planning. He sought for a means to restore trade to Deci and that solution was Forgetown. Trade had suffered for years at the hands of the murder cults whose games of "Cull The Trader" had unsurprisingly discouraged such visitors from the Deci territories. However, the presence of Forgetown not only reversed that long trend of decay but placed Deci in an increasingly dominant position regarding trade within the Empire as well as proving highly profitable for all its investors.

His power and influence is regarded with suspicion by many yet none have ever been able find evidence of any disreputable acts beyond his sharp mercantile practices and even those who strike deals with him will often begrudgingly admit that they have always got exactly what was agreed. At times even those who might regard themselves as "his enemy" have been forced to deal with him. It is much to his personal sense of satisfaction and amusement that he is regarded as some sort of "necessary evil".

Even in Deci he could not be described as a popular man but he is greatly respected by the people for his sly Deci cunning and years of tireless work for the city, even when the medicine he might prescribe has a tendency to taste bitter it is usually accepted that if The Vizier recommends such and such then such and such should be done and done without question. And it is his ability to use the city for his own benefit and his own power for the benefit of the city that have seen Halfblack Holdings and the city of Deci prosper in ways that five or six years ago might have seemed impossible.

Characters able to join guilds may join this faction with the head"s permission. The head may remove them as members simply by putting up a notice or a public post on the Labyrinthe forum. Whilst a member they may choose to battle-board the following benefits in place of their social guild if desired. Characters may not be a member of more than one such faction. Members of Halfblack Holdings are well equipped with two batches of immediately available or simple potions. They may get a better price for any "treasure" handed-in / sold off an event - it generates an extra 25% in grulls, the referee may claim these extra grulls from the Desk.

House Majius

Head: Earl Troy Majius, aka King Troy The Faceless

Power Base: Political

Heraldry: An ornate black M on a silver background with a dragon entwined around it (traditionally the dragon is a black dragon but in recent years younger house members have preferred other colours).

Halls Affiliation: Hall of Scrolls

History: The House of Majius has existed in one form or another for many, many years. Its history, though mostly destroyed in written form at Emperor Amoras' request as part of the Night of Levity, still remains in part in the lore of their council. House Legend has it that the first Majius was a mage of darkness a thousand years ago who led a host of wizards in repelling an ancient evil that threatened the borders of Primus. He was granted the hand in marriage of the then Emperor's second daughter, and the Majius line was forged in royal blood.

They were always a small house in the grand scheme of things, preferring the life of Deci's streets to the royal court. Only under Dalron's brief tenure at head of the council did they rise to prominence as the most powerful noble house of the Empire. Many of the family and their loyal stalwarts are servants of the dark queen, including several companies of troops made purely of loyal dark Elves and Drowe. Many others, however, reflect the rest of the populace in following and belief, including a thriving community of Shaehan priests administering to the poor and needy, several goodly churches on the lands (built at Dalron's behest!), and thousands of peons, farmers, and the like who benefit from the Houses' patronage.

However, the House suffered by Dalron's decision that the Empire and Primus was threatened by having an all but dead man upon the Throne of Glass. He claimed that the Emperor's slowly decaying body, due to its link with the Nagrech was sending sympathetic ripples of decay outwards across Primus and to the Exostance beyond. Approaching the Throne, as was his right as then Chancellor or the Empire, he took matters into his own hand and attacked the Emperor as he sat helpless on the throne finishing what Baron Roxbridge had failed in with his own attempt just prior to the High Final Dawn.

Whilst there were several who shared Dalron's concerns, not least the Lord Inquisitor at the time and certain high ranking members of the Inquisition, all were shocked at Dalron's unilateral decision and action that threw the Empire into confusion. Dalron was declared Wolfshead but vanished and to this day has not been caught. House Stoneheart and House De'Ville swore that they would have vengeance on House Majius for this and that they would crush them. However, Dalron had planned well and made sure that his House could not be implicated in his personal action. The Convocation of Nobility accepted this, no doubt a result of some intervention by the strangely influential amassed Deci Houses of Nobility and House Majius escaped being disbanded or declared outlaw.

Earl Majius: It is at this juncture, with such a near catastrophic loss of prestige and a similar gain in infamy, that Troy Majius came to power as Lord of House in IM 2002. In Orgrus IM 1003 he took over from Count Fade Raban as Mennihaft of Deci, having fulfilled the traditional apprenticeship for membership of the Deci Council of a year on the streets of Cheapside as a Watch Sergeant. As Mennihaft he worked quietly and subtly in a post that was somewhat neglected in all the other cities of the Empire bar Eartholme in this early part of the first decade of the Third Age. It is often overlooked quite how effective Earl Majius was in these efforts. He was able to greatly expand the influence of Deci's Nobility throughout the Empire and even persuaded the Lords of several Houses to once more take up their interests in Deci.

Another oft forgotten fact is that during the events of The Choice, he like many other Nobles of the Blood, answered the call of House Stoneheart and lent his strength to the Empress as she re-wove Primus anew.

At the Final Dawn of IM 1006 Earl Majius was wed to Lady Berina Hadensford which, whilst unsurprisingly an astute political marriage, scandalous rumour has suggested that it is also one of love.

He replaced Jander as Governor of Deci in Novea IM 1004 which he remained until removed from the post by Chancellor White in Aiprus IM 1007 although over the Final Dawn of IM 1006 he had become King of Deci and the title of Governor was but a mere Imperial affectation in the eyes of the people of Deci, being little more than a ceremonial role beneath The King. The mystic nature of how he became King is still unclear but good money could be placed on the meddlings of others, prime suspects therefore being Master Halfblack but more likely Ulis Tamary.

It was upon the very day in Juon IM 1007 that Duke Stoneheart entered the city with a held of Senatorial guard and marked the start of his two-month tenure as Governor of Deci, that the Werewolves of Deci attacked the city. It was soon revealed that this attack was aimed specifically at the Deci Nobility and the wolves succeeded in killing the House Lords of Claugh, Gelmanslew, Hail and Rath. Interestingly one consequence of this tragedy was that Troy's position as leader of the Deci Nobility was strengthened for with the deaths of the last few Lords who might regard themselves as older, wiser and his betters there remained none amongst the Deci Nobility who would now gainsay his word or challenge his authority as King.

Deci: Even now for those who do not dwell in day to day dealings treat with the common people the rule of King Troy The Faceless is often beyond comprehension. He is beloved, hated and feared by his people in equal measure and they are loyal to him and him alone. The Great Noble Houses of Deci are now little more than his personal vassals and none would dare to go against his word. The sovereignty and rule of House Majius is uncontested and for those who would even think such there is of course The Lord Sleek...

Other Notables of House Majius: House Majius is vast, perhaps though hardly surprising as for whatever reason vitae has always been very strong in Deci. It is only with the birth of the Third Age that Deci has begun to lose ground as being the birthplace of the largest share of the Mercenary Caste and House Majius is no less blessed, or cursed, depending on your viewpoint, with a great many vitae rich Blood members. It is perhaps only House De'Ville that can boast similar numbers. The House is a very political one and boasts a number of notable scions across the Empire, however, with the possible exception of his brother Talath, all of these have worked hard to distance themselves from the house of origin both geographically and metaphorically, with many declining to use their house name but tending to go by title. Even in Deci, Talath is often thought of as Talath Sleek rather than Talath Majius. Some of the more prominent members of the House are:

Talath, The Lord Sleek, The Baron Throttle: Talath, the King's younger brother, is a power to be feared of his own. Head of the Deci Hunt and Lord of The Sleek, those who enforce the will of the Deci council. It is said that nothing happens in Deci of import without The Sleek hearing. He is, somewhat interestingly, quite possibly held with greater respect than his infamous brother in The Convocation of Nobility in Halgar.

Count Isaac, The Baron of Scathe: Isaac is Mennihaft of The Rest and excels in Noble Politics. He has carved out quite a strong political position for himself in Halgar and of all the notables of House Majius is without doubt the most diplomatic and one of the most politically astute.

Lord Jeremiah, Baron of Weldon~on~Wretch: Jeremiah is Mennihaft of Scarlene and whilst not a very assuming Noble he is a good man of the people and well respected amongst the Mercenary Community, a

marshall Priest of Light and he leads his people in defence of his lands at the southern tip of Scarlene.

Lord Loxley: Loxley is Mennihaft of Eartholme and is something of a rake, fop and a joke amongst both House Majius and Mercenaries.

Adolomin, Marquis of Ivescardale: Like Lord Loxley, has lands in Eartholme and bears the most unusual title of Marquis, somewhat ironically given his lineage the duty of the Marquis is to defend Eartholme against attack and encroachment by its larger and darker neighbour of Deci.

The Majius Estates: Like all the Deci Houses House Majius makes colossal sums of money from their mines and with these resources has fuelled rapid expansion throughout the Empire. Whilst the ancestral estate of the Majius is in Deci, the House has extensive holdings that sweep great tracts across the Empire and the Earl never appears to be short of landed titles to be able to hand out as rewards to those of his extended family who earn his favour. He is, in actual fact, unusual with his generosity as a House Lord in freely bestowing his titles when most Nobles jealously hoard those titles they acquire only begrudgingly bestowing such to their kin.

Draconians

Draconians are not a true race, but are infact perversions of true dragon eggs. By using captured true dragon eggs shortly before the Genocide of the Dwarves, Torvash a Priest of Change, Gevi the Ebon Mage and the ancient Soul Dragon Rey'Lathian developed the process for corrupting the eggs into these draconians. For a long time it was believed that female draconians were never created from this process. However, the females were taken away to be vetted by Rey'Lathian for later breeding. Eventually it was deemed that to keep the males placid it would be best for them to mix with females. Rey'Lathian was convinced by an advisor to allow female draconians to live alongside their male counterparts, while still picking the best and brightest for his own broodmates.

Draconians were the elite troops of Rey'Lathian until his demise in 1117. Because of their connection to the dragons, draconians seemed to worship Rey'Lathian as a deity, which in turn granted him powers almost of the divine. Draconians were more likely to follow his orders than the typical ogre or orc or mercenary. Many of the types can use both magic and spirits and when they are killed each draconians developed a death vengeance that is carried out at the end of their life. Draconians are immune to all diseases and have been predicted live to be one thousand years old. The maximum age of a draconian can only be estimated as draconians haven't been around long enough to test this by dying of old age

The five standard types of Draconians Rey'Lathian had created with constant success are as follows; Rokeen - the Rock-kin, Gloozin - the Shadow-kin, Acriden - The Acid-kin, Eldricen - The Aura-kin and Myriak - The Nature-kin.

Live Roleplay rules

Draconians cannot wear armour of any sort, their unique frame and scaley hide does not allow for comfortable wearing of armour. Draconians gain innate PAC as per Troll and may buy more Post 8th as per Troll.

As well as armour, Draconians feet are clawed and mishapen, thus do not wear shoes. However they gain toughened feet (as halfling).

The Draconian nature of their mind will not allow for use of Neuronics.

Their natural distrust of non-Draconians means they cannot join guilds other than professional guilds; they distance themselves from politics and social meetings.

They originate from the world of Sildêyuir and as such they are non-primal beings.
Their bodies reject foreign mutations, thus Draconians are immune to disease.

All Draconians hands are Clawed, thus gaining Unarmed combat that inflicts sharp damage naturally. Classes unable to use weapons still cannot use Unarmed Combat, however classes restricted in sharp weapon use (EG Warrior Priests) can use this.

Currently all Draconians have any alignment that is Evil (LE,NE and CE)

They must wear makeup appropriate to their mutations.

All priest classes must be hermit priests.

Each character must choose which type of Draconian they are when first started, gaining benefits and restrictions as below.

Rokeen - The Rock-kin

The Rokeen variant of draconians is the most martial of all the draconian sub-species. They tend to be slow witted, suffering with tunnel vision and an addiction to intoxicating substances.

Rarely found with training in anything other than a warrior, their limited mental capacity is not suited for the Arcane or Spiritual and lacking the dexterity to be scout trained. They make excellent Shock Troops.

The Rokeen are, like all Draconians, able to expel a breath weapon, this variant is a viscous liquid that clings to the victim and reduces their capability to move.

They have brass skin which fades to a greenish colour as they age. They have an extreme hatred of Orcs.

Can only be Warriors. Life as Ggrutuck.

- *Gained at 1st level*

Tunnel Vision: once in combat they will only focus on the target they have chosen and will exclude all else until the target is dead or they have been ordered to do something else by a senior Draconian (any mutation other than another Rokeen)

Brute: As per Tables

Stone Form: Upon death turns to stone requiring 2 grades of strength to move. Additionally, if killed by a bladed weapon it suffers a Grand Weapon Break.

- *Gained on table 3*

Clinging Breath: 1/day may cause a Magical Slow 8 levels on one target within 20ft. May buy extras at 50 points each, max 1/table. Additionally on table 9 may enhance all Clinging Breaths owned to be non-level based for 75 points.

- *Gained on table 7*

Frenzy: 1/day enters a 50% Berserk Rage. Does not have to attack other Rokeen unless they attack him, however the primary target for the Rokeen is always Orcs. May buy extra innates at 80 points each, max 3.

Rokeen turn to stone upon death.

Gloozin - The Shadow-kin

Gloozin draconians are the most adaptable and cunning of the Draconians under Rey'Lathians sway. They are cruel minded and are often used in missions of assassination. Born with a dark blue hew that begins to darken to an ebony sheen over time. They are suited to many roles and excel in the path they have taken.

The Gloozin's breath weapon is a stinging vapour that when aimed at the eyes, blinds the victim.

They are smaller than the Rokeen mutation, and have venom glands, as well as also having healing saliva. Gloozin's are comfortable with members of their own race but rarely others.

When Gloozins die, their bones often explode outwards towards their killer.

Can only be Assassins, Thugs, Warlocks, Spirit Warriors and Warrior Priests, gaining Life as Orc.

- *Gained at 1st level*

Poison Spit: 1/day may "spit" CV2 at a target within 20ft.

May purchase extra innates at 20 points each with a maximum of 2 per table. On table 5 may purchase "Spray" which causes all targets within a "Neuronic Flare Cone" to be affected by a poison split if desired for 75 points. On Table 7 may purchased "Concentrated Poisoned Spit" which allows multiple poison spits to be used at the same time enhancing the poison so two uses causes the poison to be CV 4, three CV 6, etc. This functions with Spray.

Healing Saliva: 1/day May "lick" a wound on self or other Gloozin to heal it 12/12. May buy extra innates at 20 points each to a max of one per table.

- *Gained on Table 3*

Bone Storm: Upon death, their bones explode outwards dealing a spiritual/physical Oaken Spear to the killers chest. Can enhance this on table 10 to act as a physical/Spirit Oaken spear to every location of their slayer.

- *Gained on Table 7*

Blinding Breath: 1/day one target is magically blinded unlimited levels for 1 min. May buy extras at 60

Acriden - The Acid-kin

Acriden draconians have Grey scales. Able to make use of both spirits and magic in battle. They are cunning and determined in their ways, with arcane magical ability. Taught by the Eldricen their magical craft, however being physically stronger they can turn their talents to a Warlocks path.

The Acriden's breath weapon is spat out on a glob of Acid, which while burning the target, also begins to dissolve an item struck.

They are inherently skilled at leading other draconians. When a Acriden dies, they explode into acid towards

Can only be Sorcerers, Warlocks or Necromancers. Life as Ancient Folk.

Necromancers are as Vivomancers, gaining life as Elysians but may use summoned weapons. They may only use evil spirits, and must be Black, Bronze, or Onyx in colour.

- *Gained at 1st level*

Acid Breath: 2/day Breaths at an object within 20ft, this causes the object suffer the effects of an acid potion, additionally the splash deals 12/2 magical acid damage to a person who may be holding it.

- *Gained on Table 3*

Acid Splash: Upon death explodes with acid harming the killer as per an Acid Bolt

- *Gained on Table 7*

Acid breath will now destroy any objects that are not made of Glass and do not contain a spiritual component. May buy extra Acid Breaths at 80 points each, max 1/2 tables.

the killer.

Eldricen - The Aura-kin

Eldricens are mighty draconians who prefer to use Magical or Spiritual power and their innate abilities over physical fighting. They are tall and slim, and are gold coloured, their scales dimming with time. They prefer to be clad in robes.

The Eldricen's breath weapon, is a cloud of negatively charged metallic dust, reducing the Arcane or Spiritual defence of the victim, as well as causing the target to be held in place for a short time.

They are often found among their fellow draconians, where they are respected for their power and are protected by the more physically strong of their kind. When an Eldricen dies, it will often turn into a large powerful burst of energy which degenerates the killers physical form.

May only be High or normal Wizards or Pure Priest. Life as Ancient Folk.

- *Gained at 1st Level*

Shadow Breath: 1/day one target within 20ft has MAC and SAC reduced by 2 for 5 minutes, immunity to shadow plate applies. This stacks with itself but no other reductions in MAC/SAC. Post 8th can buy extra innates at 40 points each, max 1/table.

- *Gained on Table 3*

Eldritch Surge: Upon death casts an Onyx degeneration upon the killer. A dispel 4 will remove this.
May purchase "Lingering Death" on table 7 so the degeneration effect lasts for 5 minutes for 40 points. The dying effect is now a 8 mana spell to dispel.

On table 8 may purchase "Heart of power" for 40 points which causes the Eldritch surge to be mantic (evil spirit). The dying effect is now mantic, and stacks with other enhancements listed.

Finally on Table 10 can buy "Eternal Death" from Lingering Death which enhanced the Eldritch Surge so it lasts until the killer is dead, or the Draconian has been restored to life. The dying effect is now a 16 mana spell for being dispelled.

- *Gained on Table 7*

Natural resistance: Grants 1 MAC and SAC. Can enhance this to grant MAC 2 and SAC 2 so 150 points on table 9.

MYRIAK - THE NATURE-KIN

Myriaks are Bark scaled draconians. They are a sub-species of shape changing Draconians. They are the smallest of the draconians and possess the qualities of their chosen animal type.

They are the newest of all the draconian races, Acolytes of Xeo'Thyailian, they have learnt their druidic ways from the Descendants (a group of Druids living on Sildêyuir) and were perverted from their true course by Xeo'Thyailian who then showed them how to combine both earthpower and shapeshifting to become powerful.

They have sacrificed their innate breath weapon to assume a "swarm form", which makes them immune to anything but area damage, for 30 secs, as their swarm quickly reform from singular attacks.

When a Myriak dies it erupts into a spout of poisonous liquid aimed at the killer.

Can only be High Druid, Druid, Forest Guardian or Ley walkers. Life as Ratfolk.

- *Gained at 1st level:*

Venom Blossom: Upon death strikes the killer with a torrent of poison causing them to suffer a CV4 and a CV paralysis, with normal 30 second kick in.

On table 1 can buy "Rapid Blossom" meaning the poisons from Venom Blossom kick in instantly for 40 points.
Can buy Poisonous Blossom on table 9 so the CV 4 retriggers every 30 seconds for 5 minutes, or until the person receives a cure poison.

On table 11 can buy Deadly Venom meaning the initial poison is a CV Death.

- *Gained on table 3*

Swarm Form: 1/day as per warcry can assume a form of a swarm of insects for 30 secs. During this time they cannot be damaged by weapon blows. While active they cannot move from the point it was triggered.
Can buy extra innates at 60 points each, a max of 1/3 tables post 8th.

- *Gained on Table 7*

Shape Shift: 1/day may assume one of the following forms for the next 5 mins. While in a form the Draconian takes on their vague features and can only use unarmed combat as a weapon.
Wolf - 1st two blows of unarmed combat are now Thru PAC and 1 x Jump.
Bear - Thick Hide - grants 25% of physical weapon Blows.
Rat - Scurry - 1 x Physical Light Step, and 1x Illness (as per the potion by touch)
Beetle - Heavy Carapace - Immune to Backstab and 1/2 damage from behind
Fly - Walk on air @ Will for the duration.
Can buy extra shapeshifting innates at 60 points each, a max of 1/4 tables

The Forgotten Year - 799

What is written of this year is that nobody remembered it and that nobody was born or died. Until recently nothing of the cataclysmic events that occurred during it were known or understood. In the summer of IM1014 a group of mercenaries discovered that in the year 799 a being known a Tiumbre of Dreadstone, the Silent Prince, a sallow prince long thought dead had risen to power and assaulted the throne. Having almost died hundreds of years before at the hands of a group of other sallow princes called the Nuummite Ribbon he had secretly been gathering power and worship in preparation. His attack was barely stopped and even in his defeat he was only banished, lost and forgotten only to rear his head again some 215 years later, this time to be truly slain.

What was later learnt over the summer of IM1015, was just how terrible his assault was and how close to destroying the throne he came. At the end of 799, the High Matriarch, Margaret Daerk (Mistress of Primus) made her final stand against him inside the throne room, with her personal bodyguard beside her. Thousands upon thousands lay dead, cities were devastated or converted, Halgar was in ruins and behind her the throne cracked and bleeding. In a last desperate act she formed a huge convergence whereby 799 never happened, the dawn at the end of 798 became the dawn of 799 and as the year 800 dawned it became as if 799 never was. Nobody died, no children were born and only Margaret remembers and then barely.

That is, no children except a tiny minority; a tiny minority that became refugee orphans, children that were essentially never born, scattered across Primus. These children were foci of primal weakness and echoes of 799 spilled through around them. They were ruthlessly hunted down and killed only to continue to return from time to time throughout the years. A ritually empowered quartet, the Hand of the Matriarch were sent to ensure they remained dead. Unbeknown to anyone until the third age was that these children, these orphans who become adults who never aged and never truly died, were in fact all the sons and daughters of sallow blood, all the children of the nobles born in 799. It was their blood that refused to be forgotten, lost and discarded.

These children called themselves The Forgotten, sometimes the Silent. They remembered next to nothing of who they were and where they were from, save one, who tried to save them all, but most especially her twin. The one called Aria, the daughter of Margaret.

Whether the Forgotten live still is unknown, but no doubt some mercenaries might know the truth of these things and of the full story of the forgotten year.

System updates

It is now possible to start Forgotten Humans from this time that Primus have now remembered.

Forgotten Humans – As human in all ways, but are Noble Repidiare and the houses they were part of are forgotten. They are however "of the Blood". They calculate their base life as one level lower, but gain immunity to aging effects.

Gains at 4th Level - "Fade"- 1/4 levels, they may fade from sight, acting as per chameleon (including 5 minute duration), though no surface required. This will not hide the user from anyone who is immune to forget. Using this power costs 6 tblp.

Gained at 8th Level - "Forgotten" - 1/day they may fade from sight (as per the above) but may move at 1/2 speed and remain hidden. This costs 12 tblp..

However due to their lack of ties to modern day society cannot claim benefits from Social Guilds, and may only claim benefits from Political guilds 1 table later.

Frozen Tiger Tribe

Following the continued actions of the Church of the Lady of the Stars in aiding the Frozen Tiger tribe in the Far North, a number of the tribe-members have become increasingly integrated with the mercenary community, losing some of their initial wariness of outsiders.

Some of the more adventurous of the tribe have followed some of their new friends on their return to the Empire, and have continued to find work and adventure outside of their normal hunting grounds.

The notes below are what the Frozen Tigers would know, and not all of it would be public (for example how the previous Witch doctor died is not made public).

Totem: The Frozen Tiger

A sleek white tiger with black stripes. It stalks the lands hunting down those that would prey on the weak. Not a guardian, more a figure that strikes at those that deserve it.

Important people

Chief: Fury in the Storms. In his mid 30's the chief is a tall man. He has been the chief for 12 years, taking over from his father when he died. His is a stern but fair man, who enjoys the laughter and merriment of a good feast. He was one of the few that stood against the Toutatis when they sought to raid, and was more than willing to side with the Star lady's followers to fight them. He does not worship the Star Lady, but is happy to admit they have done much for his people, though he is concerned that the younger tribesmen may be forgetting the totem and its importance to the tribe.

Witchdoctor: Light on the Snow

Light became the Witch doctor at the beginning of 1009 when the previous one (Hadrak, Brightness in the Night Sky) died in a dream quest. It was a sad time, but Light had been serving as his apprentice for some time so they were well cared for. Light stands a clear 6ft and is big for a witch doctor, his bearded face leading many to believe he is actually one of the tribes warriors. He is very respectful of the worship of the Star lady and regularly attends the shrine, but does not profess to serve her himself, merely to offer thanks to her.

Shaman: Warmth of the Summer Sun

After a long search Warmth became the Shaman in Mai. It was a strange choice as the Shaman was normally an older woman or in times of war a man, but Fury had seen the bravery and courage of the woman within the Star Lady's followers so was willing to listen and be guided to her.

She is a young woman, but cares much for her tribe. She speaks with authority on matters of the spirits, and has rapidly grown in confidence since her appointment. However, some saw that her views are perhaps too extreme; indeed it was joked that she sounded like Sunshine in some of the things she said.

Germel:

While not important he has almost adopted the position of keeping the worship of the Tiger alive. He is grateful for the Star Lady's followers aid and all that they have done. However, with every month he grows more concerned that the younger tribesmen will forget about the totems teachings and indeed the totem and embrace this new Goddess. He ensures that the younger tribesmen are regularly told the tales of old and ensures that they do not forget where they have come from.

Daricus:

Or "the Crazy star man" as he is affectionately called by the tribe. He arrived in the Autumn of 1006 and spent the winter with the tribe. He was a priest of the Lady of Stars from Deci who had left to spread her word to the

tribes. He was never forceful; indeed, he just spoke of her ways and her songs. He helped tend to the sick and injured, and enjoyed a winter of laughter and merriment with the tribe. He touched some of their hearts, and a few even began offering thanks to the stars, though not worship. He left in the Spring to continue onwards. He said he would return if he could, though the tribe have never seen him again. They have been told he was captured by the Toutatis but has been rescued and is now recovering in the city of stars.

The Tribe and the Lady of the Stars

The tribe for the most part refer to her as "the Star Lady" because when people started explaining things to them they used various different names and the only thing they could agree on was that it was a She and that it involved Stars.

All of the tribe are grateful for the help given to them by the church fighting the Toutatis, and saving their way of life. There is a small shrine that is cared for by those in the village. Those that have embraced the faith are accepted by the tribe and few see anything particularly wrong with it.

The names of the several of the faithful are remembered by those within the tribe:

The Great Boozal (or Basil): the leader of the star lady's church, and a great champion Thomas: The secretive voice of the stars, whose words always hold great cryptic meaning. Falorn: The shouty lady that makes sure people do what they are told. Tanis: The champion in metal, who seems to have been hit on the head too many times. Ignatious: The man that makes the funny herb drink. Zhara: The strange woman with silly clothes that kept tidying the shrine. Bradley: The thief who you should be careful of. Especially as he does not know what heather is. Sunshine: To some an idiot that doesn't understand, to others a man with great insight that has inspired several of the younger tribesmen to the ways of the stars. Owen: A great hunter with a mighty bow.

Recent History

In the Summer of 1007 the landscape around the Frozen tigers changed. The Toutatis tribe had begun rising up against the other local tribes, forcing them to serve or be wiped out, and devouring their totems. This was heralded by a shooting red star, always an omen of doom. As the Winter began to set in the Toutatis came to all the tribes in turn – the Ice Eagles, the Wolves of Winter, the Kael Drak and the Frozen Tigers. They gave the tribe a simple option, summon their totem so it could be devoured and serve them, or die.

When the Tigers refused, Tarvak, the shaman of the Toutatis attacked and killed the Shelter of the Mother, the shaman of the Frozen Tigers. He then fought Fury and stabbed him with a dagger that broke within the wound. He left, giving the tribe a week to agree. It was a week later that the church of the Lady of Stars arrived for the first time. They were in time to save the tribe from the assaults of the Toutatis, and saved Fury from the dagger that was burrowing to his heart.

Over the next year and a half the tribe and the Church fought against the Toutatis and their allies, being aided by the Kael Drak tribe. After some time the Ice Eagle tribe were saved from the possessions placed on them by the Toutatis and joined with them. The Wolves of Winter were soon after that wiped out, though Hedrus their chief survived.

It was in the summer of 1008 that the Children of the Lost Lake tribe, a group of frost elves (though there are winter elves of the same name) were swayed away from the Toutatis. It is said that the two halves of the lost lake tribe have begun reconciling after years of war. Towards the end of 1008 the Toutatis were weakened enough to be drawn to final battle. The stories of what happened are many, and varied, however what is told is that the Church of the Stars slew the chief of the Toutatis and then hunted Tarvak into the Void and slew him there. The remnants of the Toutatis were slowly defeated over this time, and driven off. There was briefly a fear Tarvak had returned, but this was soon found to be a simple use of disguises and lies.

The Frozen Tigers, Kael Drak, and Ice Eagles are now beginning to rebuild their lives and prepare for what is to come in the future.

The lands of the tribes

North of the Empire, somewhere west of Alguz but further North the tribe's lands sit on the edge of the chilling fields. In the summer the land is a forest with lush trees and temperate climes. However, when winter comes the trees are laid barren quickly and a harsh wind comes over the area. It quickly becomes unsafe to travel above ground, and instead people moves through tunnels and ravines that criss-cross the area.

Little is different from other parts of the frozen north, except the area is inhabited by great fire worms, as they are sometimes called. These are strange creatures that sleep the winter through and then come out in the summer to hunt. They are a white colour, but their blood boils and burns causing their skin to be extremely hot. They burrow through the land hunting animals and anything else they can find to eat.

Members of the Frozen Tigers are human barbarians with the following benefits and restrictions: They must be goodly in alignment. They may be any non-priest class normally available to barbarians, or any priest subclasses (not shaman) or paladins. If they are a priest or paladin they must be part of the church of the Lady of Stars.

The Gallowglass Isles

The Chaos Wars towards the end of the Second Age

There was a vast ritual war that laid waste to what was then Primus in the First Age, which as we believe may have been smaller than the world we know now.

In many ways similar to the Choas Wars the power that flowed into/out of/through Primus was harnessed for the purpose of destruction between two forces. The population of Primus then was far lower than it is now and the nature of the world was greatly different. The invaders found those amongst the people of Primus who sided with them and used them to focus their power for the attainment of their goals. The conflict nearly tore apart Primus.

This Ritual War wrought great devastation upon the land to the extent that the powers used to fuel the great rites were being drawn from the very fabric of reality and the world was beginning to crumble. Despite this it seemed that at least some of those factions that fought were blind or uncaring of the destruction they were bringing to the world as they sought dominion over it and their enemies. With the very existence of reality in the balance the Laiu stepped in to protect creation.

What were the Laiu? Just as the people of Primus grew upon their continent the Laiu prospered upon that which is now the Ishmaic Confederacy. Central to this continent was the Nagrech Stone and it is this that the Laiu took to the centre of the troubles and it is this that they used to sunder the rites that spun about what is now the land of the Empire. They did not have long, they could not control it for long - but they bluffed. They acted as gods and since gods were at the heart of the conflict (the Primal and the Invader) their bluff worked.

The Laiu declared that the War would stop. Some listened, some did not, some saw their folly, some did not.

The Laiu forced a compromise upon the people responsible for the destruction - they made them face up to what they had done, they made them pay for every death and every day of woe that had been suffered for the people's arrogance, lust for power and sheer, bloody-minded ignorance. For them to remain on Primus they had to accept this and many did - these people became the Gallowglass Islanders.

Those who would not stop, the Laiu banished from our world. These banished beings became known as The Eth'Aderacht. They were exiled from Primus and were doomed to move about the Exostance never knowing peace or the sense of home or belonging. Their offspring would be few for only those who realised their error would produce child and they were an arrogant folk who would not accept the wrongness of what they had done. There were exceptions, but very, very few.

Legend says that there were a third group however, people of the tribes that had not fled. These were left with the Laiu and those that did not flee took upon themselves the task of ensuring that supernatural power would never more be random, never more thrash at the will or whim of people who failed to develop responsibility for what they possessed. In this they were opposed by the tribes whose outlook was that which had ultimately lead to the conflict. Those that took on this responsibility left the tribes and set off to stabilize Primus once and for all. Each one took his followers to a place where they could erect a Vandling Stone and these places in turn became the Cities that emerged from the 1st Age. Other stones were erected in order to flow the Primal power throughout the continent.

Those who saw what they had done was wrong and wished to make amends were exiled to a series of islands off the East Coast, the isles of the Gallowglass and they became known simply as The Gallowglass although in their exile they were left alone and over the centuries they undertook a penance to contemplate what they had done and, in the process, purified their souls. This process lasted a thousand years.

The Gallowglass are those penitent of the warmongers of the First Age. They were enlightened by the Laiu and saw the damage that their acts had caused. They accepted the judgement of the Laiu and put aside all thoughts, skills and arts of war to become peaceful, to dwell at the eastern edges of the world to be born and

reborn until such time as they had cleansed their souls of the stain of the evil they had committed. The Gallowglass were to suffer repeated life, between them they had to live as long as each of those they had caused to be killed - to suffer what they had suffered and to be as helpless as those they had used. They were to be aware of what was happening, trapped in a cycle of birth, death and persecution in between.

By the end of the Second Age, after a millennium of purgatory they had completed this and vanished, although not before The Eth'Aderacht had attempted schemes to use the now purified souls of their one-time kin to try and gain entrance to Primus. What has become of the reborn Gallowglass is as yet not widely known, if at all. Always pacifistic, the Gallowglass completed their penitence at the last Final Dawn. When the Thousand Souls (qv.) were released they combined with them to form a whole once more and the geas laid upon them by the Laiu was removed. Presently only the children are not 'blissed out', the more adult doing little else but sit around and enjoy the lack of pain and guilt that had been with them for many centuries.

Jurlle IM1011

Due to the actions of mercenaries the Gallowgalss Isles have been tied to Primus and brought in to the Realm of Glass under the protection of the noble house Be'Akris.

Age of Deities

Above all else reside Heidita and Piadoso, the mother and father God who watch over all people, plants, and animals of the Isles.

Those who lived upon the land grew in numbers and strength, but began to forget the teachings and forgot to give praise to Heidita and Piadoso. In Their wisdom they granted the Brae'Lan a great gift, the nine Dioscellio. Born as part of their race they grew up amongst them, but even from a young age tales were told of their strength and powers growing. At the age of twenty they left their family groups and claimed an island each for their own - so began the Age of Deities.

Each member of the Diocellio drew members of the Brae'lan to them and their island. Some were naturally drawn to one, others sought favours from and gave praise to many of them. For seventy years peace and happiness returned to the land above our homes but problems arose.

As the Diocellio grew in strength and followers, so they wanted more; the Gathering of Gods upon Juegos stopped and fights broke out amongst the followers. Within months this had escalated to full out war, breaking the links between the islands they had worked together to create and ruining much of the beautiful landscape of the Islands.

The Brae'lan were fearful of the wrath of the parent Gods, and ashamed of their actions. The elders gathered a great council and the decision was made to return to the ancient caverns and hibernate away until the Gods felt it was the right time to wake them.

In the beginning there were nine; one of war, one of redemption, one of protection, one of vengeance, one of voyage, one of opportunity, one of restoration, one of knowledge, one of dusk and dawn and they lived for play and for their followers.

As their individual followers grew the first nine fought for the popularity. What followed was a petty war, the closer they became to being the deity of their attribute the more dangerous the Isles became, drawing in the mists of the Mittlenacht and slowly weakening the Brae'lan.

On the Isle of Juegos the deities fought for 3 weeks trying to prove their worth of ascendancy. The power that the nine generated grew in to a dome over the Isle as a hue of many different colours, the Brae'lan grew fearful of the gods and the impact of their war and took to hibernation deep within the many caverns of the Isles. This caused the dome to implode banishing those within. Shards of each of first nine flew in to the void, the fall out from this created a tenth deity although unbeknown to him he was to ascend to bring peace and tranquillity back to the Brae'Lan.

Each shard that was thrown in to the void, with the power of the attribute they came from grew in to a being of its own, the being itself had no memory of what it was and what it came from.

Since the awakening of the young Brae'lan in Aiprus much has changed on the islands. When they awoke the Brae'Lan could sense that their home was floating and not belonging to anywhere in particular and much danger and threat could have taken advantage of the Brae'lan race and their home.

Comitaeus their current leader and head of the Brae'lan council was aware of the change that needed to come to pass so that their race, his people and their home could survive and be part of the world once more.

The actions of the following mercenaries brought about this change and have been commended and statues of them are erected on the island of Juegos representing thanks and gratitude for their persistence and dedication in aiding the Brae'lan save the islands and bringing about the full ascendancy of the deity of Brotherhood.

Kublai, Rufus, Elijah, Isiah, Jack Amora Halgari, Sim, Jack Spratt, Narstar, Sith-Tor, Pigsticker, Kieran, Brodie, Mara, Salts, Azazel, Able Pale, Jack Aldwick, Arconak and Kez.

Peace now reigns throughout the Gallowglass Isles and the Brae'lan have now a new God, the God of Brotherhood who unites and binds them as one large family. Comitaeus became no more and took his place as that of Brotherhood, the ashes of his mortal shell scattered among all of the islands. The seeds of friendship and camaraderie growing stronger as time passes, those that knew him mourn his mortal life and praise his seat in the heavens with Hedita and Piadoso.

THE BRAE'LAN

Native to the Gallowglass Isles, the Brae'lan have been long in hibernation since the Deities that they followed were destroyed through their conflicts with each other. They have recently woken from this long slumber due to a wash of power over the Isles.

The Brae'Lan as a race are extremely close to being tribal and tend to gather in small family numbers (though not necessarily related to each other). Many are unable to read, although some have been known to master the written word. Laws have never touched the race and neutral alignment is always a part of them. Brae'Lan follow the Gods of the Gallowglass as they know them and therefore currently do not have any religious links to the Gods known by the Empire.

The Brae'lan have pale skin, similar to the azure skies that are always present over the Gallowglass isles. Their skin is covered in markings – similar looking to tattooed skin, made up of elemental colours (fire, air, earth and water). The element that an individual is most closely linked to is reflected by the majority of these markings. Some, but not all, have tails which are thin and long. Their ears are often pointy, but not always and some may have different coloured eyes.

NOTE – Brae'lan stats are listed here for reference for those that are already in existence. **It is not currently standardly possible to start a Brae'lan if you did not play or monster the themeday about them.**

Brae'lan Invoker

This class is only available to the Brae'lan, and combines magical skills with limited martial prowess.

Life: As Human Warrior Priest
Mana: Level Squared (e.g. 1 mana at level 1, 25 at level 5 and 64 at level 8)
Skills: As wizard, including metal restrictions

Invokers must choose either fire, air, earth or water as their primary colour of magic, and they are able to cast spells as per a wizard of that colour. Additionally, Invokers gain 2 specialist slots per elemental colour that is not their main colour, which may be filled as per a normal wizard. They may cast red, green, blue and brown magic despite normal opposites restrictions. They gain all handbook grey glyphs up to 4th level, although they may never learn any grey glyphs beyond these. They may never use magic (even via item) that isn't elemental (red, green, brown, blue) or grey 1st to 4th.

Invokers progress post 8th as a 1st Class Wizard. Should they purchase additional specialist slots,

Brae'lan may be warriors, archers, warrior priests, spirit warriors, pathfinders, leywalkers, druids, psi-masters or invokers (see below for details of invoker). Brae'lan gain all abilities/restriction as per a human of their class, except that they gain life one level below their own (e.g. warrior = 66/22@8th, pathfinder = 44/15@8th).

Brae'Lan have full spirits and are flesh and blood creatures.

Brae'Lan alignments are such that they must always have a neutral element to them (NG, NN, NE, NC).

Brae'Lan may not currently join guilds within the Empire, although they may be in guilds specifically for Brae'lan.

Due to their long hibernation and lack of formal "modern" education, Brae'lan are unable to read or write any language bar Ancient (1st age) – although many are able to read and write ancient (player may choose whether they can read ancient or not, for free). This does mean that, currently, they are unable to write or use scrolls, teaching scrolls or scriptures.

They gain +1 racial DAC @ 2nd level, and +2 racial DAC @ 4th level. Brae'lan must choose an elemental colour to be aligned to (fire, air, earth or water) and @ 6th level they gain a "Draw upon the Elements" innate, which requires 30 seconds concentration to use and provides a single casting of a handbook spell of their chosen colour of up to 6th level.

Brae'lan are an agile and dexterous race, and as such will not wear heavy armour. The limits to armour are: Warriors and Spirit Warriors may wear up to studded leather; Archers and Warrior Priests may wear up to stiff leather; Pathfinders, Leywalkers and Druids may wear up to soft leather; Invokers and Psi-

Update: All Brae'Lan can now read common language as well as Ancient script.

Costume - Brae'Lan are natural creatures and as such wear natural cloths that don't appear to extravagantly made or finely finished, this can include some silks of a sort in simple hues and plain designs.

All of the following are abilities granted by the Diocello for the Brae'Lan race. At the beginning of each day the Brae'Lan can align themselves to a Diocello granting them gifts. At 8th level a Brae'Lan may choose one Diocello to follow, and this must be chosen at the beginning of the day. At 250pts past 8th a Brae'Lan may, for 50pts, choose a second Diocello to follow, and these must be chosen at the beginning of the day. At 1000pts a Brae'Lan may, for +75pts, choose a third Diocello to follow, and these must be chosen at the beginning of the day. On extended length dungeons, different Diocello may be chosen each day as desired, but appropriate prayers/rituals must be performed at the beginning of each day.

At 1500pts past 8th for a cost of 100pts they can double the innates (the first two benefits from the Diocello, not the third @will/permanent benefit) from one of their Diocello chosen at the beginning of the day. This ability may be purchased again for each Diocello chosen at the beginning of the day (max 3 total). Any given Diocello may only be doubled once.

<u>Sujeito – Diocello of War</u>
Grants a 25% rage 1/day, (as per warrior specialist skill). Additionally, if used with another 25% rage innate upgrades to a 33% rage.

War Cry 1/day

Life now calculated as 8th level – invokers gain an additional LOL. (e.g. 42/16 @ 8th)

Amparo – Diocello of Protection

Knockback, Knockdown or Stunning Blow 2/day.

1/day Stand and Die as per En Guard.

Use armour one class higher.

Sabedoria – Diocello of Knowledge

1/day Awaken skill but magically based.

1/day magical Comm 2.

Ability to read languages (this WILL allow invokers to read magical scrolls and priests to use normal spirit scrolls)

Viaje – Diocello of Voyage

1/day Lightstep (with vocals, no damage casting)

1/day Blink (with vocals, no damage casting) however may take a willing or unconscious person for 6TBLP.

All published magical transportation effects are increased by 50% distance. i.e. Blinks, (where you

Erlosung – Diocello of Redemption

4/day Erlosung's blessing – offers no AC bonus, has the effects of a "remove fear and paralysis" miracle, if cast upon a spiritually mastered creature it will free that creature of the spiritual mastery. In all other ways it has a duration of only 5mins.

1/day may resist any dying effect as per published resistance.

Immunity to alignment change and gains Enhanced Rebirth, if Enhanced Rebirth is owned then gains Fated Hero.

Herstel – Diocello of Restoration

1/day +1 med rate or aware med chosen at the beginning of the med. If aware med is already owned this ability may upgrade to greater aware med (lasts duration of meditation to a max of 3 hours).

1/day gains Herstels gift - this acts as per a trolls blood potion, this may be used by self or given to others. Requires 30 seconds concentration to activate.

Regen as per Troll.

Avondval – Diocello of Dusk and Dawn

1/day Shrouding - with 30 secs prep becomes immune to all info fx for 5mins.

2/day Twilight (vocals needed, no life).

Gains detect magic (full verbals, costing 1 TBLP). If already possesses ability, may with 30secs prep cast improved detect magic.

Rancoro – Diocello of Vengeance
1/day Adrenal Surge, only usable after an "ally" has been killed or incapacitated.

1/day Reflect a ranged handbook miracle or spell (this would include wings of darkness or similar add ons to a handbook spell or miracle).

Gains an Avenging Spirit. If already owned upgrades to enhanced avenging spirit

Mojilighet – Diocello of Opportunity
1/day Lucky Idea as per tables.

2 temp batches of any standard basic or intermediate potion.

Gains Resilience as per Scout without the need for pre-req's (eg. takes only 2/3 damage from triggered traps, cumulative with any other similar skills such as trap wary). Does NOT need to have Make

Additionally, all Brae'lan are able to enhance their natural magical aptitude. On Table 8 (1000pts), for a cost of 40pts, they can extend their ability to draw upon the elements such that they are able to cast a single handbook glyph of their chosen racial colour of up to 8 level (from 6th). On table 10, for +40pts, they are able to extend this further such that they can cast any handbook glyph from their chosen racial colour.

They may purchase additional "draw on element" innates at a cost of 80pts – they may buy 1 per 2 tables post 9th they have achieved.

The Islands of the Gallowglass

There are many islands that make up the Gallowglass Isles, many of them yet unexplored or even unnamed they all are quite tropical in nature and contain many plants and beasts not found any where else. Some of the islands have a significant theme and what the island is home to can reflect that. Mystical transport by normal means is not yet possible between the islands yet there are circles of stones that will allow transport between them. There are also bridges that can provide a walk way to get to other islands, being under the control of the Ancient Trolls on the island of Flaya.

Details of some of the main islands are below.

Juegos – The central home island of the Brae'lan and its council meeting place.

Gallow – Home to the main pack of Eranoso (bear-like creatures), in coastal villages there are human settlements.

Eruptus – Made up of a large volcano.

Veanya – Known locally as the island of storms for they continually swirl around the island. Was once home to the Diocello of Voyage.

Flaya – Home to the Ancient Trolls island of many rivers and bridges criss-crossing over it.

Quetos – Once home to the Diocello of Knowledge. The rock itself on this island lends itself well to the making of statues and golems many of which still remain here.

Orun – Once home to the Diocello of Opportunity and his presence can still be felt here.

Galas – Many Brea'lan make pilgrimages to this island for it was once home to the Diocello of Redemption.

Dawnica – Depsite its central location dawn always arrives here first and is the last place for the sun to set. This probably being the reason that the Diocello of Dusk and Dawn chose it for his home.

Cayos – Sea serpents roam around the coastline of this island, once the pets of the Diocello of Vengeance whose weather worn shrine still stands upon the island. Many caverns run underneath this island leading down to underground shores.

Juntos – Rarely seen upon this island the Giants of the Gallowglass reside here, many of the beasts are larger here too. Dotted across the island many marble pillars can be seen.

Shell – Made up of many shells that over time have created the island, giant crabs can be seen upon it by anyone approaching.

Yvanca – Peace and tranquillity reign here, surrounding the altar at the centre of this island, once home to the Diocello of Restoration.

Metea – Crashing waves surround the coasts of this island making near impossible to approach by boat. Here lie the ruins of the fortress of the Diocello of Protection.

Ipanna – The landscape is tinged with red from the many battles that have been fought here when the Diocello of War made it his home.

Flora & Fauna

Some of the Beasts and Plants of the Gallowglass Isles as told by the Brae'Lan:

Pteros

The pteros live in caves all over our islands, although they are often hard to find, they sleep during the day inside dark caves or hollow trees and come out at night to hunt. They let out a high pitch shriek to communicate to each other, the females being louder then the males. They are scavengers, looking to feed off the dead rather then hunt for themselves.

Liensis

These creatures hunt in packs and tend to swarm and capture even large creatures by corning and outnumbering them. They have excellent smell and hearing which they use to stalk their prey from afar. Their claws are strong and sharp, ripping through flesh easily

Spray Fly

The spray fly is a more an irritant than a danger, although they often come in large swarms. They feed off the blood of animals or Brea‟lan alike. Their bite itches for days.

Tijereta

Despite how dangerous the claws on the Tijereta look they are not overly dangerous to us. They use them to scrape the fungus and spores off of walls and the trunks of trees, their favourite of which seems to be Hongo. These creatures can grow up to the height of a Brea‟lan and have a thick armoured back. Despite this when threatened they can sprint really fast, clearing a path through the undergrowth as they go. They tend to spit covering things in a slime, we would advise that anyone should move out of the way.

Hongo

These spores grow very fast and extremely quickly due to the damp environment, this type of plant is much like a fungus and like everything must vie for its food, this can sometimes be old and dying Largato or the smaller insects that like the damp environment that the caves provides. To gorge on their prey the spores lash out with gas and liquid which help decompose the flesh, bone and exoskeleton of animals and insects alike.

Podadera

All types of spores inhabit caves either for the damp environment or the caves provides the darkness that the spores need to flourish and grow along with the added fact that unsuspecting creatures that can

provide nutrition for them can get caught in the dark. This spore is very leaf like and grows over the sides of the cave and about half way up the walls. The leaves are very robust and thick and have very sharp edges which can slice in to flesh, the vines that they grow on can lash out about the length of a Brea'lan away from where it is on the floor/wall, which can be devastating if several lash out at once.

Lianas

A thick green plant that grows flat across surfaces, at first glance it looks fine to walk across but as you do it will shift and twist under foot causing you to trip and then before you can even stand it will wrap itself around you pinning you to the plant till you die, your rotting body then giving it good to grow.

Largato

These beasts can be very aggressive dependant on the time of day, if its hot then they are likely to have bundles of energy and be quite alert. The Lagarto have extremely powerful legs and tails and at their peak can strike very fast. They can stand very briefly on their back legs to strike an opponent. They live in small family groups and are more often then not the most dominant creature within the jungles that they make their home.

The Crabs of Shell Island

The top of the carapace is yellow with red, brown, or purple flecks. The bottom of the carapace is either white or yellow. The carapace is generally oval in shape, and the sides are somewhat triangular. A key characteristic of this crab is the set of nine teeth on each side of the carapace. Like most crabs, it has five pairs of walking legs, but the first pair is a set of pincers which are used for feeding and defence. Unlike others however when in danger it rises on two legs and attacks with its deadly pincers.

House D'treal and the Isle of the Dragons

As the Dawn of 1012 ended and 1013 began the rituals carried out by Lucius completed and his lands were drawn fully to primus, and his house and titles recognised. Settling off the West coast of the Empire, near Eldith, they reside on a large Island called The Isle of Dragons. The Island is large, but not huge. Having several small and one main settlement, the Island is not densely populated.

Wild Port – The only port on the Island, and the main settlement. It is home to maybe 200 people. The estates of House D'treal sit just outside it. With the recognition of the lands within the Empire Milly, priestess of the Dead Heroes and member of the 13th Imperial Legion was appointed as Squire.

Fort Fallen Claw – Set watching over the sea approach the old fort as designed warn of incursions by Sea, or Air. While no longer manned as it once was there is still a small guard there. The title, Baron of Fort Fallen Claw, has been passed the Andric, High priest of the Dead heroes.

Pine Lake – Set in the North West of the island a reasonable size lake amidst a Pine forest. Previously the hunting grounds for the distinguished on the islands the title of Baron has been given to Marcus Blunt, and the Blunt House has declared vassalage to House D'treal while they continue their work to re-establish their family name.

The Dragons Gate – A set of caves upon the Island that lead deep into the earth. It is here that the hatcheries of the Houses Dragons were found in the decades gone by. Now they sit empty, waiting to be filled a new. The Squire of Dragon's Gate being David Stone.

Knights of the Isle of the Dragons – The ancient order of knights that served house D'treal, recognised now by the Empress as equivalent of Knights of the Empire. Lucius has begun work to rebuild the order, appointing Zohir and Garrick as members and Knights.

The Future - Where House D'treal will go from here is unclear. The Island is large enough to be expanded upon, or the mainland coast is made up of the unclaimed broken lands of the tribes. What is clear is that it will take time for the Nobility to accept the House, especially as it appears Lucius, despite being a Melnibaneon, is a noble of the blood.

Players may now start Ancient Folk of House D'treal. These are as normal ancient folk except: They must take the Noble Exhumanitus status (as per Evolution Races). They are not outlawed by race, but lose one 1st to 8th pact slot which is automatically filled with "Pact with Glass" at tables costing no points. Retainer to the House may be purchased as with any noble house

The Land of Legend

"Legend" and the events that have occurred there is closely linked with the Knights of the Land – and has been for the best part of two decades (if not longer).

The original campaign was run by Stave Dangerfield, and saw a varied world with more than one NPC faction that could be played off against one another. Several years after the initial plot line finished Hoz ran a two year campaign there for the Knights of the Land, drawing on the remains of the old campaign and creating new plots to follow. Finally, Mark Cox and Lee Dale, took up the baton to continue the tradition of the knights dying in Legend.

There are a variety of places and people within the land, too many to cover in full without a book of their own.

Haven

The city of Haven has stood for decades within Legend. It served as a bastion against Krondels Mist in the early years of the Knights of the Land, and then became the centre of the ideal of Legend. A place where Knights would gather before departing on errantry, where the Wyrmkin of Light could find safety and offer protection to those within.

The city is now home to anyone that wishes to reside here, providing they are willing to follow the ideals of the city. The markets of the city often contain lost treasures from across the Land, and the Taverns are filled with stories of heroic deeds and great battles from across Legend.

Within the centre of the city is the compound where Imrazil resides. While he remained here for many years in seclusion he is now seen to walk the city on occasion, though always accompanied by at least one of the virtues. There is only one set of gates to this part, and it is always guarded by the White Wyrm Guardians of Haven, and those that are allowed in are carefully checked before entering.

The Virtues

The Virtues are individuals that embody the ideas of being a Legendary Hero. Each has travelled across the land righting wrongs, and serving the people. They all live up to the ideals of the Knights vows and of what it means to be a champion of light. While there is some confusion over them, due to manipulations of time by the Knights of Dark Renown, specifically Scaflow, it seems Legend has preserved them and they know reside in Haven, serving the people and leading the Knights of the Land within Legend.

It could be said that the Virtues resemble the Primal Forces of Primus, embodying a specific purpose and ideal. The present virtues are:

Chastity – Lord Damodred: The Lord Warmage and Knight Ritualists of Legend, he is a skilled warrior calling upon the spirits of light. He is particularly apt at summoning Angels and Banishing Demons.

Temperence – Sister Grendle: The Lord Templar of Legend. She is a calm and composed priest, who always keeps a calm head in battle. Trained in various martial techniques she is capable of defending herself if the need arrives.

Charity – Simony: The Voice of Legend Simony is a priest of moderate skill. Her ability to work potent blessings and banish curses is heard off throughout the land. Many talk of her heritage as Gypsy, it seems her family travelled her along the ways that lead into Legend, seeking safety form some forgotten evil.

Diligence – Michele: The Lord of watch, she is a quiet woman. While small is stature she carries great power within her; the spirits of light. She is a servant of St Michael and the Creator. Indeed, during a pilgrimage to seek insight into her faith her eyes have been taken as with many of her faith and replaced with the sight of her lord.

Patience - "King" Husk: King Husk was the leader of all the Tribes of Legend, all chiefs follow his words. However, in recent years the tribes split and his power has waned. He managed to bring them all together through years of talking, and diplomacy. His patience meant that an impossible dream became a reality. Even now if he called it is likely the tribes would answer. He serves as the current Lord of Battle.

Kindness- Rekkard Drekkar: The current Lord Unity. A quiet and unassuming man. He listens to those with problems and tries to help them. He is always willing to help where he can, thinking of others first and himself a distant third, or even fourth.

Humility- Casabian: The current Lord Knight within Legend. He is a master of the blade, and wields a Silver sword taken from a Gythanki that he defeated in a duel, though no one can actually remember the duel happening or what lead to it, just that he obtained the sword that way. He is wise and never assumes he knows the best, always listening to others when the time permits, however when the choice has to be made he makes it, not because he wishes to but it is his duty to serve the knights and do so.

There is talk of an 8th and 9th Virtue. While the first seven remember the 8th, they can never place him fully. As for the 9th none of them have heard of it, but Imrazil is certain they exist.

Justice – Believed to be a man called Ultare. Damodred seems to remember him being his squire and as his quest of errantry going to slay a dragon, but no one can remember more than this.

Purity – Unknown to all of the Virtues. Some think it is just a concept and that no one truly embodies it. Others say that in becoming the virtue the person simply ceased to be, as they found living in the world impossible. In any event none can be certain of anything.

Priests of the Virtues

A small group is forming within Haven, where priests are beginning to worship the virtues as embodiments of ideals and aspirations. While the Virtues do not offer power those that live up to these ideals are watched by the spirits of light and find them easy to manipulate.

It is now possible to start priests of the Virtues of Imrazil.

These must be goodly in alignment. They may design a miracle list as per a hermit priest.

The priests must select a virtue they are tied to when started, and are bound by the oath of virtue relevant to it. The virtues being listed above.

To break this oath causes the individual to immediately suffer a black mark. Referees should judge the characters harshly.

If the priest is under a black mark (for any reason) they lose the ability to cast goodly miracles above 4th level until it fades.

If they, through their own actions, cease to be goodly they are instantly excommunicated losing access to all miracle on their list.

It is possible for individuals to buy ley (and devout) believer to a virtue, and should they do so, they are bound by the oath as a priest.

They may be any priestly class even those that cannot traditionally have their own lists.

For further details of these Virtues it is suggested that you search "Seven Heavenly Virtues" via Wikipedia

The Ways

Legend appears to have a criss-cross of supernatural paths that run across it. Those that have been taught, or that have some natural talent, can find the entrances to these. While some confuse them with the Mittlenacht paths of Primus they are distinctly different. Who crafted them, or how they came to be is unclear, but their use cannot be denied. They allow those individuals with the will to travel rapidly across the land, reaching places days away in hours, if not minutes.

The ways themselves however are very susceptible to the changes within Legend. It was on these most of the Demons gathered when the Myst existed, and it is these that have felt the biggest changes due to the shifting nature of the Realm spirit. At present they are guarded by the Air Wyrms, though their presence is not always seen it is there. Watching and ensuring they are not used to bring harm to the Land.

Not everyone can use the Ways, some believe it is the force of will required to walk them, other that there is an almost unseen strain that only the brave and powerful can resist. In any event the ways have become a common part of life for the Knights within Legend, and it is likely any other mercenary group that travelled there would find them of equal use.

Castle Point

A fort held by the Knights of the Land. It holds the portal that leads to Mordreds Rest on Primus, and so it is desired by many. It is currently commanded by Sir Blo‟unt, a skilled warrior and tactician. He has held command over several smaller outposts before earning his position at Castle Point. He has worked closely with the Knights on Primus to ensure that they are protected and Castle Point can‟t be used to launch attacks onto Primus, and vice versa.

The Wyrm Kin

Born years ago, these creatures are descended from potent Dragons. Some say they may even be children of the mana dragons themselves but this seems unlikely. They are vaguely human in appearance, with scales rather than skin. As they age some grow wings or even a tail, and it is not uncommon for them to grow claws or the like with time.

While this has not always been the case they are, at present, a noble people sworn to protect Legend. With the upheaval and changes over the past few years in Legend something seems to have stirred within their hatcheries. Many of the older Kin have died, or can no longer be found. The younger seem to have all been touched by the presence of the Virtues within Legend and tend to follow the path of light.

There are six distinct types of Wyrm Kin.

The White Wyrms

These creatures have white skin and tend to live within the City of Haven. Their numbers tend to follow one of two paths, either joining the Haven guard or heading out into Legend to seek out Evil and protect the people from the dangers that lurk in the darkness.

The Red Wyrms

These creatures strangely seem to live on an Island off the Coast of Legend. No one is sure how it is they came to live there, or indeed what happened to the rest of their kind. All of the Red Wyrmkin recently hatched (within the last 3 years) but have grown rapidly and developed at an unnatural rate. They are by their nature predisposed to fire, but this has been tempered by a concern for the people not often seen in their kind.

The Blue Wyrms

These noble creatures have sworn oaths to guard the ways, and to ensure they remain safe for travellers. They monitor those travelling them to ensure they are not seeking to use them to bring harm to Legend or its people. They are fierce warriors, and often when engaged in combat will not back down even if it means death. People often speak of them purging entire groups from the ways by slowly walking forward unleashing a potent breath of lightning against their enemies.

The Brown Wyrms

Living deep in tunnels beneath the surface of Legend these souls are rarely seen by others. Those that are tend to be stoic and sombre. They speak of a great duty being placed on their people, but cannot remember what it was, or if it has been performed, they just know they must be ready to perform it when the time is needed.

The Green Wyrms

These creatures live in the caves off the coasts of legend. They spend much of their time diving through the waters, protecting the ships that sail along the coast. It is not uncommon to see them moving along coastal territories or even further in land. Unlike most of their kind the Green Wyrm kin seem to be caught up in the future, perhaps the Seas of legend offering some insight other do not know. Or maybe the pull of the moon on the seas is strong and they are touched by its power?

The Black Wyrm

An oddity within the kin of magic. The Black Wyrmkin live within haven, though are small in number. Almost all of their kind are in the service of Imrazil or the Virtues. They are very pious creatures, and believe they have much to atone for because of their peoples actions in the past. They number against the bravest of the Wyrmkin, and often strive out across Legend to hunt down the hidden dangers of the years gone by to vanquish them.

It is possible to play Wyrm Kin from the last hatching. These can be started like any other character. They are as humans except for the following:

1) Must have draconic/scale like makeup. The colour should be appropriate to their colour.

2) They are limited in the classes they can be, which are: Wizard (Of the same colour as their Draconic nature), Warlock (again the same colour), Warrior, Cavalier, Power Warrior of the Jewel, Spirit Warrior (of the virtues faith only at this time), Paladin (again only of the Virtues at this time).

3) They may only be goodly in alignment at this time. However Black Wyrm Kin can still be wizards, but they loose access to all black spells relating to poison.

4) May buy Elven innates as a half elf of their draconic colour, +50% cost (they gain no other half elven buy as).

5) Must pay double cost for all armour as it must be specifically made for them.

6) Intermediate and advance guild tiers count as being 1 table higher (EG 4 for intermediated and 9 for advance) and cost 75pts for intermediate and 100pts for advanced.

7) They are not from Primus, their home plane is Legend, should this be relevant ever.

The Lexicon of Creation

The Lexicon of Power

In order to use this item the individual must have the specific prop for it. In order to use the item an individual must have the ability "Understanding of the Lexicon" below.
The book has 12 power in it that can be used to fuel "Words". This regenerates at 1 per 15 minutes.
To speak a word the person must have purchased the ability to do so below, to buy a word the person must have the book, show the GSM/Chris Andrews (Tiffer) where in the book the word is and then spend the points. Learning a word may have specific consequences, however they won't "overcast" or similar.
Speaking a word uses power from the book equal to its cost. If the book does not have enough power to fuel the word the user dies and the word fails.
If a person spends 30 seconds reading the text on the word and focusing on the book the cost of the word is reduced by 1 (minimum 1)
The book is indestructible (including negation and similar) and never blows up.

Abilities

Understanding the Lexicon - Requires read languages to purchase.
This allows the individual to use the "Lexicon of Power" and to learn Words and abilities related to it.
Evil characters cannot learn words marked goodly, nor can those that use evil spirits (except grey wardens).
Goodly characters cannot learn words marked Evil, nor can those that use goodly spirits (except grey wardens).
Cost: 50 points, or 20 points post 6th Scholar.

Channel the power: From above.
The character can now use words when the book is out of power/does not have sufficient power without dying. For every point of power the book is short the character loses a level of resistance until they have a good night's rest/use a supreme sacrifice or similar. Levels of resistance must be permanent levels not temp ones. If a character reaches 0 levels of resistance then they die and the word fails.
Cost: 50 Table: 9

Dragons Whispers: This allows a character to turn a spoken word mantic (white mana for goodly words, Grey for Neutral, and Black for Evil words). This doubles the cost of the word before reductions from prepping it.
Cost: 50 Table 10

Mastery of Words: When prepping a word using the book the reduction is increased to:
1 off words that cost a base of 6 or less, 2 off 7-12, and 3 off 13+
Cost: 50 Table 9

Use of Relics: Allows the individual to use relics to fuel Words. It should be noted relics are not easy to obtain, they can be located via CC contracts and provide a different amount of power based on their nature. When applying for the contract you should state the word you are looking to locate a relic that is suitable for.
Cost: 50 points Table 10

Hidden Power: The individual knows hidden secrets in the book to draw on power. As such the first word spoken in any 15 minute period costs 1 power less. This stacks with the book, and mastery of the words, but applies after Dragons whispers. (EG a 7 power word using the books base reduction and dragons whispers costs 12 power then this reduction).
This cannot reduce a word to below half its original cost.
Cost: 50 points, 2nd purchase 100 points, 3rd 150 points, etc.
The ability can be purchased once per table.

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The Words

Understanding the Lexicon is required to purchase any of the following abilities. Immunity to holy/unholy word applies, as do other relevant immunities (EG Non-published dispelling effects, Bar Spirit etc.)

Basic Words

These words cost 0pts each. Unless noted there is no other requirement beyond showing the word to the GSM/Chris Andrews (Tiffer)

Word	Effect	Power	Notes
Benediction 1	As published benediction holy word.	7	
Healing 1	As published Healing holy word.	7	
Dismissal 1	As published dismissal holy word.	7	
Communication 1	As published comm holy word.	7	
Force 1	As published force holy word.	7	
Warding 1	As published warding holy word.	7	
Causing 1	As published causing unholy word.	7	
Dominion 1	As published dominion unholy word.	7	
Necromancy 1	As published necromancy unholy word.	7	
Death 1	One target within 20ft suffers a Touch of Death. No protection is required and the caster suffers level loss as normal.	8	Requires a make slot to learn
Life 1	One target within 10ft is restored to life and fully healed via the Restore Life miracle. No protection or candles are required and the caster suffers level loss as normal (Can't be reduced below 1 level).	12	Requires a make slot to learn

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Advanced Words

These words require all require a make slot to be used at the desk including loss of a level. As with the basic words you are required to show the word you wish to learn to the GSM/Tiffer. You must already know the basic word to learn these.

It should be noted that this is not an exhaustive list - there are words that are not listed below which you may attempt to learn.

Word	Effect	Power	Points	Notes
Benediction 2	Retroactive Shield Against the Dark. Must be declared within 2 seconds c.f. Warcry	12	50	
Healing 2	One word Total heal (self only), still capped at 72/72 unless prepped	12	50	
Dismissal 2	Mass Dismiss 5	12	50	
Communication 2	Greater Communication	12	50	
Force 2	Speaker benefits from a Pure Force. May be used retroactively as per the miracle.	12	50	
Warding 2	Bar Spirit vs one target with 20ft, in a 6ft radius around the target, does not move from that spot.	12	50	
Causing 2	Mass Cause Grievous within 60ft, Caster is cured 60/60	12	50	
Dominion 2	One target suffers a 7 Word VOP. Effects 8th and below targets.	12	50	
Necromancy 2	As per twist the form from Vessel of the Dead.	12	50	
Death 2	Mass Slayer on all dead bodies within 60ft.	12	100	
Life 2	Speaker becomes Immune to Causing for 5 minutes.	18	100	
Time 1	Gains tempo of battle for 1 effect (can be supernatural)	12	75	
Time 2	All ongoing effects on the speaker reach their duration	18	100	
Magic 1	Target suffers +33% effect from one colour of magic	12	75	
Recreation	Supreme Sacrifice (self or willing target)	10	50	
Power	Act of Faith, max 1 running at a time and can't be ended early.	18	100	
Destruction	The effect is only found out when learnt	0	0	
Creation	The effect is only found out when learnt	1000	0	

Magefold Mount

Magefold mount is a small settlement that sits about halfway between Bildteve and Sellaville (or Seval as it was then). It isn't anything special. It was nominally part of Seval and was ruled by a Wizard (who was of the blood) called Jerome Bythorn. The village was formed sometime in the 600's around a simple hill that wizards would travel to and enact rituals. The community around would provide shelter for them, ritual components, and food. Over time the wizards stopped as the power faded, and the village just became a normal village. Having been allowed to settle and replenish it was later in the 800's when Jerome realised the mount had power again, so claimed leadership and as the age turned (from the 800's to the 900's) Jerome cast a powerful ritual (the once every hundred years sort) and created a tablet of power, which had Magefolds place spirit bound to it. He used this for various things, and shaped it to his own ends.

The two rival magocracies of Seval and Kessleharn both heard of this and sent ambassadors to speak with Jerome to convince him to join their side and allow them to use the tablet. However, he refused both offers. Eventually frustrated with his refusal both sides launched assassination attempts to kill him and steal the tablet; these failed.

So, they both decided the only option was to take them by force, and sent forces to attack the village. This occurred towards the end of 909. Both groups arrived at approximately the same time, and while setting up for an assault on Magefold they detected each other, and began to engage the other side in conflict. The associated ritualists began to unleash rituals and the entropy began to build. The battle was brutal, and within a week of beginning both sides had been significantly weakened, however with the bodies mounting the Kessleharn forces were growing in strength with undead.

Sensing the danger, the lead Sevalian ritualist cast his last rite to banish the Keslseharnian undead rites. This was successful, but in doing so also banished the place spirit of Magefold into the 'nacht.

The two forces held position, neither with enough strength to claim victory, but neither willing to withdraw and hand it to the other. As they wait for reinforcements the year turned, and without it's place spirit Magefold fell into the nacht to become a secondal realm.

Jerome, realising the danger of the nacht enacted a ritual around the area to hold the worst of it at bay. He designed it to create a barrier around the entire village that could only be lowered for a short period at a time, and could only be fully removed by the spirit of Magefold while on Primus.

While none of the three groups (the Sevalians, the Kessleharn forces, and the people of magefold) were happy they decided to live as best they could.

Each chose a different part of the villages lands to reside in, and waited till they could return to primus. The Sevalians occasionally raided the forces of Kessleharn to keep their numbers low, and the Kessleharnians would seek to steal the bodies of dead villagers and Sevalians.

And the years passed. Sons become fathers and grandfathers and died. The original people have all long since died. Each group passing on its version of the truth to their descendants, but all have passed on the need to avoid an outright war.

60 years into entrapment the Kessleharn forces said they no longer trusted the other parties. Knowing that the realm spirit was bound to the Tablet they demanded that the tablet was broken into three pieces so each group could care for one, and ensure that when they could return to primus the villagers did not leave them behind. The villagers refused this, but the Seval forces quickly agreed, and threatened to work with the kessleharn forces to take the tablet by force.

So Jerome's son, Steven, enacted a simple ritual to split the table into three pieces and gave a part to each faction.

And the years became decades, and an age. Over the last dawn the world weakened, and demons began to flock to primus. One group, strange demons of shadow and the mind who already had a foothold on Primus, began to seek any avenue they could. They soon found that it would be easier to use secundal realms to enter via, returning them to Primus. So with time they found out about Magefold Mount and have sent a small force there. The force then used the weakness within Primus to draw Magefold mount back to Primus, while also keeping the link to their realm open, giving them a chance to enter primus in greater numbers.

It was in mid-1013 that the inquisition sensed magefold mounts arrival and sent the Catskinners to investigate. After many trials the guild managed to destroy both the forces of Kessleharn and Seval that remained there, seal away the Demons, and reform the place spirit to return Magefold mount to Primus.

The last leader, William, was slain by "the Ships Anchor" a strange golem that served the black dragon. The people now look to Bede of the Catskinners for guidance and leadership until someone else can be found.

Magefold Characters:

May only be human, and may not be evil. Characters must start as Warrior or Scout Subclasses, but can later enter other brackets.

Due to their distance from Primus from years they may not join any political guilds, and may only belong to Catskinners as a Social guild.

However due to their life hardened by the mittlenacht and the fact they survive the mental demons assaults they calculate their life as one level higher (CF Ishmaics) and Gain psionic retardation for free.

Mourat

The realm of Mourat is an island, thick with jungle and thrumming with life. Practically everything there has teeth, claws or venom, even many of the plants. Beasts abound in the jungle, from thunder wyrms with lightning coursing around their thick hides and claws to swarms of bees that lay their eggs under the skin of their unfortunate victims.

Through the centre of the island from south west to north east is a chain of towering mountains, very much out of place compared to the low-lying jungle that fills the rest of the land. In the heart of the island itself is a massive volcano, and though it has not spat fire within living memory the earth still shudders and shifts occasionally as the spirit of the Volcano restlessly turns within, waiting for the moment to unleash his fury.

Surrounding the land are crystal clear azure seas, thronging with fish, sharks and all sorts of oddities. Though competent fishermen, the people never dare venture more than a few miles from shore for fear of what might seek to eat them.

Life on Mourat is a day to day challenge of avoiding being eaten by the things that surround the few settlements there. At day, the thick jungle is barely penetrable and hugely dangerous. Only a madman would venture out at night, and not even his bones would be found in the morning.

The island lies in the archipelago of islands between Bildteve and Ishma, well south of the main shipping lanes. However, the main means of transport used to reach the Empire was the mystical Sun Gate, which links Mourat to the Golden Quarter of Scarlene.

Think of Aztecian, Incan and Mayan myths, combined with the thick jungle and oddities of the Tarzan of Greystoke stories by Edgar Rice Burroughs.

The Creation Myth of the Jaguar

Hark ye, come and hear of the birth of the world and the eyes of the gods that turned to gaze upon it.

In the dawn of time when the world was fresh and raw, the wild magic sparked around us and living gods stepped upon the earth, rising and falling in their power over years like the corn grows and withers as the year turns. Our land was but one small part of a much larger world where men dwelt in tribes, sometimes aiding and sometimes fighting one another. The passing of the days were all and little thought was given beyond the following year.

And then the world began to change. One tribe of giants calling themselves The Law sought to conquer those about them, and to subdue the wild magic and the Heart of the Land itself. Their weapons were fearsome and their fury unmatched, and even this was supplemented by secret words beyond even the wild magic that they whispered to break their foes. And the heart of the land saw that they would strike through even to itself, and seek to contain it and force it to their will and so it hid itself deep within the rock of the tallest mountain, made from the fire deep in the belly of the earth.

And to shield itself from the might of The Law it called to itself the strongest of the spirits, insisting that they come and dwell in the shadows of the mountain and fall upon those that meant harm to it. And thus came the Eagle and the Python, the Wasp and the Ant, and last came the mightiest of all, the Jaguar to guard the heart of the land. And they called those tribes that lived in the shadow of the mountain to themselves and blessed them to better do their bidding.

Yet The Law finally weaved their arts to find the Heart, and fell upon the peoples that guarded it until all of their warriors were slain, and the spirits themselves were exhausted, and nothing but pregnant women and children stood between their might and the Heart itself. And so, seeing all was lost, the Heart of the Land ceded all beyond the mountain to them, but called a mist to rise up around itself and where the shadow of the mountain lay, such that it might wait in secret for their passing.

And bounded by the eternal mist, the children of the tribes grew to maturity and the women gave birth to their offspring and in time they flourished once more. The Spirits that had come demanded tribute for their blessings, and most blessed were the people of the Jaguar, for their spirit was the strongest of all those of the land.

But the land remained troubled, for though they were laid to rest the spirits of the dead were angered for the mist barred their passage to paradise. And they preyed upon the dead and their numbers were growing.

And it came to pass that the Jaguar spoke to the people through his priest, saying

"This mist that holds us safe from The Law has barred your souls from their rightful place. With nowhere to go, they will roam the land seeking those who have wronged them. Thus you must call to me when one passes so that I may know, and I can gather the spirit of the dead so that it does not stalk the land in vengeance. But to do this I must have a servant to carry the spirits, a person who in life gives themselves willingly to me. Make for me a great temple, lifted from the jungle so that I may see clearly. And each year bring one who is willing to gather the spirits of the dead and I will send my winged servants to embrace him and carry his soul aloft so that he may protect you all."

And so the first temple was constructed and Vacna, the priest himself, was the first to stand atop the mighty building and call to the winged servants of the jaguar to embrace him. And seeing his signal fire, they came down from the top of the mountain, fierce of countenance, and took his soul to gather the dead. And his body was burned and we danced in praise of the honour that had been done to him. And the spirits of the dead were gathered by him and his successors, such that they do not stalk the land and prey upon the living.

And seeing the might and the wisdom of the Jaguar, the other tribes copied what had been done and with the watchings of the spirits the land was kept safe and blessed, a home for the living rather than being stalked by the dead.

And deep under the mountain the Heart lies silent to this day, but watching, waiting to return and reclaim its home that had been stolen by The Law.

Human Civilisation

The human population, the most prolific of sentient life-forms, consists of three separate tribes named after the spirits that they worship - the Jaguar, the Python and the Eagle. The three tribes do not interact much, except for on "raids" on each others' lands to carry off women. This is not the violent attack it used to be many centuries ago, but a ritualistic event where women who wish to take a husband travel to a set place at a set time to be captured by men from a neighbouring tribe. The new wives cast off their old identities and swear fealty to the new spirit as if born again. This ensures that the blood of each of the tribes remains strong, and they do not suffer from inbreeding.

Two other tribes (The Wasp and the Ant) are extinct, obliterated by the forces of the Decadent in the War of the Realm to become nothing more than a vague memory.

In the shadow of their patron spirits, the people live, love, grow old and perish. There are warriors, scouts, herbalists, hunters, priests and many many other callings. However the powers of the mind have never developed fully here, and magic is known to be a dangerous and unpredictable elemental force.

The people of Mourat are skilled builders, using stone gifted by the spirits of the many caverns carved throughout the island from the molten rock that flows beneath the surface. From the smallest hovel to the grandest ziggurat towering a hundred feet above the jungle floor, each is intrically carved with symbols representing predators and prey that throng the verdant land that surrounds them. Some of these symbols are empowered to ward off the creatures and protect the settlements that would otherwise be quickly overwhelmed.

Many of these ancient buildings are carved in the language of the Heart, a form of runes handed down the priesthood which would have fallen from use but for the need to check the warnings left on the old temples hidden in the deep jungle.

Players may freely start characters from the Realm of Mourat. They may be Mouratian human, or any of the specific races listed below. They have the following benefits and restrictions:

- *They must have appropriate Aztec-style costume and roleplay.*
- *All characters lose the ability to utilise any form of magical item unless noted.*
- *Mouratian humans gain the ability to utilise one spiritual item appropriate to their alignment per 4 levels (Priest-classes gain utilise spiritual items as normal).*
- *Characters may not join open guilds (other than those specifically restricted to Mourat) until they reach T:8 where they may gain Basic tier benefits. They gain Intermediate tier on T:10 and Advanced tier on T:11.*
- *Priests of Mourat may construct their own miracle lists as per hermit, but they must be of any lawful alignment.*

Religion

Each of these tribes are strongly religious, their day to day lives governed by a series of rituals and prayers. It is this that defines them more than anything else. Any traveller from this culture would be expected to pray in some form at least a dozen times a day – at waking, sleeping, eating, and many other occasions in between – as well as making sacrifices of burnt herbs, animals and fallen foes where possible. The rite and ritual of daily life fills and consumes them and the thought of living without this clear direction and guidance is abhorrent.

Throughout the ages these peoples endured, raising great ziggurats to their patron spirits. Many of these now lie empty and lost, untold treasures deep within their heavily trapped vaults and guarded by the minions of the spirits that once held their fealty.

At the heart of their faith is their spirit, Jaguar, Python or Eagle. While different in many ways, they are a number of similarities

Jaguar

The Jaguar typifies respect for family and the aggressive defence of one‟s own against outside threats. Servants of the Jaguar are known for their skill in hunting prey and stalking the land, seeking out trouble and dealing with them before their kith and kin can be harmed.

To walk in the footsteps of the Jaguar is to accept that the world is a dangerous and violent place, and that sometimes a pre-emptive attack is the best way of protecting oneself.

They are renowned for their warder-priests and hunters, though all walks of life are found amongst their people.

Python

The Python embodies careful though and consideration before action. They protect themselves through careful planning and preparation, ensuring that they have the tools and skills required to deal with a situation. Where others may run, flail and fight, the follower of the Python will deal with the heart of the issue as efficiently as possible.

They are renowned for their scribes and scholars, though all walks of life are found amongst their people.

Eagle

The Eagle is the proud overseer, aware of the bigger picture of the world and maintaining not only themselves, but the land and their place in it. Even more than the others, rituals guard and guide what they can do and often disputes are settled within this tribe with never a sword being drawn.

They live very efficiently from the land, making use of every one of nature‟s bounty that surrounds them in ways that would confound even the most creative rangers and herbalists.

They are renowned for their priests and herbalists, though all walks of life are found amongst their people.

Spirit-Singing ("Kakin Mescha")

The ritualistic art of singing to the spirits, persuading or coercing them to dwell within an object and bestow their powers on those who would use them. Artefacts that can be manufactured with this art range from a talisman that can perform the smallest healing miracles once in a single day, to gateways allowing passage across hundreds of miles that endure for the passing of an age.

The Undead

The thought of a dead spirit bound to walk the land is anathema to the people of Mourat. On a death they sing a lament for the soul that has passed such that the Kukulai, angels of the animal spirits, may come and carry it to its proper place.

For those who die without someone to sing their lament for them, a more gruesome fate awaits. Once each year a warrior is selected whose honour it is to be sacrificed to their patron high atop a ziggurat. The Kukulai descend to earth on leathery wings and consume the heart of the warrior, carrying their soul with them back to the gods. This soul is then empowered to scour the land for those who have died unlamented, to destroy the spirit rather than let it walk as undead.

Vitae

Until the Final Dawn at the end of IM 1009, no vitae was present amongst the tribes of Mourat. The people lived and died as peons. However, four Heroes from the group known as the Champions of the Golden Throne – Hilde and Reuben, Almayer's Folly and Six – gave all of their vitae to the Jaguar, Eagle and Python respectively at the end of the War of the Realm. This gift allowed these gods to create vitae amongst their own people, so that they may have champions to endure and remember beyond the turning of an age.

The sacrifice of these four mercenaries and the other Champions of the Golden Throne will be remembered for ever, and temples have been erected to their deeds amongst each of the tribes.

Magic and Magicians

The elemental forces in Mourat still contend with each other strongly, often battling for supremacy over an area. To channel magic, one must rely on the patronage of a potent elemental Baron and cast off any previous loyalty to the gods of Mourat. For this reason only outcasts or the insane would seek to walk the ways of the elements.

These Barons hold sway over an area, embodying it in much the same way the Samila do in Ishma. They are not necessarily bound to a single element, but combinations are common. For example, the Spirit of the Crystal Cavern might control earth and light, while the Spirit of the Storm might bind air and water magics.

The presence of these powerful Barons calls forth servants from the land, the Jae‟nah. Fae- like, these creatures are capricious and usually malign, seeking to drive off any that might seek to displace them from the honour of their Lord. They are truly creatures of magic and the land, born afresh from the elements every dawn.

To obtain the favour of a Baron one would first have to overcome his Jae‟nah. If one was simply seeking a favour, then often he would grant it there and then, or seek some demonstration of prowess first. This is a common task used for a rite of manhood. If one was seeking apprenticeship however, a worthy offering would be needed together with a plea to be accepted as a servant or slave. In time, he may then gift the secrets of the elements.

There are tales of powerful wizards who have bound Barons into service to them, seizing their power rather than having it granted to them. These are mostly regarded as myth, however.

Players may play wizards of fire, air, earth or water from the Realm of Mourat. They do not gain utilise spiritual item, having turned their backs on their patrons, but can use magical items.

The Others

The Decadent

Railed against the humans in the War of the Realm were the decadent. These are men whose bodies and souls had been twisted by the supernatural whispering of a certain secret.

This secret forced them to understand that the gods of Mourat were actually enslaving their followers, returning them to life time after time in a culture that could consider nothing other than complete and unwavering devotion. Those that heard the secret turned their back on their gods in the name of Decadence – the freedom from the eternal rites and rituals that had previously governed them.

The touch of Decadence also changed their bodies so that they were no longer subject to the whims of mortality – they no longer needed to eat or sleep but could instead contemplate their place in the world and how to achieve the full potential of their soul. Their presence also draws the life from the land itself, such that where they dwell plants wither and the earth is dead.

Unfortunately, this secret was too much for all but the most enlightened and aware. Most of the Decadent are like the nightsoil of Thimon or Bildteve, shadows of their former selves. Stronger men and women however retained their personalities and intellect and accepted and championed the cause that had been presented to them, seeking to free their friends and family from an eternity of bonded slavery to jumped-up animal spirits.

During the War of the Realm their leader and originator was Puchal, who slew the realm spirit of Mourat and wrested the power of belief from the people touched by his power. He was killed in Mai 1009 by the Champions of the Golden Throne, leaving the Decadent leaderless. Many of them remain however, and the stronger ones amongst them guide and direct the weaker such that they remain a formidable force, fighting for the freedom of their loved ones who are too blind to see that they are trapped.

Players may start minions of the Decadence. They discern as a Servant of Decadence, (level 1undead) initially, rising to their resistance level to spirits -3. They are immune to flesh and blood fx and are fully affected by miracles that affect the undead, including dismissal. Despite this, they are otherwise as (Mouratian) human in all ways and gain no further benefits or disadvantages.

The Verdant Heart

Deep within the jungles rest the peoples of the Verdant Heart. Their limbs are knotted vines and their body is heavy vegetation, they walk and think as men and venerate and protect plants of great age. They are a little slow, like the Curious Trolls of Primus, but mighty when enraged.

The powers of nature flow through them very strongly and they are tribal and druidic in nature.

The War of the Realm mostly passed them by, though many of them fell asleep never to rise as the land died around them.

Players may start members of the Verdant Heart. They gain the following benefits and restrictions:

- *Life scales and abilities are as Alfar but have no spirit and and gain +1 PAC at 6th, rather than +1 DAC*
- *They may wear no more than stiff leather armour*
- *They should have make-up of heavy browns and greens and aim for a generally plant-like appearance.*
- *They may be Warriors, Rangers, Thugs, Pathfinders, Leywalkers, Forest Guardians or Druids (Thugs have life-scale as per alfar forest guardian (47/16 at 8th)*
- *As noted above, they cannot use magical items, but being spiritless beings they do not gain the ability to utilise spirit items*

...and Beyond

Tales of other peoples abound and almost anything could be lost in the dangerous jungle, living in secret from tribes of pygmies, to great cats who walk like men. In the bustling heart of life where the Wyld held sway until very recently, all manners of life are born and grow.

New Priest Abilities

These are only available to 1st class priests

Dedication to life – Post 6th spiritual healer and Devotion to the healing tree

Cost: 130pts **Table**: 10

Once a character has purchased the healing tree four times including restore life restore life is considered an asterixed miracle and can be skipped if desired.

However the character may not have better than ½ level loss restore life.

Light within – Post 6th Spiritual Celebrant

Cost: 75* **Table**: 9 Max: 2

The priest may cast a rite of the bright god using themselves as the focus. The benefits will only extend 30ft around them, rather than the normal mile. Additionally the duration is reduced to one hour, usable 1/day.

Life drawn close – Post 6th Lifes Avenger or Spiritual Exorcist, and from Forced Dismissal

Cost: 20* **Table**: 8 Max: 3

The priest may cast a dismissal miracle upon themselves, including naming the type of undead effected, so that they may trigger it by touch. The miracle will hang for 30 seconds and does not trigger unless the named type of undead is touched. If the duration expires then the power is wasted.

Words of Power – Post 6th the relevant spiritual class

Cost: 75 **Table**: 10

The priest may now purchase Holy words of a chosen sphere as a Paladin/Grey Knight/Unhily Champion. They must be post 6th in the relevant Spiritual X class (eg. to buy Healing words you need to be a 6th level Spiritual Healer). This can only be purchased for one sphere.

Power Returned – No Weapon using priest only

Cost: 40* **Table**: 8 Max: 3

If the priests cast an offensive miracle from their Major sphere and it fails for any reason (including the target being immune) they may trigger this innate within 2 seconds and regain half the spirits used. This can only be used if the miracle was cast with spirits.

Darkness within – Post 6th Wound Bringer

Cost: 50* **Table**: 9 Max: 2

The priest may cast a rite of the bane god using themselves as the focus. The benefits will only extend 30ft around them, rather than the normal mile. Additionally the duration is reduced to one hour, usable 1/day.

Word of Protection – Post 6th Spiritual Warden

Cost: 60* **Table**: 10 Max: 2

1/day May enact a protection from spirits miracle without the need to mark the line. The Protection must be in a circle and it forms in a 6ft radius with the user at its centre.

Protections enacted in this way only last 5 minutes.

Miracle: Wings of the Netherworld	
Alignment/Sphere: Evil/Major Necromancy	**Range**: 20ft
Duration: Instant	**Spirits**: 2
Verbal: Sent forth on the wings of the netherworld.	
Effect: Causes a single handbook Undead touch effect, or related miracle (EG would work on Wraiths Touch, but not devour spirit) that the caster has hanging to affect a target within 20ft.	

Miracle: Touch of Light	
Alignment/Sphere: Goodly/Major Healing	**Range**: Self
Duration: Instant	**Spirits**: 8th level (12 spirits)
Verbal: Spirits of light abide with me for a while, let my touch tend to the suffering of others.	
Effect: Allows the caster to cast cure wound for 0 spirits and 1 TBLP every 5 minutes. This curing cannot be used on self, and cannot be stored in any way. If the caster is struck by a fully cast touch range causing miracle then this miracle ends. While active the spirits cannot be regained, and they may only have the miracle active once.	

Miracle: Peaceful Dreams	
Alignment/Sphere: Goodly/Major Healing or Major Benediction	**Range**: Touch
Duration: 24 hours/Special	**Spirits**: 4
Verbal: May the spirits of light abide with you and ease your suffering.	
Effect: This grants the recipient "Sleep off Perm" for all wounds they are currently suffering. This miracle must be cast on time in, and within 15 minutes of the wounds being suffered to work. If the recipient already has Sleep off Perm then any permanent wounds they have suffered in the last 15 minutes can be healed normally. Goodly Witches can learn this as a Minor Benediction miracle and Hospitallers as a Minor Healing miracle.	

New Scout Abilities

On dungeon Recipes

These can only be learnt with points and it is only possible to make the potion using Mercenary/Hero Alchemist or similar. They are considered Difficult recipes with a difficulty level of 10 and the potion only has a single dose.

As per ATSE this means costs are 30 points plus 5 per difficulty level and not more than one can be purchased for every 300 points post 8th – except for those with the Herbalist tendency who have no restrictions.

Healing:

Lingering Anti-Venom	
Cost: see above	Table: see above
Once drunk the recipients body begins to produce natural anti-venoms. They are considered to have a dose of AV2 in their system at all times. This lasts an hour. An individual can only benefit from this potion once in a day. Prerequisites/Notes: To learn this the AV True recipe must be known.	

Poison:

Traitors Breath	
Cost: see above	Table: see above
When made the kick in time of the potion can be anything from 30 seconds to 8 hours. During this time the person still discerns as poisoned, but there are no visible effects. Once the potion kicks in the person suffers a dose of IV6 and a further dose kicks in every 10 seconds for one minute (so seven doses in total). While the poison is kicking in the victim is unable to cast/use abilities that require concentration. Prerequisites/Notes: To learn this the IV 8 recipe must be known.	

General:

Lucid Dreams	
Cost: see above	Table: see above
The potion must be drunk within 30 seconds of being brewed as it does not store well. Once drunk the recipient enters a semi-lucid state. This grant them Greater Aware Meditation for one hour or until the med is broken. However for 3 hours (from the point of drinking) they are at -2 levels of resistance. Prerequisites/Notes: To learn this the Sweet Dreams recipe must be known.	

Mystical Power	
Cost: see above	Table: see above
This potion is brewed to act as a store for magical or spiritual power. At the point of brewing 3 mana or 3 spirits must be cast into the potion. When drunk the drinker regains 3 points of the relevant power (in a similar manner to meditation). The potion will only last 6 hours then it is wasted. Prerequisites/Notes: Witches and Wayfinders gain +1 skill level for making this potion for spirits, and Rogues gain +1 skill level for making it magically.	

Other Scout Abilities

The following are available to any 1st class Scout Subclass, including Wayfinder, Rogues, Ley-Walkers etc.

Rapid Stealth	
Cost: 40* (Max 2)	Table: 7

Requires 6 levels in Stealth skill. 1/day this allows the scout to re-enter a stealth they left in the last 30 seconds. This cannot be used in conjunctiowith any abiity that increases the stealth's duration beyond the normal 5 minutes but does function with Greater Stealth.

Giant Leap

Cost: 25* (Max 2) Table: 7

Requires 6 levels in Athlete skill. 1/day can double the distance of a single Salmon Leap.

Evade

Cost: 30* (Max 3) Table: 7

Requires 6 levels in Combat Wary skill. 1/day allows the user to apply Combat Wary to a single blow even if it has been used in the last 5 minutes. Must be declared within 2 seconds of the blow.

Rapid Defense

Cost: 80* (Max 2) Table: 9

Requires 9 levels in Combat Wary skill. 1/day allows the user to apply Combat Wary to a every blow suffered for the next 30 seconds. This ability ends if they strike a blow.

Dodge

Cost: 60* (Max 2) Table: 9

From Trap Wary 1/day may use Trap Wary (not Enhanced Trap Wary) vs a targeted ranged effect (eg. Lightning Bolt) allowing the benefits of Trap Wary to be applied if the Jump takes the user out of range.

New Warrior Abilities

Contra Mastery Weapons	
Available to: 1st Class Kensai and Duellist	**Cost**: 250 **Table**: 10
From Contra Mastery vs Swords gains Contra Mastery vs all weapons. Can buy enhanced contra mastery weapons as a 1st class warrior.	

Parry More	
Available to: Battlemaster	**Cost**: 40* (Max 3) **Table**: 10
1/day Instead of its normal benefits can use a Blade Fury to turn any and all counter/contra masteries owned into numerical damage reductions such that Unique Fighting style/similar do not negate them.	

Defensive Stance	
Available to: 1st Class Warrior Subclass	**Cost**: 75* (Max 2) **Table**: 9
1/day Grants 12 points off all weapon blows while able to move for 5 minutes. During this time max damage is reduced to zero, and is reduced to triple for 15 minutes after the innate ends.	

Supernatural Accuracy	
Available to: 1st Class Warrior, 1st Class Kensai, 1st Class Monk, Post 6th Battlemaster	**Cost**: 200 **Table**: 12
From Perm Accuracy. Now gains Accuracy vs MAC and SAC with supernatural weapons. This does not extend to effects delivered by blow, just the damage grade itself.	

Predictable Foe	
Available to: 1st Class Warrior, 1st Class Kensai, 1st Class Monk, 1st Class Duellist, Post 6th Battlemaster	**Cost**: 50* (Max 3) **Table**: 10
1/day vs one target gains Target Prediction (as Archer ability) for 5 minutes.	

Telling Blow	
Available to: 1st Class Warrior, 1st Class Kensai, 1st Class Monk, 1st Class Duellist, Post 6th Battlemaster	**Cost**: 80* (Max 2) **Table**: 10
1/day for 5 minutes grants +2 Max Damage vs one opponent. While active cannot use any damage reductions except AC (this includes supernaturally generated defences such as Rockskin).	

New Wizard Abilities

These are only available to 1st class Wizards

Drain the Power

Cost: 30* (Max 3) **Table**: 10

1/day May spend 1 minute ritually draining the power from a magical scroll of the wizards own colour and destroying the scroll. The allows the wizard to regain mana equal to half the power of the scroll. (EG a grey wizard using a scroll of dispel 10 would regain 5 mana).

The Dragon's Gift

Cost: 75 **Table**: 10

1/day May perform a 2 minute ritual drawing upon power from the dragons. At completion the wizard may sacrifice (lose for the rest of the day) as many casting levels as they wish. For every casting level lost in this way they regain 3 mana. If facility (or similar no damage casting abilities) is owned and the wizards casting level drops lower than the point the spell would cost 1 life without them then casting damage is suffered without the benefits of facility.

Mana Returned

Cost: 50* (Max 2) **Table**: 9

1/day If the wizard has used an offensive spell and the target has taken no effect from the spell this innate may be used within 2 seconds and half the mana the spell cost to cast is regained.

Form of the Elemental

Cost: 75* (Max 3) **Table**: 9

1/day within 10 seconds of summoning a published elemental the wizard can choose to merge with its form. This allows the player to "play their own elemental". This lasts a maximum of 5 minutes, but ends earlier if the elemental is destroyed.

When the elemental ends (Duration or being killed) the wizard re-appears where it expires and suffers an irresistible stasis.

If the elemental was killed due to contact with another elemental or being dispelled then the wizard re-appears dead.

Reclaim the Power

Cost: 40* (Max 3) **Table**: 9

1/day If spends 30 seconds prep before casting a normal dispel (dispel 1-20, not Disenchant, Zeniths Magical Destruction etc.) regains ½ the mana of the spell being dispelled (EG if dispels a 10 mana spell regains 5 mana).

Those that have multi-classed to 6th level disenchanter can buy two additional innates.

Targeted for Destruction

Cost: 50* **Table**: 10 (High Wizards can purchase a second innate on Table 11)

1/day for 5 minutes vs a single target gains 1 mana off all offensive spells cast vs them, per offensive spell cast vs them while the innate is running. This only stacks with itself and expertise, and the reduction cannot reduce a spell below ½ of its original cost.

EG The first casting of a lightning bolt is at normal cost, the second has 1 mana off, the third 2 mana off and so on.

The innate ends if the Wizards casts spells at another target, or any non-offensive spells.

The following spells can be learnt as any published colour. If the wizard has multiple colours then they must be learnt separately for each colour.

Armour of the Dragons			
Level: 2	**Colour**: Own Colour	**Range**: Self	**Duration**: 5 minutes
Verbal: "Let the Dragon of (B) enfold me in his/her armour."			
Description: Grants the caster +2 MAC vs the opposite colour of magic (EG A red wizard gains MAC vs Green). This spell does not stack with itself.			

Blade of the Dragon			
Level: 5	**Colour**: Own Colour	**Range**: Touch	**Duration**: 5 minutes
Verbal: "Into this blade I call forth the power of (B). Let the physical fade and the magical prevail.			
Description: Turns a weapon that is already magical, and of the same colour of this spell, pure for the duration. This does not work on weapons with a spiritual component. The caster must touch the weapon for the entire duration of the verbal for the spell to work.			

New Druid Abilities

Sacred Preparation

Available to: Druid, High Druid, Forest Guardian | **Cost**: 50 **Table**: 9

Increases the chance of successfully crafting Talismans to 100%.

The Body Reclaimed

Available to: 1st Class Druid, High Druid, Forest Guardian, Leywalker | **Cost**: 80 **Table**: 7

With 30 seconds concentration or appropriate ritual the user can cause the flesh and bones of a target to decay and crumble. The result is the body cannot be restored to life, or used to raise an undead, until a regeneration (or regrowth)has been cast on it. Immunity to Slayer applies, and this ability only functions on targets with normal bodies.

Foundation of Nature (May not own the Narrow Path or Field Devotion)

Available to: 1st Class Druid, High Druid, Forest Guardian | **Cost**: 80 **Table**: 5

Allows the druid to buy a single innate of every standard evocation that is on their list at ½ cost. This does not stack with other reductions in the cost of innates.

Narrow Path (May not own Foundation of Nature or Field Devotion)

Available to: 1st Class Druid, High Druid, Forest Guardian | **Cost**: 60 **Table**: 5

Allows the druid to buy innates of one standard evocation that is on their list at half cost. Not stacking with other reductions in cost.

Expertise: Aerie's Foul Feast

Available to: Any with chosen field Deserts | **Cost**: 20 **Table**: 1

Enhances a single casting of Aerie's foul feast so that the healing gained from it is doubled (not with other increases in effect). A second innate may be purchased on table 8 by first class druidic classes

Expertise: Cat's Grace

Available to: Any with chosen field Mountains | **Cost**: 20 **Table**: 1

Enhances a single casting of Cat's Grace so the recipient gains Dexterous Celerity and immunity to force majure while it is active. This benefit lasts a maximum of 5 minutes. A second innate may be purchased on table 8 by first class druidic classes.

Expertise: Soothe Wounds

Available to: Any with chosen field Mother Nature | **Cost**: 20 **Table**: 1

Enhances a single casting of Soothe Wounds so all permanent wounds on the target become healable. A second innate may be purchased on table 8 by first class druidic classes.

Evocation: Pass without Trace	
Field: Any Terrain, chosen when purchased	**Range**: Touch
Duration: 15 minutes	**EP**: 3
Verbal: May I/you pass through this place without a trace	
Effect: This may be cast on self, or anyone under a joining evocation. For the duration the recipient gains immunity to acute hearing and sniff.	

Evocation: Resist Lightning	
Field: Spring/Skies/Lord of Skies	**Range**: Touch
Duration: 5 minutes	**EP**: 5
Verbal: May nature shield me/ you from the ravages of the skies	
Effect. For the duration the recipient gains immunity to natural lightning and electricity, and half effect supernatural lightning and electricity.	

Evocation: The Predator's Mark	
Field: Horned Man	**Range**: Self/20ft at casting
Duration: 15 minutes	**EP**: 6
Verbal: You are marked for the hunt!	
Effect. To learn this evocation the druid must have predator talisman. Vs the chosen target (who must be within 20ft and visible) the caster gains Wanderers Hunch for the duration.	

Evocation: Heightened Meditation	
Field: Desert	**Range**: Self
Duration: One period of meditation	**EP**: 4
Verbal: As I sit ready to be one with nature I call to the Meerkat to awaken me.	
Effect. The caster must have Meerkat talisman. Enhances the aware meditation gained from the Meerkat talisman to be Greater Aware meditation. The caster must enter meditation as soon as this evocation is cast and it lasts until the meditation is broken.	

Abilities:

Mental Surge		
Available to: 1st Class Any	**Cost**: 30* (max 3)	**Table**: 9
1/day allows the use to destroy parts of their mental pathways to allow their mental powers to flow more effectively. Use of this ability causes the loss of 3X TBLP for the day (This can be casting stamina, but cannot be healed by any means other than supreme sacrifice as it is a weakening of the body). For the next 10 seconds the user gains X neural foci. The life loss for this cannot be reduced, avoided, or taken on temp life/similar		

Harden the Mind		
Available to: 1st Class Any	**Cost**: 50* (max 2)	**Table**: 9
1/day allows the user to regain a published neuronic innate that they have used instantly. For every 3 TBLP the neuronic costs to use (at published base cost before any reductions) they lose 1 permanent neural foci for the day. Temporary and item foci cannot be sacrificed.		

Mental Fortitude		
Available to: 1st Class Any	**Cost**: 80	**Table**: 9
From immunity to fear, Emotion attacks and Insanity. The neuronicist can now use their neuronics regardless of their location.		

Neuronic Powers

Offensive Neural Purge		
Available to: 1st class Mystic, Psycher or Psi Drowe	**Cost**: 150* (max 2)	**Table**: 10
Range: Touch	**T.B.L.P**: 48	
Duration: Instant	**Immunities**: Non-published dispelling effects	
All on going neuronics on the target are immediately ended. As a neuronic ability this cannot remove Mind-Bar/similar.		

Neuronic Imbalance		
Available to: 1st Class Any	**Cost**: 80* (max 2)	**Table**: 10
Range: 20ft	**T.B.L.P**: 24	
Duration:30 seconds	**Immunities**: See below	
The target becomes unable to use neuronics for 30 seconds. Any that are already active remain in effect, but if they require concentration or ongoing casting damage (EG neuronic wall) they end. Mental Fortitude (or similar) means the character can continue to use Neuronics but cannot use Foci for the duration.		

Multi Class

The Awoken Mind

This class is available to: Any neuronic first class

Level	Abilities	Cost
1	Can no longer meditate/regain neuronics except through this class and supreme sacrifice. Gains an empty pool of 2 "Neuronic Reserves" per level. This regens at a rate of 1 per hour. The pool can be used to regain innates of a characters base class neuronics. This takes 30 seconds concentration per innate being regains and costs 1 NR per 3 TBLP (base cost) of the Neuronic.	50
2	Pool now regenerates at 1 per 30 minutes	100
3	The pool can now be used to regain innates of any published neuronic owned. The time taken to regain an innate is reduced to 15 seconds	200
4	Pool now regenerates at 1 per 15 minutes	300
5	Pool now regenerates at 1 per 10 minutes The time taken to regain an innate is reduced to 10 seconds	500
6	Pool now regenerates at 1 per 5 minutes	800

New "ALL" Abilities

Table 3 (250pts)

Magical Resistance to "Element"		
Available to: All	**Cost**: 30	**Table**: 3
From ½ effect an element (EG Fire) now gains ½ effect the relevant colours (EG Red). To purchase this for White both ½ effect Light and ½ effect Cold must be owned. Must be purchased per colour.		

Table 8 (1000pts)

Inner Magic		
Available to: Elves/Draves/Fairies/Similar	**Cost**: 50	**Table**: 8
From ½ effect own racial colour of magic. Now gains full effect own colour of magic. This ability can only be purchased once as an elf.		

Magical Sustenance		
Available to: Elves/Draves/Fairies/Similar	**Cost**: 25* (max 3)	**Table**: 8
1/day with 30 seconds preparation may, at the point of casting, absorb the power of an Affirm to instead heal the character. Rather than the normal benefit the affirm provides 6/6 magical curing. If the character has the ability to stack affirms then they can use additional affirms to increase the healing gained (EG 3 affirms = 18/18 healing). This healing cannot heal damage from dispels.		

Table 10 (3000pts)

Immunity to Power Drain		
Available to: All	**Cost**: 60	**Table**: 10
From immunity non-published dispelling effects.		

Immunity to Halt		
Available to: All	**Cost**: 120	**Table**: 10
Complete immunity to Halt, from 3 resistances to Halt		

Tempo of Power		
Available to: All Power Users	**Cost**: 60* (max 2)	**Table**: 10
1/day gains the benefits of Tempo of Battle (warrior ability) but it applies to all supernatural power ups that are active when used.		

Table 11 (5250pts)

Mental Resistance		
Available to: All	**Cost**: 200	**Table**: 11
Must have the Fully Active (including 10 pens) and Fully Passive trees. Now gains Mind block (as monk skill), however can never use Neural Foci, nor purchase the ability to utilise Neuronic items.		

Table 12 (7500pts)

¼ Effect Second Element		
Available to: All	**Cost**: 175	**Table**: 12
¼ Effect second Element.		

NIGHTSOIL

Towards the end of the Second Age, the Empire and the Baronies were enemies rather than allies. The Circle of the time chose to invade the Empire. Their aim was to reach the rift in reality known as Amora's Doom, the breach created by calling on power and pacts from across the exostance by Emperor Amora. It was rumoured they needed to perform some great demonic sacrifice there.

The Baronies moved swiftly and effectively, ever a warlike people they took the Empire by surprise. At the battle of Amora's Doom, defeat left the Empire's armies in disarray and a great many dead. Things looked bad for the Empire, but then came the Lord of Felldrakken Isle, the Liche Ashgaroth. At the time the Felldrakken, or Zombie Isle, still possessed a vast well of power for the use for necromancy and it was this power Ashgaroth took and channeled, aided by the secret lore of the dark Scholars of Rhiannon Vo Rosarian and the assistance of the followers of Jon Shannow to fuel a rite.

These three powerful factions enacted a great rite that caused those who had died in defense of the Empire to rise once more as an army with a second chance to do their duty to defend the Empire. This they did and victory was secured by the Empire, but after they had completed their tasks the living dead did not simply fail and fall apart as one would have expected but sought to return to their homes and continue in death what they had done in life.

Thus were the Nightsoil born. The vestiges of the loyal dead of the Empire who had been given a second chance. Today the Nightsoil are found throughout the Empire although their greatest gatherings are in Bildteve, for that is where the "Father of the Nightsoil", Ashgaroth dwells, and in Thimon where they were enticed by Count Saldana and his council of necromancers.

However, the Nightsoil were not left as the living dead for the Empress, in her compassion and love, saw the sacrifices the Nightsoil had made and rewarded them. At the final dawn that marked the end of IM 1006 and the beginning of IM 1007 she, as do many ritualists at the Final Dawn, enacted a great rite. Her rite suffused the Nightsoil with a measure of life, letting those without vitae return to the land of the living and with the first light of the new year the Nightsoil, gasped, drew breath, and ever so slowly little more than once a minute, their dead hearts beat once more. It is said that at each Final dawn since, the Empress enacts the rite to keep the Nightsoil alive – it is rumored that there may be ways to help them get closer to true life, as is their desire….

Rules for Nightsoil

Nightsoil may now be started as a playable race, with the following details:

Each club member may only ever have one Nightsoil character, and they cost 75 monster points to start.

Nightsoil may only be warriors, archers, pathfinders or thugs, and currently may only be in the warrior or scout bracket. They may be of any alignment. They have abilities and restrictions as per human except as noted below:

- *Nightsoil require excellent "corpse" make up*
- *All Nightsoil are peons, and they gain the published "peon" ability for free.*
- *They may not currently purchase, or otherwise gain vitae.*
- *They are immune to life and death effects – specifically – Restore Life (and similar ressing abilities – Animate Life, Breath of Life etc), Touch of death, Suspend Life, Steal Life Essence, abilities that specifically only effect the living (eg. "Power word Frenzy") and appropriate non-standards that logically only effect the living.*

- *They are Immune to beneficial F&B effects. They may purchase ½ effect dis-beneficial F&B for 40 points on Table 3, and may purchase full immunity to F & B (as Angel of War) for an additional 60 points on Table 8.*
- *Nightsoil, are currently unable to benefit from any form of rebirth or survival abilities.*
- *On the 1st January each year, the Empress' rite re-animates all Nightsoil. This means that should they have 'died' at any point earlier in the year, they are 'ressed' and may again be played, regardless of how long they have been dead. This could mean that a PC Nightsoil plays a dungeon in Feb, unfortunately dies, remains dead until the following 1st January. The ritual will work even if the Nightsoil's body has been destroyed or otherwise lost, as it re-creates their body.*
- *All Nightsoil are fiercely loyal to the empire. They fought and died for it, and were rewarded by the Empress for their devotion. Should any Nightsoil become outlawed, they immediately collapse lifeless, never to move again. (In system terms, they permanently die, and don't auto res next January). Should they be pardoned for their crime and have their outlawhood removed, they then will be able to be auto-ressed the following January.*
- *¼ levels (at 4th and 8th) they gain an innate "Feign Death" – this will for 5 mins, mean that they discern in all ways and to all powers as dead. Should they be knowcked uncoincious via damage (not via use of own abilities) and have an innate remaining then it will automatically kick in.*
- *Nighsoil benefit from a "Fortified Spirit"*
- *Nightsoil may purchase immunities/resiatances to miracles which do not affect the undead at half normal cost.*

To be clear, Nightsoil are not creatures of undeath – they do not discern as such, and are not dismissable. Referee's should avoid setting them as undead.

Should any clubmember have an existing base race change Nightsoil, then they should see the GSM to check for appropriateness.

Reincarnation and Rebirth

As people will have seen on the boards there have been several changes to rebirths and reincarnations. Why have these been done? Well the intention of making rebirth take 3 months was to give death some meaning, and in truth it didn't. People just waited 3 months and started playing again. Delaying the rebirth in several cases just meant a player didn't play as they didn't want to play something else. It also meant if you were playing with a group of friends not only would you be less points due to rebirthing you'd lose 3 months of play so they'd get further ahead.

The changes to reincarnation are also pretty simple. No one really wants to spend to spend a day watching someone wander around with a shopping bag looking for their rebirth, or worse stand bored as it is shopped for. Letting people reincarnate characters, without being as powerful as you can be if you died on a dungeon, will hopefully get rid of this.

The rules, for those that have not seen them, are:

Rebirths

Rebirths will be processed as quickly as we can. In general, assume 2 weeks as not an unreasonable turn around. This will be delayed if the ref takes time sending bits in, or if it's a very big rebirth as it needs time to work stuff out.

ISP for rebirths is calculated as 10isp per full thousand points a character is post 8th until they reach 10,000 points.

Characters over 10,000 points gain an additional 10isp per full 5000 points they are.

The Crypt CP offers a bonus as published.

If an Obituary is written, and submitted for publishing in the Almanac, then this will add 10isp to the rebirth. This should be emailed to lee@labyrinthe.co.uk. The intention to write an obituary needs to be emailed within a couple of days and the obituary itself within a week of the death. It is possible to do your own obituary providing it's appropriate/funny and not being abused.

A character cannot have a rebirth of more than 150isp.

It is permissible for a player to say the theme they would like their rebirth to be, it is not acceptable to ask for specific stats.

If a character does not have rebirth then they cannot gain a rebirth, perm death is just that; perm death.

Reincarnations

The active choice to rebirth a character without perm dying on dungeon. When reincarnating you are effectively trading in a current character and getting a new one. The new character does not retain the old characters memories, and all of the old characters equipment must be handed in at the desk. There are three types of reincarnation:

As a new standard character – If you chose to reincarnate as a new published character class/race combination then you return at a percentage of your points listed below.

This can be dealt with at the desk, by desk staff. The characters card and equipment must be handed in.

Current Points	% of current points returned at
Below 1000 points	10%
1001-2999	30%
3000-5249	40%
5250-7499	50%
7500+	60%

As a non-standard class/race combination

This is choosing to reincarnate as a non-standard class/race combination. This should be dealt with via a points request. Once processed the new card can be issued by the Desk with the player handing in their old card and equipment.

The characters returns at a new points as follows:

Current Points	% of current points returned at
Below 1000 points	Cannot be done
1001-2999	20%
3000-5249	30%
5250-7499	40%
7500+	50%

As a rebirth

This method is again dealt with by points app. The player should submit a rough idea of what they want their new character to be like. They will generally receive approximately 75% of the ISP they would receive if they died on dungeon, and do not gain the benefits of a crypt or obituary.

Once the ability is processed the player can hand the character and equipment into the desk and the card will be processed.

Characters using this return at:

Current Points	% of current points returned at
Below 1000 points	Cannot be done
1001-2999	0%
3000-5249	10%
5250-7499	20%
7500+	30%

It is, when using any method of reincarnation, possible to choose to return at a lower numbers of points than they can be (the same is true for rebirths).

It is not possible to reincarnate and merge multiple characters into one. One rebirth/reincarnation per character.

Rising Star

The Rising Star Trading Company is a merchant enterprise seeking to offer expert services to the mercenary community. With its main base in Halgar but offices in every major town and city in the Empire (and beyond!), the Rising Star is in a unique position to be able to offer their services to those that work tirelessly for the protection of this land.

The Company was originally formed by a number of newly retired Mercenaries under the leadership of Rufus Wolf. In early IM1009 they were given the Cerus Marque and by IM1012 had welcomed Anath Halfblack to their number. In Mai IM1012 Rufus Wolf was murdered by unknown assailants and by the end of the year it became apparent that one of the company had started subverting the business for his own needs.

Thanks to the excellent work of the mercenary caste this rogue element was removed but the company shortly stopped operations. In late IM1014 the company passed hands to a group of mercenaries who have slowly started the company's business operations back up.

The Company is run by Partners and Associates. The Partners are:

Asher, Master Potioneer, and incumbent Mentatus

Marcus Blunt, the Master of the Blunt Club and Baron of Pine Lake

Mallerstang, the Lord Laght, Master Scriviner

Palewise, Master Artificer and Scriviner

With Anath Halfblack and Peronel Winterhaven as associates.

Individuals may choose to be “Members” of the rising star. Such requires permission from a Partner (unless already listed above) and is signed onto the card. Membership is suspended if the individual becomes an Outlaw or is Ostracised within the Labyrinthian Empire.

Members may choose to claim benefits from the Rising Star rather than a Social Guild in which case they are well equipped with up to 1000 grulls (at permanent make cost) of published potions or Standard Scrolls these are dungeon temp (as such no cards are issued). Additionally, any treasure sold via the company is increased in profit by 25%.

people, known for their intense hatred of the undead and those who have been restored to life. Since then however, their race has been found to be far more than the simple beasts of war that a dark church had brought to Primus, their plane explored and liberated and one of their great cities brought to Primus, now resting at the edge of The Isle of Dragons.

SHIRET

The Shriel originally hail from a plane of existance known as Shiret. The place is a great plain, broken by a series of huge lakes, on the borders of which great walls were constructed to keep out Feral birds and Grinners, as well as the once mighty horde of golems that were created so that war would be constant on the plane. Once each of the great lakes was enclosed, isolation became more and more common amongst the various cities that grew within them, each being self contained enough that they were self sufficient. However, across most of the cities, a religion flourished.

Having become a culture now safe from previous strife and somewhat caged by their own actions, it took on a focus on rememberance and religion grew around the worship of previous Shriel that were viewed as Saints. One High Saint was declared as a prophet of the religion, but many stories were told by many people and the majority of the Shriel have never known which are true. Many may follow saints who have never existed and are merely stories retold a thousand times.

One truth sticks hard and fast in the religion of the Shriel however. In the afterlife you will fly forever, and those who would reject their own death are chained to the ground in punishment. For this reason, Shriel almost in their entirety despise undead and those who make them. While The Church of Dead Heroes have made solid progress explaining that this afterlife is not how it is for everyone and have changed the minds of many, old biases die hard.

THE NEST

One city of Shriel has been brought to primus and now rests gently on the western edge of The Dragon Isles – The Nest. This is a city filled with ritualists, with a small network of defensive wards and a great tower of spun glass resting in its centre. Administration and bureaucracy are queen in this city and frankly that is a necessity. The central tower, The Nest the city takes its name from, is an intricately spun ritual chamber, but is built from wild magic and draws yet more in. As a result, it is carefully monitored and guarded lest its power be wielded unsafely.

The city has a slowly growing presence on primus

All Shriel PCs have come from The Nest, but they might well have had origins as wandering pilgrims, or from other cities.

SHRIEL

The Shriel are humanoid birds, slenderly built but strong. They commonly have features similar to Ravens, Crows, Swans or Jays, but could draw their features from almost any conceivable bird and, indeed, some of the greatest single figures in the Shriel's pantheon of saints are brightly coloured tropical birds of paradise. It is said that the greater deeds you perform in life, the more colourful your plumage will be after your death, so many view those with vibrant feathers to be in some way holy, which may often carry over to how they interact with some primal races, such as Elves.

There are many castes that the Shriel adhere to, and it is often the case that one will strive to a path from an early age. Nest-Weavers are those who manipulate magic, but rarely for combative purposes preferring a candle-lit study and a focus on preventing violence with wards and walls. Azure Talons are those trained in destruction, making up a very small number of highly trained warlocks who strike hard and fast with lightning and blades. Lost Pilgrims are those who follow the path of the saints and develop spiritual powers as a result. They are commonly seen with a single colourful feather amongst their duller plumage and are known to channel power through it.

Since the turning of The Dawn, vitae is not unheard of within Shriel bloodlines, but is treated with suspicion and is under-studied. Of those who have been blessed with it, some might choose to view it as a curse or to simply refuse to be restored to life. Others take it as a burden, that they might strive for their beliefs for several lives, to better the world how they may and then take their punishment eternal in the after-life. It is notably very rare for a Shriel to have as much Vitae as a normal imperial mercenary, but it does happen occasionally.

System rules for Shriel

Shriel PC may be Wizards, Sorcerers, Blue Warlocks, Warriors, Blade Masters, Pure Priests or Warrior Priests. Priests must be hermit priests of the Saints.

They have life as if a human of the same class, but one level lower (7th level at 8th) and may not buy extra levels of life (may buy stamina's normally). Sorcerers gain life as a Human Warlock. They are fully flesh and blood creatures.

Shriel must have bird like make up, and due to being birds cannot wear above light armour, but gain 1 point of racial DAC at 4th and at 8th level.

A Shriel who has been restored to life (not rebirthed) may never, under any circumstances fly or be carried by someone flying. This applies to all variants, such as walk on light. Trying to lift them from the ground feels as if you are struggling against great, unbreakable chains.

All Shriel gain the benefits of The Falcon Talisman at level 4, but may not buy the enhancements to it. Each Shirel may choose one of the following statuses on table 1.

Path of The Nest Weaver

Requirements: Must be a mana user. Is a Noble Exhumanitus, and must buy the Status.

1/day when dispels a spell can spend 30 seconds to recover mana equal to half the level of the spell dispelled (40,2)

Path of The Azure Talon

Requirements: Must have B skill

Gains Lightning Bolt 1/day that can only be used through a two handed sword in place of a damage blow. (50,3)

May cast Lightning Bolt through a two handed sword instead of at range. Grants 1 mana off, stacks with expertise.

Path of The Lost Pilgrim

Requirements: Must be a spirit user

Whenever the character is in any kind of Church or Shrine gains a major prayers worth of information about the faith. If remains in the area gains an additional major prayer every 15 minutes about the faith.

Immune to becoming "lost" (in the nacht or similar)

Path of Primal Acceptance

Requirements: None

Gains the Eagle Talisman.

May buy the upgrades to the Falcon Talisman.

May still fly and be carried by fliers after being restored to life.

Grinners

The goblins of Shiret, Grinners are small, yellow skinned tribals with mouths that seem to split their whole face open into great wide toothed smiles. They are conniving, but more interested in eating metal than actively

pursuing much of any other goal. That said, the allure of rare materials is often enough to get them travelling to strange and wonderful places.

System rules

Grinners are as Goblins except:

Grinners do not gain racial DAC, nor double Dac while fleeing (and cannot buy upgrades related around this). However, they do gain E skill and are able to wear metal armour (only) however they never gain the benefits of master crafted armour due to chewing on it regularly. They have not been accepted by Primus's Goblins and may not join goblin tribes without express permission of the guild head on dungeon.

Bite in half: ½ levels a Grinner may physically shatter an object with a single "snap" of their teeth with a range of touch (does not need to use their head, a hand touch is enough). If the object successfully breaks, this heals them 6tblp.

At 8th level they may shatter objects (without the healing) at will, but takes 2 minutes per object shattered.

Strong Teeth: Upgrades a single "Bite in Half" to be a Grand Weapon Blow instead, costing 30 points on table 9, max 2.

Stormvale

The Island of Stormvale is some 30 miles out from the Scarlene Coast. The Island is relatively small and circular measuring only about 20 miles across. At the centre of the Island is a huge mountain known as Drake Peak. Historically its residents have been very insular. Their primary trade has been acting as a port and trade hub for all those travelling between the East, Port Mierre and Scarlene.

The Island's history is swamped in legend. It is said that the Blue and the Green Dragon's fought high above these waters during the Chaos Wars. As their magics mingled together an egg was formed which plummeted from the sky. As the egg struck the ocean both air and water took solid form and a great island rose up around the egg to protect it. It is rumoured that within the centre of the Island still protects the Stormdrake Egg to this very day.

The residents of stormvale are largely human. Their skin is covered in blue and green markings. They are blessed of the Stormdrake and wield powers bestowed on them both of blue and green magics.

In IM 1013 a great disaster befell the Vale. A great storm erupted and surrounded the Island. A number of mercenaries lead by Jhor Blackfin and Petulia Hylos managed to erect a stable gateway through the Nacht connecting the mainland to Stormvale such that mercenaries could travel to the Vale to uncover the cause of these storms.

Later that year it was discovered that at the previous Dawn where the Onyx and Jade Dragons took their rise there was turbulence amongst all of the dragons. This started to weaken the Storkdrake that protected the Vale and as such the land became unstable. Each of the natives lost their connection with either water or air and they formed two distinct factions. Brother and Sister took up arms against one another. They believed that only one side of the Drake's magics could live on and that the side which fell away would perish.

In late IM 1013 a number of mercenaries travelled to the Vale to put an end to the problems with the Stormdrake and bring stability to the region. One their arrival they discovered that a particular Sect (at that time proscribed by the inquisition) had took up residence in the Vale. A great dark castle loomed over the region and the dead had started to rise.

These mercenaries brought peace to the two warring factions and united them against the Cult who had managed to steal the Stormdrake Egg. It was returned to its rightful position and rum our has it that the Cult were the ones who had weakened the Drake originally rather than the warring dragons. As such magics returned to the native people and peace was restored once more. The Isle has been stabalised over the last 2 Dawns by the Inqusition. It is now once again a bustling hub of trade and industry. The stable portal between Stormvale and the Scarlene Coast is still used now for trade purposes. At the Scarlene end it opens nearby to the village of Bream's Folly.

Stormvale Human – Playable Race
It is now possible to play a native of Stormvale. They have a full spirit and are otherwise as a human. They may select either Air or Aquatic Elf innates and start with these innate at first level (as an elf). They may not buy double or triple innates but may buy the set of innates which they did not start with for 80 points post 8th on table 5. Due to the Island's insular nature they may not join Political Guilds.

The Free Republic of Sweethaven

The Free Republic of Sweethaven consists of the villages of Sweethaven, Tarnstead, Graycott and Riverbend along with the Battered Skull Tribe of Orcs. The Republic is nestled in the Heartlands a short ride from the River Windrush and the trade road that follows it. Since defeating the demonic and unliving forces that threatened their homes the common folk have started to look to their place in the wider world. The Free Republic was born from the beliefs in the power of the common Peon to protect Primus, care for one's fellows and a rejection of the feudal system imposed in the rest of Primus. Acting as a democracy based around "talking about it like adults" the Free Republic has voted to confirm the local noble, one Zacharias Ward. Talks are also in progress regarding electing a Mayor of each village to help with the day-to-day running of the Republic, how power will be wielded and by whom. Only time will tell whether the Free Republic will prosper or not.

Any Human or Orc may choose to be a member of the Free Republic of Sweethaven at the time of character creation. Any other character may join the Free Republic on an appropriately themed adventure after a majority vote.

Members of the Free Republic may choose to have various rituals of Soul Binding enacted upon them. This causes the character to become a Yeoman. This choice can only be made as a starting character. They are not Imperial Yeomanry - all references are replaced with The Free Republic of Sweethaven. If this choice is made then they may only join Social guilds that are tied to Sweethaven or The Yeomanry (Although some of these guilds might specify Imperial Yeoman only).

Members of the Free Republic may choose to be a "Revolutionary" - this is as per the Dishonoured One status but with regards to The Empire not Amlas. This choice may be made at any time but all previous ranks must be purchased at once.

May only join political guilds which exist to further the cause of The Free Republic of Sweethaven.

The Owil'rha'tha

The Owil'rha'tha are a group of people who were once a tribe in the southern part of the Empire. Their lands were some of the first to be taken by the emerging magiocracies and they became nomads who wandered around and through the magiocracies and the lands of other tribes.

They frequently stole livestock, carried off women and generally got into fights with other tribes. They frequently suffered attempts by other groups to crush them or even to wipe them out totally. This of course all became recorded in their histories as a litany of wrongs done to their people by just about everyone.

Their religion had rapidly turned to a worship of the darkest of their totem spirits - a faith born of fear of a deity that frequently punished them for lack of faith or offerings, that was offered worship and sacrifices to grant them revenge against their enemies and that would one day lead them to back to ownership of their promised lands. He is known as the Felwathen, which has several meanings - the Watcher of Evil, the Silence of Men or the Dark Stalker. (Fel meaning man or evil, Wathen meaning watcher, stalker or silence)

Faced with frequent attacks and many of their people dying, history is recorded partly by written word and picture. Some of their books are vast litanies of grievances. However, this lore is supplemented by a willingness to summon the undead spirits of their ancestors for a chat, and the presence within their groups of undead made from the more potent old members of the tribe. To them it is considered an honour to be marked as one to be raised as undead when they die, usually in a corporeal form.

The original tribal name has fallen out of use and they became known as the Owil-rhatha. Owil is the tribal word for darkness, night, unwelcome surprise & rhatha is nomad, wanderer or bastard. They take it to mean 'The Wanderers in the Darkness' but other tribes were happy to understand it as 'Unwelcome bastards' or 'Night skulkers'.

In modern times the Owilrhatha found it easier to survive as scattered communities in the Empire than among the tribes. They have become far more civilised in nature but remain clannish in their relationships, marrying within their own kind or at least insisting any spouses are brought into their religion. Such initiations usually involve the new member proving themselves with a human sacrifice.

In recent years though they are more regularly forced to relocate by the acts of militant goodly faiths than tribal conflicts. They are, as one might guess, a generally evil people, seeing their own acts as always justified by the circumstances but any wrong done to them as a sign of the manifest oppression that they unfairly suffer.

The Black Tarot

A common tool used by them is a set of tarot cards known as the black tarot. It consists of a major arcane and a minor arcana of four suits. The suit of bones represents the passion and emotions, governing matters spiritual. Blades is the suit of action, authority and righteous revenge. Chalices is the suit of artifice, study, visions and pleasure. The chalice may hold poison, blood, alcohol, drug or potion after all. Scrolls covers business, acquisition and matters practical.

The major arcane vary from group to group but common cards include "The Murderess" and "The Oppressor" who appear as paladinic figures, "The Crossroads", being that between life, undeath and oblivion and "The Willing Ingénue", an innocent fascinated by the mysterious and dark.

The cards of the Black Tarot are often used as ritual foci. Common uses include the obfuscation of spiritual information powers (not necessarily a complete block, but weakening them or making them more painful or difficult to use), weakening people against necromantic powers and acting as summoning foci for an undead – often the undead must be backed up into the card when dismissed to stop it being re-summoned.

Player Character Owil'Rha'Tha:

Owil'Rha'Tha must be human (initially) and may not be goodly. They may be warriors, rangers, archers, unholy champions, fighters, duellists or blade - masters, any scout class bar beggar (they are wanderers not tied enough to any city), wizard, warlock, any priest class bar shaman, grey warden or guardian of the balance. Priest classes may not join another church, their ancestral faith counts as their church – it is not possible to leave this "church" without being excommunicated (they are very vengeful).

Priest classes gain the following miracle list based on their faith in their dark totemic spirits. The number of evil spirits means they are ostracised for it (but not outlawed, this is not a black guild) – to use it however they must take the clan benefits in place of their professional or political guild.

Lawful Evil Miracle List:
1st: Halt, Taint Spirit
2nd: Cause Wound
3rd: Curse, Talk to Spirit, Protection From Spirits, Cause Serious Wounds
4th: Create Ghoul, Communication, Cause Disease
5th: Spiritual Invisibility, Cause Grievous Wounds
6th: Control Wraith
7th: Animate Corpse, Suspend Life
8th: Touch of Death

Note that although their origins were tribal, they have become sufficiently civilised that they do not count as barbarians or tribal now.

Realm of Caeruin (and the Tales of the Black Company)

The world of Dia is one in which evil has triumphed, thanks in large part to the ruthless cunning of a band of champions and agents of the High King, known as The Company of the Crocodile. The forces of light are scattered, broken and crippled. However, the realm is large and the High King's forces are still finite, so sparks of resistance still flicker from place to place and forces once united by the common goal of conquest now start to warily eye each other over the division of spoils.

Background

Within the Realm of Caeruin, the greatest power is the High King. Much of the continent of Thernea lies under his sway – many lesser kings, princes, dukes, theocrats and chieftains of an array of races pledge fealty to him for their lands, with varying degrees of willingness. None disobey openly however – those who have in the past are ornaments upon the road of skulls that leads to the capital, endlessly bewailing their error of judgement.

The High King is said to be immortal, commanding great powers of magic and pacts with all of the Dark Pantheon. His true origins are not commonly known. Centuries ago he came to power in the land of Ibatrus and piece by piece added the neighbouring states as either conquests or willing vassals to the rising power. His might is not limitless however – fifty years ago his forces were checked by the so called Free League – a rag-tag alliance of the eastern realms of the continent, who gathered to together under the leadership of the heroic King Athain of Prydell. At the battle of Iceford, the two kings came face to face, the young paladin daring the High King into a duel of champions. King Athain„s blade was had been greatly ensorcelled by the pious preachers of the Halls of Light, said to have been bathed in the tears of the Goddess Kagathia herself. When it struck the High King but once, he was sorely wounded and forced to quit the field. Dazed and confused without their leader, his forces were defeated in battle and driven back to their current borders.

The High King recovered from the terrible wound received and has spent the intervening decades rebuilding his forces and re-entrenching. King Athain, was slain by an assassin's knife and his holy sword disappeared. This last year, a sustained campaign of espionage, sabotage and assassination by a particularly devious band of agents crippled many of the forces and defences of the Free League. Allies were turned upon each other, charismatic leaders assassinated by stealth or by summoned demon, holy sites and temples of light were turned to darkness. So complete was the preparation, the forces of the High King stormed into Prydell with ease.

King Gwydion, Athain‟s son, marshaled his remaining forces and put up a fierce final stand. However, he was defeated by the same band that had so crippled his defenses and was finally cut down by the now and unhallowed blade that once belonged to his father, wielded by Rufio, a man they call the Kingslayer. After this defeated, those who would fight for Prydell fled into hiding or exile, the remainder surrendered.

With Prydell conquered, the other nations of the Free League sued for peace and so fell under the sway of darkness. One of the side effects of the war however was the opening of a portal to Labyrinthia from Prydell. King Gwydion's wizards opened the portal of light to bring through Labyrinthian mercenaries in the last desperate stages of the war. The mercenaries, fared poorly and were killed or driven off and the portal is under the control of the High King's champions. Some few loyal servants may have been allowed to pass through it to explore this new land. The techniques needed to open the portal remain in the hands of the desperate remnants of the Free League however.

Servants of the High King – The Lands of Caeruin

Ibatrus

The original realm of the High King, Ibatrus is now the capital of a much greater state. High, strong walls of dark stone protect the city itself, its towers flickering with eldritch green fire by night. The headquarters of the numerous Royal Societies, guilds answerable only to his majesty sit here, training apprentices and hold great libraries of secret lore and collections of artifacts. Also, there are cathedrals to each of the Dark Pantheon and

great forges to arm the royal troops with both arcane and mundane equipment.

The Vampire Lords of Brecorisaria

A bewildering array of titles – Herzog, Graf, Margraf, Count and the like are claimed by the lords of a miserable and mountainous region – the most potent among them claims the title of Prince and a seat at the High King‟s council – this title often changes hands. Many have been shut up in their castles for decades, studying obscure arcanepowers, indulging their passions or simply pondering the ennui of eternal unlife. They, their knights and personal guards are a fearsome force when they do take the field however. Their people are long used to paying their taxes in blood as well as coin in return for protection, indeed more than a few attractive young people have actively sought out the attentions of the vampires, trading on their looks and accepting having their blood drained as fair trade for a life as a pampered pet instead of grubbing in the frozen mud.

Within these lands, actually being embraced, turned into a vampire is regarded as a great honour, akin to knighthood, and carries similar social status. It is said that the first vampires were brought back to unlife by a few drops of blood of one of the Dark Pantheon and many claim to be able to trace their infernal ancestry back to one of those evil gods, calling themselves “child of (whichever name)‟. Many however speak little of their ancestry to the mortals, watching the living go about their tedious existences from behind their steepled fingers, the default pose of a well to do vampire.

Over the years the vampires have created servants from their kindred creatures – the ratfolk are their most commonly seen creations – their clans and breeds now numerous, but wolfen and batfolk (statwise – having primal soul wolf/bat respectively) show up from time to time.

Blackbriar

Within this unseelie court, dark elves, trolls, goblins and evil fae all pledge allegiance to Prince Hemlock. The lands of Blackbriar are not contiguous in a geographical sense but pockets within the realms of the other princes – the dark centres of the forests, deep caves and the like. As might be expected there are often scuffles between the unseelie and those who claim the lands around them.

The Beastlands

The high king keeps many tribal creatures cooped up on an area of very poor land. The various tribes are paid to supply the royal armies with recruits - proven warriors especially. As the only real source of wealth and goods, this keeps them fighting among themselves to prove who is worthy but in constant flux as the winning tribe is weakened by the loss of recruits. Those recruited have any tribal loyalties, nonsense about totem spirits and / or inclinations to put bones through their noses beaten out of them by the drill sergeants. The resultant soldiers look down on tribal types as weaklings, not tough enough to join a real army or worship real gods. A few wilier types manage to escape without joining the army and some are truer to their tribal heritage

Marrowcastle

A great fortress city in the north, its walls cemented with the bones of fallen fighters, Marrowcastle holds the High King‟s northern flank against the winter elves and keeps a watchful eye on the northern tribes, whose loyalties change with the winds. The tribes used to side with the High King one day and the Free League the next. Ironically, with the collapse of the Free League, they find their position very shaky now. A great cathedral to Dameos lies here and a great number of the Hellknights are based here.

Principality of Galinorn

The southerly parts of the kingdom are rich in agricultural land. Grapes and grain grow here in abundance, tended by armies of serfs and slaves. Without these lands, the rest of the kingdom would likely starve. The powerful entertain themselves with sumptuous banquets and gladiatorial games. Galinorn‟s ports are the common point of trade to Euphabas in the south, through which all manner of interesting goods flow.

The Reunited Kingdom of Rochelleme

Rochelleme was once part of the Free League and represents a recent victory for the agents of the High King. Always a country in the firm grip of its nobility, the only way out of poverty for most of the peasantry was the church and many resented the wealth and power it had obtained. Playing on this resentment, travelling in secret, preachers of the Dark Pantheon recruited many to their view of the gods. The decadent nobility embraced this with as much glee as the oppressed peasantry. Inevitably this lead to civil war – the king of Rochelleme's younger brother threw in his lot with the believers of the Dark Pantheon and fought for the throne as a champion of religious freedom. Initially the younger brother only held sway in Western Rochelleme, the Eastern part remaining true to the Halls of Light and the Free League. Eastern Rochelleme fared relatively well in the last war – it was not successfully invaded. The nobility recognised that it could not hold out indefinitely however once Prydell had been crushed. They negotiated a peace treaty and reunification of the country, swearing allegiance to the western king and through him the High King. Their previous monarch was swiftly disposed off in a palace revolt and the churches of light shown the door.

Many of the peasantry are actually relatively happy with this state of affairs – they still pay huge taxes, but no longer get the moral lectures. Some folk, commoner and noble remain quietly devout to the Halls of Light – priest holes, hidden shrines and secret worship abound.

A small court of plane travelling Ancient Folk have settled within what was Western Rochelleme, drawn to the entertainments of the court and have been accepted as guests and advisors of the King.

Rochelleme is also noted for its duelling academy that teaches elegant styles of swordsmanship to any of suitable social standing – they teach that combat can be almost an art form and the true mark of a gentleman is to kill ones foes stylishly.

The Marchlands

These lands are the centre of where earlier wars were fought, marking one of the major fronts between the High King and the Free League. Blackened and blasted by ritual magics, littered with ruins and corpses, they are of little value to most. The High King‟s council has decreed that any who can take and hold a chunk of the march lands can call themselves marcher-lord and claim the rights of nobility. Many have discovered this is a fool‟s errand as these lands hold few resources. There are those with reason to come here - scavengers, desperate fugitives from the law in either group of kingdoms, brigands using it as a base to raid the surrounding lands, members of the Royal Society of Necromancers and Anatomists looking for the bodies of great heroes of either side, and now of course, rebels and refugees who will not submit the High King‟s rule

The Principality of the Silver Spires

A group of Gythyanki moved here from the astral plane some years ago, seeking a place to rebuild their strength and their numbers. They quickly formed an alliance with the High King and have provided him with many useful agents. They occupy land that they conquered from the Free League – a duchy once famed for the psychic powers of the ruling family. They captured the duke‟s castle and have embellished it with complex baroque towers and observatories.

The Isles of Mist

Off the west of the continent lie the Islands of Mist. Either perpetually shrouded in fog or drenched in torrential rain, even those of the Cartographers and Explorers cannot claim to know their number or reliably find the same island twice. These are said to be the point at which Dia and her children first walked upon land and made many creatures. A great many fantastical beasts are said to live upon these isles, along with some of the most ancient undead spirits. The Explorers have brought back strange creatures from some of these islands and bred them to act as troops. The most famous of such are the Dragonkin, a race of warmth loving lizardmen, most grateful to be off the islands and the magic eating Cave-Wights, brought to feed upon the elves of the Free League (and to keep the Unseelie of Blackbriar in line)

Groups Within the Kingdom

The Royal Societies

Founded directly by the High King to preserve skill and learning alongside the martial might of his hordes, there are numerous societies with a royal charter that grants them much independence. Each is arranged on similar lines, with a guild leader whose authority rivals that of the princes of the realm or the prelates of the dark pantheon. Reporting to the guild head is a council of masters – those who through some great work have proven their expertise in this field – the masters of course jockey for position for the right to be next guild head. Beneath them are the journeymen – sent out on errands and missions for the guild, often assigned to the command of the princes or generals to perform a task as a favour to them – each looking for their potential masterwork to elevate their status. Beneath them are apprentices who toil for the masters within the guild as they learn their craft or science.

The Royal Society of Explorers and Cartographers

Nominally responsible for map mapping, embassies to foreign lands and the conducting of censuses, they act as spies when abroad and secret police at home. Their former Master, DeVries, was assassinated in a plot instigated by the last head of the Apothecaries and Artificers. Their star is very much in the ascendant however, as their agents were the key force in the recent destruction of the Free League. Many wait with interest to see who comes out on top as the new guildmaster.

The Royal Society of Necromancers and Anatomists

Entitled to the corpses of any of the lower classes and with access to the bone strewn battlefields of the last war, the society applies scientific precision to the dark arts of necromancy. They are particularly keen on finding the remains of ancient, potent or rare dead beings, such that they might create more unusual undead for their masters. The society is much excited by the recently uncovered lore and rites retrieved from the ancient lich Kendric by the necromancer Saskia Roselle – the power to animate a whole hoard of undead at once is much sought after.

The Royal Society of Apothecaries and Artificers

Experts in poisons, caches and traps, they put their knowledge to use as assassins, specialising in accidents. They also created many golems, and drug addled slave-soldiers. There was always a rivalry between them and the Cartographers, which was brought to a head when they discovered that misinformation planted by Cartographer agents to distract the Free League from their operations lead to a group of their own forces being badly outnumbered and defeated with heavy casualties. Their former leader instigated a plot to assassinate the Cartographers‟ guildmaster and pin the blame on the group of agents mentioned earlier. The assassination worked, but the agents were able to unravel the scheme and lay the blame at the correct door. They slew the Artificers‟“ guild master and many of his council. Of the surviving society members, many are now wanted traitors on the run, the rump of the guild is a shadow of its former self.

The Royal Society of Philosophers and Astrologers

– wizards and demonologists – they are associated with the bizarre entities thought to be the children of Kerkya, exiled beyond the stars. Their last head, Doctor Goethe, proved to be a crazed traitor, feeding information to the Free League in an attempt to make the struggle more evenly balanced, so there would be more slaughter and destruction at a time when the stars were right. He was unmasked and slain by the same band of champions who defeated King Gwydion of Prydell. Many would love to have access to his grimoire of secret demonic lore, rumoured to have been taken from him by a sorceress called Inara.

The Hell-Knights

– Followers of Dameos, heavily armoured black knights who drink the blood of demons to gain their strength and fortitude. Their number also include chirugeons whose medicine involves taking body parts for fallen foes, demons and other beasts and turning these into strange forms of medicine, to impart the strengths of the slain creature to the one consuming it.

The Covenant of Winter Midnight

A circle of wizards who train in a tower of ice upon the frozen wastes, far north of Marrowcastle. They are said to wield powers of ice magic despite their dark alliances, but are very few in number

The Daughters of Saena

– an order of nuns who worship that goddess, they have been given responsibility for taking in orphans within the High King‟s realm. They baptise the children in unholy water and bring them up with a firm moral code. When they reach adulthood, many of the boys become squires and eventually Hellknights or priests of the Dark Pantheon. The girls often join the order as nuns or priestesses, but many have become wives to the nobility. Through their graduates the order controls many a baron or warlord, and has considerable subtle political power as a result. Recently the First Daughter, leader of the order, has decreed the construction of a new orphanage within the conquered capitol of Prydell – to ensure that the orphans of the war do not grow up with the same misguided religious views their parents held and has asked her protégé Sister Alys to take the role of abbess.

The Weeping Thorn Tribe

– a tribe of goblins within Blackbriar who serve Prince Hemlock. Though small in number they are wise in herb lore, dark spirits and fae magic. The Prince values them as cunning agents – they have gained much prestige through the deeds of Blends With Blood, one of their number who Hemlock sent to serve as one of the High King‟s agents.

Duergar

– Also known as The Banished Dwarves or Dark Dwarves. Dwarven Clans who came to the surface and sold both armaments and lore in Ibratrus and Marrowcastle. Through sharing of lore with the crafters of Caeruin, they have gained much prestige and learned to combine their workings with rune lore and similar supernatural powers. While selling the goods they have made is normal for Dwarves, sharing of lore is not, and for this they were declared banished by Balinor, the Under King. This lead to them wholeheartedly throwing in their lot with the High King and more of the other clans aligning to the Free League – the banished dwarves often raid the other clans when they get the chance. Given recent events the Duergar feel it's all worked out rather well for them.

Characters from the lands of the High King are now playable

As per human, except they may only be of any non-goodly alignment. Priest classes who follow the Dark Pantheon may create their own hermit list. This list must be evil in alignment. They count as being non-primal. They may choose to be "Loyal" – in which case, they may battleboard one benefit from the Dark Faith options, and may choose one of the factions to be a member of. Loyalty and the choice of faction (explorers, philosophers or shadewrights) must be chosen and written onto card.

Loyal characters may not be in any other guilds, except any that are specifically for Loyal Caeruin. Should they join any other guild they lose the ability to claim these benefits forever after (and will be considered a defector or traitor by many back home)

A small but significant group of Duergar are followers of the Old Faith, as druidic ways are called.

Caeruin Groups

The Dark Faiths

The members are the lay followers of the various members of the pantheon. These guilds are not mutually exclusive as people often pray to more than one of the pantheon. Of course you can only battleboard one at a time, representing the one you have been most fervent towards recently. Anyone with a spirit may join these, even if not a priest, and they may use the benefits even if they are not in the priest bracket.

The groups that revere Kerykia are not out in the open or organised enough to grant such benefits.

Restrictions – may not join or be a member of any non-Caeruin faith.

Faithful of Hebsia

2/day, for 5 mins, gains neutrality to undead (1st-5th level only) req. calling on their faith to use. Create Ghoul 1/day

Faithful of Vahauka

Gains acute hearing. Cause Grievous 1/day (full verbal)

Faithful of Irus

Gains slightly scaly skin – granting +1 innate PAC but must have scaly make-up at least on the face. Spirit shield 1/day (full verbal)

Faithful of Saena

Gains disguise skill. Charming Words - 1/day after talking to a target for 5 minutes, may use any domination effect at +1 level of casting Spiritual Deception 1/day

Faithful of Iapetus

Gains read languages as per scout. Comm I 1/day (full verbal)

Faithful of Mordanis

+1 Level of Resistance to Spirits for 5 mins the first time required per day. Voice of Power 1/day (affecting up to but not including 8th level)

Faithful of Dameos

Gains immunity to fear. Knockback 1/day. Spiritdart 1/day (full verbal)

One of the Old Faith

Pre-requisites – Respect the ancient druidic traditions and the memory of Dia. Those without a spirit may join this faith.

Restrictions – gains purest self defence restriction vs druids and other members of the old faith.

Benefits – Benefits from a perm Barkskin granting +2 innate PAC

Druidic Heal 1/day

The Royal Society of Explorers and Cartographers

Nominally responsible for map mapping, embassies to foreign lands and the conducting of censuses, they act as spies when abroad and secret police at home. Restrictions – cannot have restricted intelligence. May not learn to make traps or buy cache related abilities Benefits – Gains tracking. This upgrades to enhanced tracking if tracking already possessed.

Gains a physical psi-scan 1/day (as per emotion sensitive). Gains solitaire 1/day for 5 minutes

The Royal Society of Philosophers and Astrologers

Wizards and demonologists and their assistants – they are associated with the bizarre entities thought to be the children of Kerkya, exiled beyond the stars. Restrictions – may not be goodly. Benefits –

Gains discern demonkind (note this also includes angelkind). 1/day may wardpact demons (not angels) at 8th level effect. 1/day after a 15 minute appropriate ritual, may add a published grimoire sorcery spell to their list of spells known for a period of 1 hour. They take casting damage as if reading a teaching scroll (i.e. double normal casting damage) unless a sentient being is sacrificed as part of the ritual

The Shadewrights

The Shadewrights are group who seek to learn and share in the powers of black mana. Mages give some of their time to teach and research, being given access to laboratories and libraries funded by the money or service on the non-wizard members. The killing of a white mana user of course is a source of much bragging rights in the society. Restrictions – may never use a white mana spell, glyph or item

Benefits – See Through Magical Darkness 1/day Darkness Self 1/day. Mortality 1/day

The Former Free League

The Conquered Kingdom of Prydell – previously the central kingdom of the Free League and one that claimed some degree of leadership. It was always Prydell that rallied the other nations of the league. Prydell has been conquered by the High King, its defences having been crippled by the cunning schemes of his servants. At a final battle outside the capital, the last king, Gwydion, was slain by the hand of Rufio, now known to some as the Kingslayer.

The Conquered Kingdom of Merrikeep

Once a happy and prosperous land – its farmlands are bounteous and rich. Previously jolly halflings engaged in bucolic pursuits and fae of the Seelie Court gambolled in the woods and wild places, emerging to join the humans for feast days and fetes. Merrikeep surrendered to the High King when Prydell was conquered. The Seelie have retreated to their hidden places. Those servants of the High King sent to administer the realm have found that no matter how much you abuse them, getting an honest day's work out of a Halfling is an impossibility – they drop dead if overly harshly treated, but if not their capacity for slacking, pilfering, sabotage or simply escaping to the wild places is unrivalled.

Eastern Rochelleme

Formerly a land firmly ruled by its chivalric leaders and the church of the Hall of Light. Now reunited with the Western part of the once divided nation – see earlier entry. Cavaliers and duellists still abound.

The Lawbringers of Crius

Priests and paladins of the lord of justice, who encouraged those in the lands of the Free League to engage in

proper and just behaviour – sometimes with a greater or lesser degree of compulsion depending on which land they were in. These days the followers of Crius are forced to operate in secret – their remaining hidden temples nests of resistance against the High King.

The Paladins of Kagathia

Fierce opponents of all they call evil or foul and most especially the undead, these holy knights once roamed the free league, driving their foes deep underground. The paladins only recruit among those they regard as beautiful and swear to remain celibate whilst in the order. Supposedly they seek out their true love and leave the order, returning to the secular world to marry, their days of questing done. Like the Crius followers they too have been driven underground now. Rumours abound of members of the order carrying off relics, great works of art and treasures to hidden places and foreign lands. It is said that they are become expert at passing information through a system of symbolism and metaphor – poems, songs and pictures carrying messages to the faithful.

The Brethren of Argus

Healers who take the responsibility for the long-term health of their charges, they espouse tough love, preaching temperance and abstinence. They have been known to burn down breweries and were recently rumoured to have kidnapped some of the fattest citizens of Merrikeep, forcing them to exercise and eat only bread and water. By and large they are relatively pacifist and do not oppose the occupation of the Free League openly.

The King's Wardens

Originally the personal guard of the King of Prydell, these expanded into a secret service and acted as his agents both at home and abroad. They crossed swords, or more frequently daggers with the Royal Societies on many an occasion. They are believed to be the backbone of resistance against the High King – guerrilla warfare is something at which they excel.

The Seelie Elves

Pockets of the seelie court overlap the lands of the free league – light, winter and goodly elves and dwarves comprise the majority of their people. They are stalwart foes of the Dark Pantheon but many argue that humans and suchlike are tainted and impure due to association with Morganis, and that they should stand alone. Since the fall of Prydell, they have increasingly retreated to hidden glades and the more inaccessible fae sites.

The Dwarf Holds

The dwarves have sometimes come out of their mountain holds at the call of the Free League. They have often supplied it with armaments to rival those of Ibatrus and are now a refuge for many who will not submit. Much as the High King would like to see them crushed, rooting them out of their heavily fortified homes is not going to be an easy task. The dwarves have a long running rivalry with the followers of Irus the Dragon Cloaked, and this feud seems to have transferred to the Dragonkin also.

Neutral Powers

Characters can now be started as refugees from the free league that have fled to Primus. They have taken something of a beating so get few benefits.

Priests of the pantheon of light must use the independent guild list for those classes that would need to join a church.

Followers of Eleria may be grey wardens or guardians of the balance and use the normal rules for such classes. Likewise hermit priests (the class) and friars work as normal

They count as being non-primal.

They may be humans, elves, halflings, dwarves or faeries.

Such refugee characters may join labyrinthian guilds, but count as being 2 tables lower than they are for the purposes of claiming benefits.

Their stats are intentionally bad to reflect their desperate state. These might of course change based on player actions in future.

The Sea Wolves

Raiders from the eastern isles. A mix of humans, aquatic elves and sea alfar, these pirates often raid coastal settlements. Occasionally they show up as mercenaries in a land based conflict. They care little who their fight for, seeking gold and glory.

Sea Wolf characters may be human barbarians, sea alfar or aquatic elves, following the normal rules for such, with the following changes. They are non-primal - They gain guild benefits one table later than normal.

The Southern Continent

An unscrupulous trading nation, Euphabas, lies across the seas to the south. Its robed merchants happily deal in drugs, poisons and slaves and consider it the high of rudeness to ask the provenance of anything. Their sorcerers are skilled in the summonation of djinn and efreeti. The services of their slayers' guild are available to any with the coin. The slayers membership on the northern continent have suffered a number of losses of late, but there remain many in the southern lands. Those require the services of a slayer in the north are commonly advised to seek out the services of Ivan and Rufio, said to be the new masters of the slayers' guild in the north. Often veiled, these assassins are reported to have a vast range of powers – perhaps because they recruit those with a range of talents but dress alike. Eupahabas lies along the northern coast of this continent – other kingdoms lie further south still. Within the deserts of Euphabas, scorpion men in thick carapaces are a major threat to travellers, as are the giant scorpions they keep as pets.

The Euphabans are a matriarchal society and will only attack women in self-defence. They worship the goddesses of the pantheons of both Light and Dark – Eleria, Vauhauka, Kagathia and Saena, who they refer to as the "four goddesses". Some expand this to the "five goddesses" to include Hebsia or even "the six goddesses" to include Kerkya, but such people are as much outcasts in the south as worshippers of Kerkya

Euphaban characters are human and may be the following classes - assassin, warrior, scout, ranger, archer, wizard, sorcerer (human sorcerer gaining life as per warlock), rogue, hermit priest, grey warden or guardian of the balance, following the normal rules for such, with the following changes:

They are non-primal. They gain guild benefits one table later than normal. They gain healing potion facility as per the scout specialist skill and the ability to use it

would be in the north.

The Ice Tribes

In the north around Marrowcastle, numerous tribes of nomadic barbarians scratch an existence alongside the winter elves. Some pledged loyalty to the high king one day and the free league the next, others call no one friend. A complex array of feuds and alliances exists between the tribes. Ironically those who once served as mercenaries are now finding their position tenuous – unable to play one side off against the other, they worry that the Hell Knights may just decide to conquer them all now and have been forced to distance themselves from their former paymasters.

Ice Tribe characters are human barbarians, following the normal rules for such, with the following changes:

They are non-primal

They gain/may buy guild benefits one table later than normal. They may, 1/day, gain 1⁄2 effect cold as per tables (lasting 5 mins). They may, on table 3, upgrade this to immunity cold (as published table 3 ability) for 50pts. They may be humans, elves, halflings, dwarves or faeries.

The Dispossessed

War, famine and other disasters have created numerous refugees within the realm. Beggars and vagrants, they wander from town to town or even state to state seeking seasonal work or what little charity there is to be found. They are frequently "moved on", often by force, even within the so called goodly lands. Some among them are skilled at forming a mystic connection with whatever settlement they are in and drawing some power from it to help them adapt to the place.

The dispossessed are often hired for dirty work as disposable ruffians by many groups in the land, but those proving themselves skilled and useful can still rise far as they are reputed to be sneaky and devious sorts by all – the one-handed brigand known as Aces High was recently honoured as one of the champions key to the fall of Prydell, although rumour has it he was latter slain in the turf war between the Societies of Artificers and of Cartographers.

Gods and Legends

The Creation Myth

In the beginning the land was empty and void. No living thing existed, save for Dia, the spirit and essence of the land itself. She was lonely and bored by the fact she had nothing but the wind and water for company. One day she cried at the emptiness and sadness of existence. Where her tears fell, the ground became soft and fertile clay and green shoots started to appear. She took them and shaped them into pretty patterns that pleased her. These became plants and grew. She decorated the world with many plants and was gladdened by their appearance. The wind and the water were pleased with these and spread these green things about the land.

Dia wandered the land, admiring her creations. One day she cut herself upon a rock. Where the blood fell upon earth it sparkled and fizzed with potential. She grabbed it and shaped it into a new thing – an intricate little beetle that crawled away of its own accord, without needing the wind or the water to carry it. Fascinated she worked with the remaining clay, making all manner of little creatures that scurried away to feed on the plants. She willingly wounded herself that more blood should fall upon the ground, to give her more material to work with as she made more and more complex animals.

The First Children

Dia enjoyed the presence of her animals and they amused her, but she was still bored. She yearned for company and realised that if her tears and blood alone were such potent forces, within her body there must be a mighty source of creative power. By this idea alone she conceived a child. He was born in the daylight and she named him Asteron. Fed by first her milk and then her other creations he grew and had thoughts and ideas of his own and for the first time she had someone to talk to and this gave her great joy.

In time, she thought that perhaps she might make another child and by this idea conceived again. This child was born at night. She hugged him and fed him but did not see him properly until the next day. When the day dawned she yelped with surprise because he looked very different to his brother and she had not expected this. The firstborn took this as a sign his mother loved him more and grew arrogant from this – from that

moment on he assumed he was more important than any of her other children and that it was his right to rule. The second boy grew however and she named him Mordanis. The boys laughed and played and fought with each other as boys are want to do. Mordanis always resented his brother's attitude however.

Dia had a third thought, that it might be nice to have a child that resembled her more. By this she conceived a daughter. The daughter did indeed resemble her, and was named Hebisa. The mother assumed that a daughter would have the same interest in creation she did. This lead her to a very dark thought – that if her daughter had her power, then perhaps she herself would not always be needed. By this thought she soon conceived Kerkya, Destruction, that killed her in the birthing.

The brothers were horrified by this and hurled Destruction away from their mother – up into the sky and far beyond the stars. It is said that one day it will return and consume the whole world. Hebisa was distraught. She was still very young and had not been fully nourished by her mother's milk. She ate of the plants and animals but was always wan and malnourished, no matter how much she ate.

The Making of Mortal Races

The children grew to adulthood. The brothers were fascinated in creating things but did not have their mother's power to do so. They asked their sister for help but she feared succumbing to her mother‟s fate and would not acquiesce to their desires.

Where the mother had died, her flesh turned to clay. Her children saw that it held more power of creation than the earth enriched by her tears or blood and wondered on what it could make. In the same way that their mother had made the plants and animals, they began to make the thinking races from the mortal clay. Their first experiment they worked upon together and these creatures they called humans. Some human scholars are proud to call themselves the firstborn race. Other races point out that human flaws come from being designed by committee.

Both Asteron and Mordanis looked upon the humans, each seeing things they liked, mostly the elements they had wrought, and things they disliked, mostly being their siblings‟ choices. Hebsia's interest in them was very different. Eternally hungry, she had ensured that they would be tasty to eat then went about devouring them. This caused both brothers much sadness, as they liked their creations and did not like their sister destroying their toys just because she was peckish. They argued with her at great length over this. In the end they all agreed that she could have any of the creations that had been broken – by this agreement she gained dominion over all things that had died.

Whilst Hebsia went about feeding upon the dead people, Asteron and Mordanis each considered how they could make improvements if only they were the sole designer and creator. Each gathered up half of the mortal clay from where their mother had died and began to make creatures their way.

Asteron made races in his image – he sought perfection in appearance and behaviour. Those who did not conform to his fierce standards he squashed back into clay and reshaped. He only worked in the light that he found so akin to – he made the elves of light and other elements, the seelie fae, the jolly halflings and the stout dwarves.

Mordanis was far more tolerant and inventive – he too experimented with the elements, making elves and fae, but he made a great multitude of creatures – orcs, trolls, ogres and goblins – all things that Asteron would have squashed in an instant, but Mordanis took pride in finding a use for even the most lowly and loathsome thing and tended them all.

Hebsia realised too late that she had missed out upon the mortal clay and could not make many creatures of her own. She started to toy with and change those made by the brother that had died. She found how to re-work the mortal clay from which the once living had been made. The things she had remade from the broken clay were what we now know of as the undead.

Families of the Gods

Both brothers noted with interest how the creatures they had made mated and made more by themselves. In time each chose a wife from among the mortals.

Asteron's wife, Eileithyia had several children by him.

The eldest son, Crius, was massively arrogant. He thought being the eldest child of the eldest child entitled him to tell everyone how to behave. He kept going on about just behaviour, which followers of more enlightened gods sum up as saying means just doing what Crius tells you.

The next child, Kagathia, was said by all to be the most beautiful being in existence. Unfortunately, she heard this and it went to her head terribly. When she was not starring at herself in a mirror, which is one of her symbols, Kagathia chased away many of Mordanis‟ creations and Hebsia‟s undead into dark caves or obscure corners of the world, telling them they were too ugly to be seen in the daylight, and they should only come out at night, or not at all. She is associated with or even said to be the sun itself, flying through the sky that all can marvel at her beauty. She shapes burning parts of the sun into angels to further torment those she despises.

Nereus, the second son of Asteron was a joker and prankster who took joy in the embarrassment of others. Forever spying on or interfering with the lives of others or turning his silver tongue to seduction or deceit, he revels in buffoonery and ignorance. Circus folk, bards and entertainers worship him.

Argus, the third son, had the gentlest and softest of hearts and wept copious tears whenever any of the mortals was broken and taken by Hebsia. He spent his time learning to reshape the mortal clay, patching up and mending his father‟s creations. His aunt hates him for denying her her due. He cares so much for the prevention of suffering, he does not even eat the flesh of animals and bars his followers from doing so either. Some sects of followers however can be very self-righteous, proscribing behaviour that is supposedly self-destructive – many are vigorously opposed to drinking alcohol, smoking of tobacco or sedentary lifestyles.

Eleria, youngest daughter of Asteron, was born at night, unlike all of her close family. She never felt at ease with her siblings and was fascinated by the darkness. She found Crius' pomposity, Nereus' pranks and Kagathia's vanity insufferable. She would often visit her aunt Hebsia to get away from them, staying up late into the night and lying in bed during the day. Kagathia said this was because Eleria was jealous of her beauty and shied away from looking at her – she taunted that Eleria would always be her pale reflection. At this, Eleria adopted the Moon as her symbol, and she holds sway over all things changeable and contrary, including the lycanthropes. (Followers of Eleria are normally grey wardens)

Asteron and his family were worshipped by his creations and many of the humans and are known to this day as the Hall of Light. From the power this faith and worship granted, Asteron was able to make the greatest of his creations, which he called Angels, to enforce his will.

Thebis, wife of Mordanis, bore several children also. Her eldest was called Dameos. He was strong, athletic and quick to anger. He was always getting into fights and had the power to turn into a huge bull that trampled all in his way. However, he would not stand for Crius bossing people about and always stood up for those mortals Crius was persecuting. He delights in tests of strength and physical prowess. Dameos has long pursued Kagathia but she has always spurned his advances.

Iapetus was the second son. He was born and feeble, a complete opposite to his older brother. His legs were so crippled he could only get around by walking with a staff. Asterion urged his brother to destroy this wretched son, but Mordanis would not, for he loved all of this children and creations and this showed his wisdom, for Iapetus had been gifted with great intellect to make up for his deformity. He studied all around him and became a master of magic, artifice and lore – he knew well the power of secrets. In stories he often catches the annoying Nereus with cunning traps. He often visited his aunt Hebsia and from her learned the art of making the undead. One day when he visited her, in the pitch dark as normal, his cousin Eleria was there. They spoke at great length – she was most frustrated at life within the Halls of Light and the insufferable behaviour of her siblings. He suggested that she should leave them and come live with him instead. Not able to look upon his crippled form, she judged him by his words and wisdom alone and by this he won her heart. When day dawned, she was open minded enough not to let physical appearances change her mind and became his wife. He is known as the Crippled Prince. Books are sacred to his followers.

Saena was the oldest daughter of Mordanis and Thebis delighted in getting her brothers to do things for her and soon became a mistress of manipulation. Known as The Veiled One, her worshippers are frequently veiled, hooded, masked, disguised or otherwise cloaked. In part this comes because she is famed for tricking Crius and Argus into thinking she was Kagathia in thick robes and a veil, claiming it was to avoid dazzling them with her beauty. She is revered by counsellors and viziers, wives who want to keep control of their husbands, mothers over their sons, spies and actors. Fashion and cosmetics are supposed to be entirely her invention.

The third son, Irus, took a very different path to his cousins and siblings. While they were fascinated by that which lived (or at least shambled), plants, animals and mortals held little interest for him. Instead, the precious and noble metals, all inanimate things crafted with skill and diligence catch his eye. He worked hard to accumulate the most wondrous collection of treasures. He even fashioned himself a shinning coat of beautiful metallic scales – with it, he takes the form of a dragon, the better to seek out more things for his horde. He grants power to his followers in proportion to the size of their own hordes of treasure, for such grant him reverence and honour. The dictum is that "Irus helps those that help themselves". Another saying is "Resting on one's horde only makes it smaller". He is also called "The Shining One"

Vahauka, the younger daughter, had no time for her sister's games. As a child she loved the outdoors and liked to play in Dameos' rough and tumble sports. She had no chance of betting him in tests of strength but discovered she was quick and quiet – hunting became her favourite pass time, especially as Dameos did not have the patience to do it so well as her – she sought out one of every type of Dia's animals and beasts, delighting in the sport of slaying them. After this she moved on to the hunting of mortals as a more exciting challenge. Hunters and assassins often pray to her for luck or guidance. She often helps Iapetus catch Nereus after he has pulled one of his stupid pranks.

Mordanis' family are likewise revered by his created races and by many humans, who call them The Dark Pantheon. Mordanis feared the interference of the Angels upon his worshippers and shaped their belief into Abishai, to remind them they could do as they wished.

As one might expect, there have been many wars in the heavens between the Hall of Light and the Dark Pantheon. Not being made entirely of mortal clay, the brothers and their children cannot easily be claimed by Hebsia, and in the legends they tend to eventually return, whatever their previous fate. The mortal followers however are rarely so lucky and are frequently caught up in the schemes of the gods.

Worship of the Old Ones

While those who revere the Hall of Light or the Dark Pantheon invoke the names of Asteron or Mordanis, those father figures are somewhat intangible to many mortals – most either worship that part of the pantheon as a whole or find a closer relationship to one of the younger generation of gods, who, being closer to mortals are easier to comprehend and hence draw spiritual power from.

Some do worship Hebsia directly. She is a goddess of both Death and Undeath. Most that revere her do so as a simple trade – in return for knowledge or power, they offer worship by slaying the living (which feeds her) and/or the creation of the undead (which pleases her). A few simply pray to her in the hope of being spared an untimely death themselves or for their loved ones.

A few odd people revere Kerkya – it is said that with enough invocation and worship she can be called back to destroy the world. Some are desperate individuals who feel themselves to have been grievously wronged to the point that they would happily be destroyed themselves to bring an end to those they hate. Others, such as the Cult of the Devourer are convinced her return is inevitable and believe destroying things is an act of worship that ensures they are last in line or have some further mad reasoning. Another group, the Bringers of Silence, teach that when Dia's world is destroyed, Kerkya shall remake the fragments into a new and better world and those who have served her shall be reborn in places of honour within it. It is believed by some that in the depths of the void Kerkya has conceived her own children in the manner of her mother and these most alien of creatures can be contacted with great difficulty. Such creatures range from petty servants such as the imp Xiarakez – called on as a dogsbody by sorcerers the land over to the mighty demon of destruction known as Mephos. However, the forms they are able to take when summoned depends very much on the skill of the summoner and the design of the rite used.

Those of druidic beliefs refer to it as “the Old Faith“ and venerate the memory of Dia. Her death is taken as a given however – those few who do learn spiritual powers as well do so by venerating one of her descendants as well.

The Golden City of Rodanne

An extract from the forthcoming book "The Roughest Guide to Rodanne" by Rudolph Winterhaven.

Introduction

Like it or not it cannot be ignored, the fabled city of Rodanne will soon be upon us, and who better than me, one of its former residents to take you through some of the sights and smells of the place?

I say fabled city, but I had never heard of it, not until I bought an enchanted coin and determined to discover where it had come from. Then my adventure really began! In this book I hope to give you a flavour of the place, so light the fire, check those wards, pour a glass of wine and get ready to be transported to that mystical place of wonder, or if you will, cess pit of disease and vice, or look at it another way - at least it isn't Gothiel.

The Aureate Lotus

"It is a wretched hole... so low that we are unable to stand upright. Lying pell-mell on a mattress placed on the ground are Elves, Men, Demons, and even a few Halfling blackguards who have imbibed a taste for Tamarisk."

On the wrong side of the wrong side of town you might be able to find the Golden Lotus Tamarisk den. A creaking three storey wooden building more or less leans on the spot, the only sign that there is anything inside is the shutter in the door, which will spring back the moment you look like you might be about to knock.

"Me effendi? No, I never touch the stuff" Zumurrud the Re-Arranger

The inside is a Shaehan priest's nightmare, past the bald, shoeless bouncer down three flights of creaking wooden stairs to a pungent basement of rooms and alcoves where the patrons lie in various states of soiled euphoria. Smoke hangs perpetually in the air, choking those not accustomed to it.

There are private rooms in the back, for the more discerning clientele, and the office of the proprietor, an Ishmaic known as Zumurrud the Re-Arranger and his staff, dusty looking elves unaffected by the smoke with cruelty in their eyes.

The stairs up into the rickety building are out of bounds, but rumour has it they are the domain of the alchemist that works for Zumurrud, where the laboratory can be found. What race he is nobody knows, but here on the street they call him "the Embalmer".

I would suggest this place is only for the most adventurous visitor, though many of the cities underworld pass through the place from time to time, and it can be a good place to make contacts if you know what I mean.

The Temple of The Sacred Heart

The crumbling yet once magnificent temple to the sacred heart dominates the temple district. It stands at the southernmost end backing onto the river, built around a central knave with two wings that curve out and round to form the shape of a heart.

During the terror of Cyrus Blake's reign, this was of course the third most dangerous place in the city, after the palace and the demesne of the city spirit (don't expect me to describe that here, I never saw it myself). The street stalkers were based here, and shuffled their way around the city sniffing out anyone who wasn't where they were supposed to be – and doing who knows what to them.

I have heard from my rescuers (see chapter seven "I Didn't Need Saving") that they managed to cleanse the high priests private chapel and destroy the rite summoning the stalkers, still I am not sure I would go there on my own.

The river has seeped into the foundations, the walls are damp and slimy with a covering of moss – and what might at first look through the gloom like a fine carpet is a spore laden lichen that is best not disturbed. The crypt is partially submerged, and the library while situated on the upper floor of the east wing is almost entirely covered in thick webs and echoes to the skittering sound of no living creature.

A domain of the dead it is, and making it safe or re-dedicating it to the sacred heart will I believe be no easy task. Still, if it is ever made safe there are said to be frescoes and carvings that rival any in the temples of

Halgar or anywhere else, would be treasure hunters may be interested in the reliquary for who knows what artefacts it contains?

The Verdigris Knight

Now interestingly I purchased my enchanted coin from this shop, though of course it was in Sellaville at the time. The owner is called Klaus, an irascible dwarf with a somewhat acerbic demeanour. Worth putting up with I would say, he knows his stuff and though expensive always delivers what he promises.

The shop is down an alley off Bodkin Street, oh no wait, was that the Sellaville address? Just ask around, the beggars will know where it is. The shop itself is a huge windowless stone vault, the stonework is Dwarfish, dry mortared and ponderously secure. Harder to get into than a bank or prison, though some have tried, a few may even have got in – though I am not sure they ever got out again. For sure there is a lot of money within, and artefacts, but not worth risking life and limb for.

When he's open you just walk in through the large iron bound door, when closed, well there is some kind of demonic summoning wearing a closed sign – try again later. When open Klaus will purchase any unwanted antiques or artefacts of power, at an unfavourable price of course – and stocks a wide range of empowered artefacts to meet even the most esoteric needs.

The Temple District

Apart from the imposing edifice of the temple of the Sacred Heart there are a number of temples in the district. Most are crumbling ruins, full of squatters or robbed out to furnish the homes of the local peasantry. There are a few that remain untouched, and there is a war cemetery. The gates are closed however and I was warned when I arrived not to go there, as it was under some kind of enchantment.

Away from the river there is a rather strange place, a low wall topped with iron railings and an iron gate completely enclosing a large area of what appears to be supernatural mist. A few people I spoke to claim to have seen something in the mist on a windy day, one said a dark tower of spider-haunted mystery and another claimed there was a statue of an elf with two faces. My friend Bromhead (a wizard) poked his hand through the gate once and said the mist was certainly magical but that the detect magic cantrip said there was no magic at all. There is a plaque by the gate, but I can't seem to bring to mind what it said, I will have a look when the convergence is done and put it in a later edition.

Further down the main street of the district, near the river is a temple fortress made up of three small keeps and a curtain wall. The gates were shut, my senses didn't feel any danger so I had a brief shinny up the wall – inside the courtyard there was a statue of a man holding three objects – a shield upturned with a warhammer lying across it and beside the warhammer a book. I asked around to see if anyone knew who this temple was dedicated to – but nobody seemed to know.

Haven Square

A large area near the palace, that was until recently under a protective dome. Of course, I had access inside the dome as I had been placed there during my captivity – see chapter six "the palace of infinite pleasures". Haven Square during the wars was where any faction, noble house, country, land or city would place an embassy. Some were extremely grand and others more modest many of them to people and places that I have never heard of. The most amazing thing about this place of course, deserted though it may be – is that being under the dome that protected the palace – it is untouched and unspoiled. The biggest and most impressive embassies are unsurprisingly those of Kesselharn, Glorianave and Seval. Who knows what lies within them? Certainly, I felt like something was watching me outside the Kesselharn embassy, and smoke rose mysteriously from the chimneys of the embassy of Seval. There was a building of white alabaster to somewhere called "Ether" and a tower of silver whose name plaque was in an alphabet I could not read. A pyramid with a shifting plaque of strange symbols and a building that had seemed to have been grown of huge vines and shield sized leaves.

I gather that since the dome was removed the beggars have moved in and aren't letting anyone in. Rather than ransacking it they have sealed it in, for who knows what purpose. The green space in the middle of the square was particularly pleasant, I used to walk there after lunch – while I was still able to walk of course eventually I was in such a pleasure induced state I was only capable of lying down and had to be fed lunch by a succubus – till I was "rescued".

Anyway, many a great conference or negotiation happened in the pavilion which is still an inviting and relaxing building of plush furnishings and light airy spaces, I felt when I walked within that there was no chance I could ever see violence occurring there.

The Amazing Gardens and the Tree of Life

I have been told the gardens of Rodanne were once an amazing sight to see and many would travel from all around to see the beautiful flowers and plants grown there.

Unfortunately, that is not the case now. The whole park, including the gardens are overgrown with weeds, bushes, trees and high grass. There are strange fungi growing amongst the plants that have a nasty habit of making you fall asleep to become human compost for the hungry vegetation.

The entire place is now full of all manner of creepy crawlies, from annoying Giant Flying Ants to deadly acid spitting Horned Beetles. And that's not even mentioning the huge hairy Tree Spiders that give even the hardiest man a fright!

During my visit, I did enjoy seeing the new Tree of Life growing at a fast pace and beginning to spread new life around the park. I would advise against taking a dip in the gardens lakes, as you'd leave their murky waters dirtier than when you went in. Plus, the vicious Water Nymphs there still seek to drown the unwary.

Not really one that enjoys that type of thing I am happy to let the tree hugging Druids gush on about the many strange and wonderful things that are growing or living there now.

I do look forward to the next years 'Party in the Park', which used to be an annual event to celebrate the Tree of Life. The old pavilion needs a good clean out but there is still much festival fun with food & drink, music, and dancing. One of the strange Mushroom Men that appear to tend to the gardens said he will bring along some delightful herb brownies that are supposed to be a delight!

Halls of Learning

Before the war and before Cyrus whisked Rodanne away from Primus, the Halls of Learning were a renowned place of academic study. The Halls were full of great philosophers, artists, mathematicians and the brightest young minds. Students would travel from all cross the lands to try and get accepted into the prestigious Halls.

The Head of the Halls of Learning was a man could Lewis Delguardo, who possessed amazing mental powers & skills. It was said he could answer a question before it had been asked such was his ability to read minds. Lewis was incredibly strict on who was accepted to study within the Halls and refused bribes from the richer families to allow their children to study there.

Albert Kilgrave, was a faculty member at the Halls and was deeply jealous of Lewis. When Cyrus took the city into the Nacht, Lewis was killed and his very brain used as the anchor empowered with neuronic power. Albert took over the duties of the Head of the Halls and used a rite to neuronically link his own mind to the 'brain anchor' so he could enhance his own mental talents. Unfortunately, the downside of the rite was that all other active minds within the Halls were driven crazy and the place has descended into little more than a psychiatric prison with the patients running the asylum.

The Halls have huge muscle bound lobotomised guards, that I was able to easily pass with bribes of food or anything remotely shiny. A particularly big fellow was even distracted by a bouncing ball thrown down the hallway, which he chased like an excitable pup.

The students are quite something else though. I doubt I have seen anyone as mentally unhinged as those poor folks. With strange wild eyes and stretched grins on their faces, they can appear comical but upset them at your peril. One took a dislike to the colour of my robe and lack of 'class stars' and soon my nose and ears ran with blood, and my head felt like someone was trying to remove my brain from the inside.

The Halls have a fairly good Gobball team though, with insane Cheerleaders, but be warned as they often attack the crowd and players alike with wooden clubs whilst whooping out their cheer songs.

The Mining Fields & Golden Furnace

The City wasn't just called the Golden City due to its great buildings and amazing people. There are a number of deep gold mines within the cities walls.

Rumour has it the resistance against Cyrus and his foul rule, were based within its many tunnels. Also it is said the disused mines were used as a dumping ground for rubbish, rotten wood or building rubble, and even the bodies of the dead. Many of Rodanne's Hanot made their home there and a strange 'Beggar Undercity' has been formed in the caves and tunnels of the mines where the undead walk about freely in harmony with the ragged beggars.

A giant rock eating Town Troll, named Garlglegut, is overseer of the remaining functional mines and is said to be a hard taskmaster if somewhat dim witted. The close by Golden Furnace has relit its smelting fires again and no doubt soon the markets of Rodanne will once again by filled with wonderfully crafted golden artefacts.

I haven't as yet explored too much of the mines as the awful whiff is extremely unpleasant and the beggars eyed me with much suspicion.

The People of Rodanne

As well as many weird and wonderful places to go and visit within the cities huge walls, there are a good few people or creatures of note. I have come across or heard about from the Noble House linked to the city and the terrifying Street Stalkers.

House Kilgrave

I have heard that whilst on Primus the nobles of House Kilgrave were kind, caring and compassionate to the common man, often organising feasts and awards for those working in the city. They were renowned for a damn good party and over indulging. That to me sounds like my kind of Noble House. However, it would appear the power of Cyrus Haven has corrupted them, the house is the polar opposite of what it was, with perhaps a handful of family members still retaining some aspect of kindness/goodness. Most of the House are now depraved, cruel and evil to the core enjoying torture, the pleasure dens and fighting pits of the city. Definitely not my kind of Noble House!

I have read histories of the House in the Halls of Learning and a derelict library, and I have met one of the Kilgrave Nobleman.

Heathcliff Kilgrave - Was at the time the dark horse of the family and a completely evil Unholy Champion. The rest of the House disowned him and when Rodanne was taken away from Primus, he sought to escape the city and leave the rest of his house to rot. Unfortunately for him, Heathcliff was killed in Rodanne's park and his bones lain to rest by the nest of some Giant Ants until a recent mercenary party discovered them.

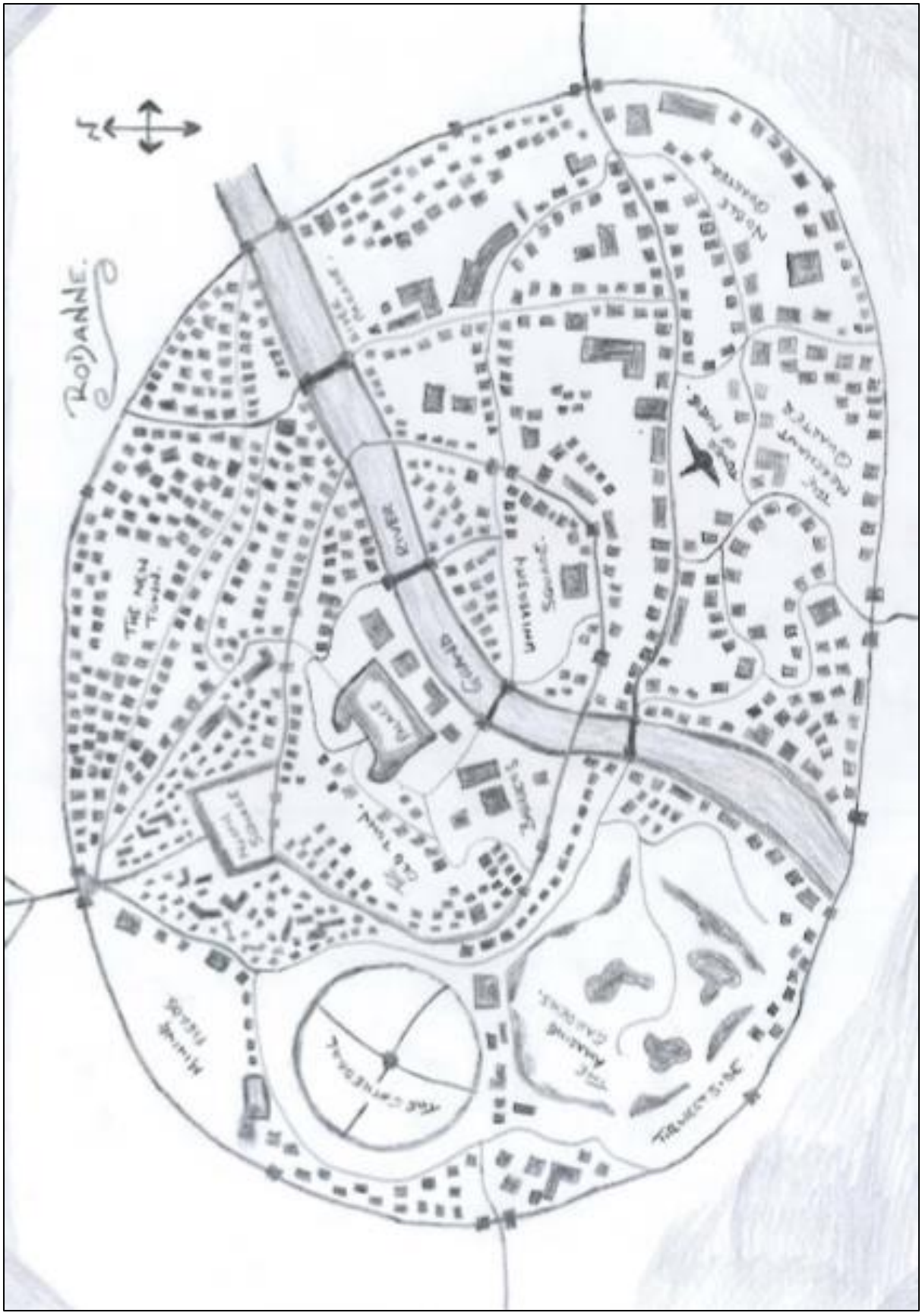
Albert Kilgrave - Was a faculty member at the Halls, before taking over as Head Master. Driven mad and believed to have conducted experiments on his own brain, Albert was killed by the brave heroes that freed Rodanne when they broke into the upper levels of the halls to break on of the anchors holding the city in place.

Constance Kilgrave – Helped organise the resistance against the rule of Cyrus and now works hard to help those freed from the dark Haven to readjust to 'normal' life within the city.

The Deadly Street Stalkers!

Though the ritual creating the Street Stalkers was destroyed (and has so far not been replaced or recreated) there are still a number of the deadly undead creatures patrolling Rodanne! They are no longer under the control of Cyrus so who is currently summoning them is unclear. Possibly the dark and mysterious Kallah Lord or a minor player of Cyrus's old rule but they are a lot less likely to attack now. They tend to roam around the city, patrolling or hunting when summoned. The Street Stalkers are often summoned or called be the Kallah of the City, sometimes by sending messages through the eyes of a Hanot so it's likely the beggars may know more. When one is approaching, you can normally see a distracting fog or mist before they arrive and the smell of putrid rotting flesh makes you as sick as a night on the battlebrew. They can be known to release a spine-tingling screech/scream when closing in on their prey that frightens the bravest of hearts. I'd avoid such creatures at all costs if you are unfortunate enough to see or hear one.

The Roughest Guide to Rodanne by Rudolph Winterhaven is published by Halgar Press is priced at 50 Grulls – and will be available in all good book shops this final dawn.


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RODANNE.

Shadowfell

The House of Hellum is an old house, dating back to the 500's, and an anomaly. It was founded when Breadon Hellum was awarded the title of Baron of Shadowfell. A barony within what is now rural keys. He was a simple man, a hero of his time, but not a great legend. However, while travelling he passed through these lands and was beset by undead. Rather than flee he faced them down and hunted down their source. He found the priests summoning them, and uncovered the ritual they were performing, an attempt to let a great undead power wash over the region and beyond, turning all men and women into mindless servants. Breadon faced down the foes, and rescued the sacrifice, an Ancient folk called Estarl Tavrinth.

In recognition for the great service the rulers of the land granted Breadon the title of Baron and named his Land Shadowfell, in recognition of the events that would have transpired there. Estarl, as thanks for saving him, offered Breadon the hand of his daughter, Shevorth, in marriage.

This union, an odd one by any standard, was successful and allowed Shevorth to invoke pacts she held and strike bargains with the nobility so the title of Baron would pass to Breadons sons, and down the generations.

The pact, or will as it became known, is steeped in power and mystery. It holds the secrets to the inheritance and dictates how the title shall pass. As part of the pact Breadon ensured that the family of his friend, Isiah Drake, would be cared for. Isiah served as Breadon's seneschal, helping with the day to day running of the Estates, and when Isiah died his son took his place, and so it passed down the generations, as the title of Baron passed through Breadons line.

So the years passed and the line endured and while small, and of little power it's unique position survived through many masters of Primus, and the rise of the Empire.

As 1012 was coming to a close the present lord, Samson Hellum fell ill. He contracted a fever that the priests attempted to cure, but it kept returning. The fever continued for a month, and Samson eventually, being an old man, died in mid-January 1013. His son, Emerson was called but did not make it back before his father died. Arriving at the end of January Emerson took the mantle of Baron. Unfortunately, within the month he had been killed as well, leaving no son.

So the current Seneschal, Morren Drake, began the process of enacting the will to ensure the title passed to the correct heir.

The Will had several clauses in it concerning indirect inheritance. Specifically, the individuals must, either through their own action or by those working for them, uncover the mystery of the Barony, and specifically the Manor, and understand it. This may only be attempted once and had to be done under a full moon. Until then the Manor should be sealed. If the potential heirs failed, or none were alive, or 3 full moons passed without a Baron, then the Barony would pass to the seneschal in recognition for the years of the families service.

Unfortunately, Morren knew this, and he was not as kind or loyal as his ancestors. The truth is Samson did not contract a fever but was afflicted with such by Morren, and when the priests cured it Morren simply cast the rite again. To make it worse he added a mild poison to Samson's meals, which made him weaker and went unnoticed because of the fever.

Fortunately, due to the actions of brave mercenaries this was thwarted and Morren's dark plans were stopped.

With agreement from the remaining heirs the title, and land, was passed to Cerus Amoura the second and pacts with the patrons of the barony reforged to allow it to sit within his care.

At this time the Angel Cloud also placed a blessing upon the people of the Barony that seems to have settled and fused with the place.

Since the death of Baron Samson the Barony had also been plagued by fey, but the new Baron has forged a bargain with them to ensure such does not occur again. A spring festival of dance and merriment will occur, and then each Autumn a sacrifice will be burnt in a large wicker man to appease the local fey.

Character options: The folk of Shadowfell.

People may begin Peons from Shadowfell. These may not be evil, and unlike normal peons cannot buy res chance on the tables. Instead due to Clouds blessing all gain rebirth (as tables) and may buy enhancements as a normal mercenary. They must rebirth as a peon of Shadowfell however. Additionally, if they do rebirth and do not gain any ISP benefit then the rebirth only takes 4 weeks to happen, unlike normal.

Finally, they gain Ward Pact undead, due to the ancient secrets of the power of Shadowfell.

However, they may claim more than basic tier of any social guilds as interaction with others is never easy.

Shattered Words of Creation

A History

Being an account of the Shattered God

By Bradley Williams

Extended from works by Talarak Eruldine

Much of what I write here is taken from the records of Talarak Eruldine, High Priest of Creation at the dawn of the 2nd age. Much else is only known and scribed thanks to the efforts of those mercenaries who risked their lives to uncover it and to end the threat of the Shattered God, at least for this age. The documents of Talarak's were taken from a sealed and warded chest within a shrine to the Creator upon Eruldine. This shrine still remains and by all accounts there is much good cheer and good food upon the Isle. I would advise any who seek further knowledge of this tale to visit the central meeting hut for vast quantities of meat before paying a visit to the tavern of Gieldan's Feast for drink, merriment and a hearty jug of the local battle-brew.

The following is Talarak's account, after which I shall add my own conclusions, drawn primarily from the actions of those mercenaries who travelled there. It is worth bearing in mind as you read that we know almost nothing of the 1st age and indeed decisions were taken that obliterated almost all knowledge from that time. Nobody really knows why.

Sacred candles are to be lit and kept lit night and day until the time comes when the Shattered God once again threatens the world and it is time to act. At that time, should the threat be great enough, the light of the candles will dim, and the wards fade. Then, and only then, will what truly transpired at the end of this, the 1st age of mankind be revealed.

I have struck a bargain with the Elder such that all shall forget what came before and what happened at that dawn, save for this parchment. On its completion even I and those witnesses and participants will have the memories of it stripped from their minds, such that none shall ever learn of the darkness we have banished, until the time such is needed once more, which I hope shall never be.

Those priests and ley members of the faith witness to this act are listed here, such that the power placed herein will flow over them once woven and sealed:

Talarak Eruldine – High Priest of Creation

Miollus Kol – Knight Defender of Kharkas.

Arta Noclo – Priest of the First Night

Vreiglis Aparathe – Chaplain of Purest Creation

Endelev Mylon – Priest of the Beloved Constantine

Edevra Voreaux – Lord of the Craft

William Gielgood – Herald of Peace

Osric Rasha – Sword of Life's Touch

Samuel Antra – Chaplain of Creation's Beauty

Benjamin Barrok – Knight Sanguine of Kharkas

Paulo Caspavi – Head Librarian of Kharkas

Toredor Ji – Lord of the Rolls

Ernest Brell – Seneschal of Kharkas

It is worth interjecting here to say that the shattered islands found by mercenaries were each named after one of these original witnesses, and though all are now once again forged together and return to Primus, their names, sacrifices and acts of heroism, should not be forgotten. One, Constantine Edevra Voreaux still lives, blessed as he is with some fragment of the divinity that is creation.

A brief history and my account of the proceedings follows:

When the second word of creation was spoken and that which was destruction came into being, it was not just the force that came, but a manifestation also. That manifestation would become known as The Shattered God. Legend tells that the first word that the god spoke shattered its very being into a thousand pieces. Nothing that it could ever be, or ever bring to the world could create, only destroy, and thus in speaking, it's very words destroyed itself.

And so legend tells that the fragments of the Shattered God came to rest throughout the land and were worshipped, or at least many were. To those that followed they granted power and both fragments and peoples shaped each other through belief. Belief though that was always twisted and bent by destruction. For example, one might think of perfection, but express such through the process of constant destruction and recreation, where nothing can ever be perfect, but perfect is the only acceptable state. Cults and faiths formed, for the most part not knowing what it was that they followed, revered or worshipped, or that they were ultimately being influenced by its power.

The fragments of the Shattered God sought one another, sought to become whole once again, but owing to their very nature found such difficult to achieve, for their sole purpose and being was that of destruction. Instead they influenced those around them to seek other tokens of their power and to take them. Such always occurred in a destructive way, not necessarily always in a nihilistic, violent way, but such that one faith was destroyed and consumed by the other; the greater growing stronger through its conquering of the weak. In time, some of the groups became very strong, powerful and are rumoured to have been behind several of the great wars and terrible events throughout the first age. Largely unnoticed and unseen, the influence of the fragments was widespread, and coveted by those who found them, influenced as many people are by the power they brought.

Now I should interject here and say that much of this previous is supposition. We have good evidence to point to such being true, but little direct proof, and it is likely that there will be no such left by the time anyone comes to read this. I ask that you keep an open mind and accept that it might be true, and even it is not, that you accept that this being is still a potent and dangerous creature of vast power.

As a further interjection on my behalf, I suspect it likely that many of the cataclysmic or near cataclysmic events that have occurred throughout the ages of mankind have been somehow influenced, if only, lightly, by the power of the lost fragments of the Shattered God. The Chaos Wars, for example and the madness of the Magiarchs; one

could easily theorise a little touch here, a little influence here and the spiralling that then ensued.

What we do know though, is that there were and are a great many fragments of the Shattered God, thousands, perhaps more, and the impact of the vast majority had more to do with the individuals who uncovered and claimed them than the fragments themselves. It is easy by far to influence a wicked man to commit slightly worse atrocities than he has already done, to step over the line just a little too far and create a cascade of events that lead to widespread destruction, than it is to make a good man fall. Though the fragments sought such individuals and in certain cases led to much woe, they could never spread widely their influence or strength in the same way that the Shattered God could if reforged, or if a large number of fragments were brought together.

As a brief aside, it is believed that most priests of what we commonly refer to as the Destroyer, of which there are few, have all come into contact with a fragment of the Shattered God at some point in time and been influenced or touched by its power. Most probably don't even realise it, and for all intents and purposes it doesn't matter one way or another. Thousands of fragments exist and for the most part their influence is countered by the Creator.

It is also worth mentioning here that while we acknowledge the existence of destruction as a necessary force, we as a faith strongly oppose those who would seek to worship such. In doing so they give power to the Shattered God, in his fragmented form or otherwise, and willingly or unwittingly empower him. This is no good thing.

Now, I have mentioned fragments and how there are thousands of them. However, there are twelve significantly larger fragments, which each contain vast and significant power by comparison to those others. These when brought together form a statue or idol which forms the manifest vessel of the Shattered God. Constantine informs me that it was made a great many of years ago by his hand as a means by which the power of the Shattered God could be contained, or at least that was the intent. The physical fragments of such, within which his power is bound are nowhere near as old as the power itself. Many have attempted to bind and imprison the Shattered God's power, as we have done in this age just gone, and this binding within an idol was just one such attempt. To an extent it worked, but the fragments still sought each other out and drew themselves together, even bound as they were.

Thus, over the years the twelve were naturally drawn together, by the actions of groups worshipping them, or by other means. Priests of the Creator at the time of the first 'drawing' which involved the physical fragments came to the conclusion that the best solution to the problem was to take the twelve pieces of the statue which had failed to hold the God‟s being entire, and ritually shatter them when each time of the 'drawing' occurred.

The 'drawing' for those who know not is a cyclic rhythm of creation and destruction whereby the tides of creation and destruction throughout the land ebb and flow. Every few hundred years or so these tides are such that ritually significant events seem more likely to occur in relation to the fragments, or the power within. If nothing occurs to keep them shattered then, no doubt, in time they will eventually be gathered and become whole once more.

To look back on further history, and incidents regarding the drawing, there is more to be said. The priesthood, every drawing performed rites to re-shatter the fragments and influence the forces of creation and destruction surrounding them for the years to come. These they performed without necessarily having the fragments, believing that the rites themselves would scatter the fragments once more and keep them from ever re-joining. They were wrong.

At the end of the age just gone, we almost failed. The Shattered God baring a single sole fragment was reforged and almost became manifest. Cataclysmic events occurred, which, thankfully due to the Elder I now forget, though the feeling of horror still lingers in the back of my mind, never far away. Because of our failure all of existence as we know it was almost lost. Because of our failure we attempted something more drastic but we hope more permanent.

At great cost we took the fragments and undertook a rite, whereby we deliberately reforged the statue from the twelve fragments, by adding the final missing piece, and within the beating of a heart shattered it once again; accepting that as we did so the land we were within would shatter also, but believing that with suitable precautions such a shattering would ripple only over Kharkas, rather than Primus as a whole.

Thus it was that at the high dawn we sent Kharkas into the mittlenacht along with the near completed statue and the final fragment. There we reforged the statue, trapping it within a ritual pyramid, and shattered it by rite, destroying this Isle but trapping each of the twelve fragments on twelve independent isles all warded and separated by mittlenacht; all once part of Kharkas. There we hope they will never again be able to draw each other together. Each of the witnesses and their families were involved in the rite, and each we hope will be able to build new lives for themselves within this shattered archipelago. It is sad that each will be isolated from the other, but it is a sacrifice we all were willing to take.

What remains of Kharkas I will seal away from the world and live out my days here with those few monks who remain, duty sworn to keep the casket within which this account will be placed safe, and oath bound to ensure that should we fail again and the drawing come to pass, others will be able to take our place and see the Shattered God does not rise to power.

Talarak Eruldine , High Priest of Creation, 1st Year of the 2nd Age of Mankind
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MORE RECENT EVENTS

For a thousand years the isles remained shattered, until at the high dawn of the 3rd age the wardings that sealed and sheltered them slowly began to fade and the rise to another "drawing" began. Most of the peoples on the islands which held a fragment had been influenced by them in one way or another; mostly badly. Each fragment drew on and attuned itself to a corrupt parody of the aspect of creation that those people involved in the original rite worshipped.

For example, those on Barrok, who believed in self-sacrifice, of putting themselves in harm's way to help others, in gifting their time to aid the needy, instead became a place of blood sacrifice and dark ritual to the power of the fragment. The islanders still believed they were giving their lives to help others, but in fact were doing nothing but feeding the manifest shard of the fragment who took the title Antula.

The mercenaries travelled to these isles, recovered the fragments, helped or slew those too corrupt to save and in the end performed a great rite to end the current "drawing". They reforged and broke the power of the Shattered God just as those of Talarak's time had done before them, only this time they sent the fragments to places or people on Primus. In these places some would be imprisoned, the malign power held captive and bound for at least an age or more, others would be given the chance of redemption, the raw power of the shards able to be moulded to a better purpose.

In the end it is likely that in some far distant future, more than an age away, the fragments will once again be "drawn" together as they have before, but for now, and for many years to come we need not fear the direct manifestation of the Shattered God and all his destructive power would bring.

It is worth noting that they were not the only ones seeking the fragments. A group known as the Conclave of Oblivion, sworn to the Lady Vanity Indeminii, who has previously attacked Bildteve, and led by the now deceased Corvinus Madrak, also sought the shards. It is believed they sought to use them in a rite to grant their mistress, who they called The Lady Oblivion (I believe simply another honorific of Vanity's), power from the fragments as the time of the „drawing" reached its climax. Thankfully, they failed and most are now dead. Two escaped, having not been present when the mercenaries raided their island stronghold. Of these one is an Ancient Folk sorcerer and ritualist, whom the mercenaries never met in person, the other a very dangerous shape changing assassin; who is believed to be some kind of Kallah of Cities Destroyed.

My thanks also to those of Al'Rashan who provided some of this information to both the mercenaries and later myself. They mentioned also that this Vanity somehow engineered her death at the dawn in order to achieve some kind of accession. They believe it likely also that her Seneschal, though he defers to her, is perhaps the one with the true power. For those seeking to oppose them, they are potent adversaries.

As for Eruldine in its current form, I will give a small account of the regions which were formerly her neighbouring isles now re-joined to her. The isle itself, now returned to Primus, sits off the coast of Bildteve, between that city and the Confederacy; about two day's sailing by ship.

Peoples, Groups and Places

Eruldine – the central region of the Isle and the name of the monastery and shrine which resides there. Famed for good food and copious amounts of meat, all laid on by the friar Leigh Stoutley. Another hut which recently appeared nearby, is home to a ghostly chef and the Knights of Renown on the Isle, they having laid claim to such. It is believed that such a hut once formed the lair of the Conclave before it's island home shattered and was reintegrated into the Isles. It's unclear why this particular hut has appeared and remains when everything else on that Isle was lost, but a man called E.W. explained quite forcefully that "it just had", and that I should stop nosing about. Point taken.

Eruldine - Goodly Creator Priests (any type of priest, spirit warrior, friar or way finder; all are human) but can make their own hermit list based on the particular faith of Eruldine which evolved away from the main body of the church. Cannot join a political guild, having been separated from the politics of the mainland for so long, and generally being disinterested in such. Are part of the Monestary of Eruldine which takes up their social guild slot (cannot have another; though could buy hanger on). Through this they gain the following:

"Meal Blessing" - may call on Eruldine or the Creator bless a meal to grant all participating greater aware med and +×1 med rate while eating; max 1hr duration. "Warding Candles" - Gains the spiritual candles miracle added to list. They may call on the sacred candles which protected the Isle of Eruldine 1/day. This requires a lit candle(s) to use (which may be kept alight by spiritual candles once lit) but must stay lit for the ability to function.

The candle radiates a protection from evil spirits around it, at +1 level of effect and additionaly works against all mittlenacht creatures regardless of alignment. When lighting the candel, the priest may choose to carry it. If the candle is carried the protection will move with the caster, but cannot actively push things back, should they block it's path. The duration in this case is reduced to 5 mins

Kol – is inhabited by the beaten remnants of the Kologai tribes, sworn to the warring spirits of fire & earth. Weaker, by far, with the fragment removed and their chieftain "Blessed by Fire" dead, they still pose a threat to the other inhabitants of the Isle.

Noclo – a portion of the Isle bathed in permanent darkness. Home to a group known as the First Night who believe in the "darkness of creation" and that creation fist sprang from the night and thus the night should be revered. A little over-zealous in their ways, it is likely that some will find them staunch and honourable allies,

Noclo - Any wizard subclass/warlocks/power masters/power warriors/rogues or warrior subclasses/assassins all of which must be LE. All are human, calculating their base life at one level lower, but gaining full dark elf innates and they may extend these innates as a dark elf at +50% cost. All gain 1/2 fx Light (as Tables; Power Masters get 1/4 fx, from 1⁄2), and all are immune to beneficial white mana. None of the Noclo may ever gain or use any non-black spells (although they are not specifically immune to them, so a brown wizard could cast a Plate (o) on them, but they couldn't utilise an item of plate (s), nor learn to cast the glyph.) Magical classes must be 1st colour black and cannot ever gain access to any non-black spells. In the case of Rogues and Power Masters gain black mana instead of the usual and all basic spells associated with such. Power Master self heals are in darkness suitable for a shadow shift/walk on darkness. Cannot join guilds, since their sole loyalty is to the First Night (though could still buy hanger on).

while others callous murderers.

Aparathe – few people still live in the region though those that do are slowly recovering from years of tyrannical rule under the dogmatic rules and laws of the priest Imalek, who's vision of purity became corrupted by the influence of the fragment.

Mylon – a stark and divided region where one half is lush forest surrounding the Blauz owned, Parlour of the Beloved, and the other a desolate wasteland of sand, long dead. The Parlour specialises in all manner of exotic fancies, trade goods from around the world, and the much sought after (and feared) "elixirs of emotion".

Rumours abound of a drink said to provide 8 hours of passion in 30 seconds, all for 500g. Unlike many of their kin the Blauz appear to be both friendly, welcoming and very much against the Horned God of the South.

Edevra – a place of crafting where the immortal crafter Constantine Voreaux resides. Infused with a shard of the Creator's divinity, and one of his first sons in ages long gone, he works wonders with wood, stone, metal and anything else he can lay his hands on.

Gielgood – a region inhabited by the monks of the Sacrosanct who believe in the sanctity of life and of peace, to the extent of using gold and bronze magics to impose such. With the fragment gone their blessing no longer prevents the old from dying, and no longer causes people to suffer in endless pain prevented from the release

Gielgood - Human, non-evil, non weapon-using priests or wizards. Have Elysian restrictions with respect to inflicting damage. Wizards may be white, gold or bronze as their 1st colour, but gain no damaging spells (and cannot ever buy any such), and may be Bronze despite normal alignment restrictions. Priests gain a hermit list, but may never learn damaging miracles. Are outgoing and seek to spread the word of the Sacrosanct and thus may join guilds normally. Gielgood may not use teaching scrolls or scriptures of faith.

of a natural death. A people whom pilgrims of Shaehan would no doubt be able to have profound influence.

Rasha – the closest region to west of the main Eruldine meeting hut and the location of Gieldan's Feast, a tavern owned by the fey blooded Gieldan, son of Osric Rasha, the founder. Those who partake in a toast with Gieldan are often touched by the power of his blood, gaining minor magical powers. Those who regularly drink at the Feast are touched further, slowly ceasing to age, healing wounds more swiftly and in some cases regenerating even from death.

Antra – is almost entirely devoid of life other than a species cousin to the curious trolls of our Empire and a handful of silver skinned creatures; the only survivors of a brutal conquest by those of the Kologai tribes from neighbouring Kol. The land has yet to be fully explored, though the trolls seem to get on remarkably well with Constantine from nearby Edevra and are learning the arts of crafting with marked skill and speed.

Barrok – a place left torn and suffering from hundreds of years of bloody sacrifice and death. The land and

Rasha - Any G or N alignment. All are 'fey blooded humans'; as human but gain a single Elder Fey Minor power (if power has innates, calculated as if L6 of that M/R.) May only M/R published Elder Fey. Cannot join a political or professional guild, but may join social guilds freely. 1/day may call on the Blessing of Gieldan's Feast when raising a toast during a meal; this grants everyone participating in the toast a single innate of a 1st - 4th basic handbook spell or 1st - 3rd handbook miracle, which fades at the end of the day.

priesthood of the Antula is in tatters and it will likely take many years to recover. Pilgrims who know of sacrifice and what it truly means would no doubt be a great help to the priesthood there.

Caspavi – home to a trio of Liches, the brothers "Al'Rashan". They seek wisdom and knowledge above all things and prefer to spectate, study and learn rather than actively involve themselves in on-going conflict. A great help to the mercenaries who travelled there, and extremely honourable in terms of knowledge both

Caspavi - Are apprentices to the Liches of Al'Rashan and in that respect may be any kind of wizard subclass, seer, priest subclass or wayfinder. If a priest they gain a hermit list but must take all the basic comms sphere miracles they can and their first major/minor sphere (if taken) must include comms (but it could be the minor). Wizards must be 1st class Silver.

Wayfinders must take at least one prayer for guidance in their base scout skills. Due to their vast reservoirs of knowledge, contacts in high places throughout the Empire and beyond, and interaction with outside society for many years they may join guilds freely.

given and taken.

Ji – a small ruined hut bereft of anything valuable is all that remains of the collectors who once called themselves the Church of the Saviour and resided on Ji. Their collection once held such wonders as the haft wrapping of the Axe of the Enunciator, three obsidian rings bound with the dead essences of the ancient Drakons of Tin, Pewter and Copper, a childhood bracelet of the current Empress, a large & pure shard of Nagrech, and much more. Where all such has ended up, is unclear.

Brell – a place where demockary still rules and which will require some considerably and forceful reorganisation if anything is ever to be done there. I believe the monks of Eruldine have stepped in to stop the ritual stonings that were commonplace, but the people will need some long-term help to recover from hundreds of years of the fragments influence.

Spinner's Rise and the Muma

Spinner's Rise

Spinner's Rise appeared to be an ordinary town near Deci. Nobody suspected that it had a hidden history but deep below the town, deep beneath its catacombs lies a shard of dream stone. This shard has created a pathway from Spinner's Rise through the mittlenacht to Bruadar, the world of race of dream eaters known as the Muma.

The Wayfarer

On the mittlenacht path between Spinner's Rise and Bruadar waits the Wayfarer, an ancient and mysterious figure covered in misty chains. The Wayfarer is said to have existed for longer than anyone remember. Immensely powerful in this place he could end even the most competent mercenary's life with a few swings of his staff but he will not. He exists solely to warn those travelling the path to Bruadar of the dangers and to ask them to leave something behind to anchor them to Primus otherwise they would become lost in dreams of confusion for all eternity.

Bruadar, the World of the Muma

The world of the Muma is as expansive as Primus, possibly even more so. It is shaped by the dreams of those from other planes (including Primus) known as dreamers. There are many important places in Bruadar including the two great cities - The City of White Ivory and Pearl and the City of Black Ivory and Pearl, the Dream Mine, the Crystal Mountain and the Temple of Dreams.

The City of White Ivory and Pearl

The City of White Ivory and Pearl is a huge settlement on top of a large hill of purple grass. The City is filled with libraries and museums including the newest building, dedicated to the people of Primus who have helped the city in the past. The city is currently ruled by Lord Yuri VII (known to those of Primus simply as Yuri). Yuri took on the title at the age of seventeen after his father, Lord Tempus IX, was murdered by a corrupted Muma, named Tenoh. Yuri has sought to do what is best for his people and to aid those from Primus. He still has much to learn and is guided by his council and the City Spirit, Iradess.

The City of Black Ivory and Pearl

The City of Black Ivory and Pearl is as large as the City of White Ivory and Pearl. The Black City as it is also known as lies deep under the ground. It too is filled with libraries and museums however these are all filled with books and relics of darkness. The city is currently under the rule of Lady Akela II, a powerful necromancer after the murder of her father and brother at the hands of those from Primus. She is hot headed and desires revenge but is currently being kept in check by the newly formed City Spirit, Mikora who made a deal with the people of Primus where the Muma of the city do not interfere with Primus beyond the feeding on the dreams of the people and the mercenaries of Primus do not interfere with the city.

The Dream Mine

The dream mine is a strange and mysterious place. It is filled with every dream ever given and taken as well as the precious dream shards used in the dream feeding rituals. The miners are all balanced Muma and no Muma of light or dark heart has ever stepped foot in the mine. The miners sell the dreams and dream shards mined to all. Muma who has the right amount of gems (the currency of the Muma). The dreams from the mine cannot be devoured by the Muma but instead can be used in various rituals or to replace a dream devoured.

The Temple of Dreams

The Temple of Dreams, is a mysterious place. The Muma worship here regularly. Half of the temple is above

ground and the other half beneath ground. Here is the closest that the Muma of light and darkness get to actually meeting. The temple is run by a group of priests who are neutrally aligned. The temple has various powers most of which are unknown to even the Muma. One of the temples powers are to manifest the dreams and nightmares of any dreamers who enter in order to test them. However sometimes conquered nightmares may linger seeking revenge.

The Crystal Mountain

Deep within a gold and silver forest lies the crystal mountain. The mountain has been there for as long as anyone can remember. Inscribed at the base are the words "Do not mistrust the dreaming dream. The dream watching child watching the dreaming dream. The dream watching child"s dreaming dream." Nobody is quite sure what this means and those who do are long dead. The mountain is said to be home to two forces, the Corruption which resided deep beneath the mountain and the Purity which resided at its peak. The purity however has not been seen for centuries and the corruption has recently gone on a rampage, corrupting all that crosses its path.

The Laws of the Land

The Muma have many laws which vary from location to location but there are several laws which all Muma adhere to. These laws are as follows:

* No Muma of a light heart must live below the ground for without the sun's benevolent warmth they will perish.

* No Muma of a dark heart must ever see the sky for the sun's malevolent heat would burn them greatly.

* Muma of a balanced nature may align themselves to a settlement of light or darkness or live in the outlands.

* No blood must be shed in a settlement of the Muma of light for this will summon an Akuma (demon) of blood which will rampage.

* No evil spirits or black mana may be used in a settlement of the Muma of light as this will summon an Akuma of dark spirits and magic which would seek to slaughter all the good in front of it.

* No goodly spirits or white mana may be cast in the settlements of the Muma of darkness as this would summon a Tenshi (angel) which would seek to annihilate all evil it came across.

The Muma

The Muma in appearance are humanoid creatures with white skin (goodly Muma), black skin (evil Muma) or grey skin (balanced Muma). No matter what colour their skin is it always has a pearly sheen to it.

They feed on the dreams of those other planes through the use of complex rituals or by plucking them directly from the minds of dreamers. Using these rituals the goodly Muma feed on nightmares and replace them with pleasant dreams whilst evil Muma feed on pleasant dreams and leave nightmares. Balanced Muma on the other hand feed on both kinds of dreams and leave behind a dreamless sleep.

All Muma are chaotic in nature due to their diets and can be unpredictable at times. However, despite their chaotic nature Muma follow their laws strictly. Muma, whilst on Bruadar are able to put dreamers into deep sleeps with their touch or weapon blows. They are skilled with the art of magic and the use of spirits. They are talented trackers and fighters, often preferring to wear light armour and wielding a blade in each hand.

The Corruption and The Purity

Long ago the Muma were all one race of balanced peoples. Then one day two forces arrived in Bruader, the Corruption and the Purity. They each took several Muma who they saw as having potential to be great and Corrupted and Purified them respectively creating the good and evil Muma. These Muma discovered that they

could not live in peace with each other so they formed their two cities, one for the light and one for the dark. The Corruption and Purity their jobs done went to reside upon the crystal mountain, the corruption below and the purity above. One day however the Purity vanished leaving behind nothing but its blade. The Corruption left unchecked dwelled beneath the mountain growing in power and slowly corrupting itself.

The Corruption sent out its spirits of corruption and its servants to slowly begin corrupting Bruadar. The Corruption was succeeding until a group of mercenaries came to the crystal mountain and destroyed the Pillar of Corruption and split the Corruption into four separate and weaker entities, which were scattered throughout the land. The servants of the corruption tried and failed many times to re-empower their master. They eventually succeeded in empowering part of their master by using it to possess Karina Moon of Primus.

In Karina‟s body the Corruption began to lay waste to Spinner’s Rise and would- if left unstopped- have reached enough power to potentially corrupt all of Primus. Thankfully a band of mercenaries purged the Corruption from Karina Moon and banished it back to Bruadar.

On Maii 8th IM 1011 a group of mercenaries retrieved and empowered the Blade of Purity and used it to destroy a portion of the Corruption. These mercenaries also discovered that once the Corruption was destroyed Purity would return to the world of the Muma. The Muma themselves believe that when the Purity returns the Muma would be gifted so that those of light could live without the light of the sun for a while without dying and those of dark could live above ground without getting burned.

Tivoria, the Shattered World

When Port Miere deconverged from Primus as the Lord Inquisitor's years-old defenses on the city activated, it was held together by the strength of the Netter - the Goddess of the Undersea, whose presence had been summoned to Port Miere by the actions of Senator Marcus Blunt and his hired mercenaries.

However, the Netter had made an agreement with another being - a Deity known as the Watcher of the Ages. With Them She had a pact, almost two centuries old, that stated that at the opportune time She would capture the lost and fragmented pieces of a plane known as Tivoria.

Seeing the moment at hand, as the Final Dawn sundered Miere, the Netter also captured the last hundred pieces of Tivoria - which became linked to Port Miere and the anomalies that had manifested within it as a result of the deconvergence and violent entropy of Salas of the Deep's tidal wave.

The History of Tivoria

Once, Tivoria was a huge plane comparable in size to the Empire. It contained four cities and three natural communes, a set of civilisations that were as old as Primus's. At times they had been at peace, at times they had warred, and it was oncoming war that marked the end of the Shattered World.

Every city and commune had a city spirit - similar to the concept as it exists on Primus, but much further reaching. All power in Tivoria passed through these spirits. Essentially, the spirits served not only as the equivalent to Primal city spirits, but also to Primal Gods and to the Throne of Glass itself. Their power was considerable - but limited by the fact that they were intrinsically tied to their location. These spirits are commonly referred to as Great Spirits.

These Great Spirits, two hundred years ago, guided each civilisation to a single action that would end everything. Simultaneously, all seven civilisations spoke a Word of Creation - each believing that it would bring them victory, all of them doing it without knowledge of the others.

However, there was a secret betrayal hidden behind this act. For the Great Spirits were not seven beings, but one - the World Spirit of Tivoria itself. The World Spirit engineered the destruction of its own plane in order to free itself from being shacked to one land - allowing it to escape to Primus. Unfortunately for the World Spirit, the faith of its followers shaped the Word, and in shaping the Word it changed what happened next.

The Speaking destroyed Tivoria, killing everyone on it, and shattering the plane into a thousand pieces. Only a hundred remained, empty and adrift within the Mittlenacht. The life force of those people and the spirits they venerated was transformed into the Pantheon of Seven - a group of Divine who then passed into Primus and beyond.

None of Them remembered what had come before; none of Them remembered being the World Spirit, or betraying Their people. And so, desperate for understanding, many of Them set about trying to discover the truth.

Mercenary Intervention

Seeking to resolve the anomalies in Port Miere, a group of mercenaries hired by Inquisitor Daedalia Wilton found themselves coming across more and more of the Pantheon of Seven and the converged pieces of the plane of Tivoria.

They mounted several expeditions into the plane, seeking to discover what had occurred there and find a resolution that would safely separate Tivoria from Port Miere. There they discovered that Tivoria was no longer empty - it was populated by beings manifested by the Netter. Conjured from the memories and knowledge of the 420,000 people who had died on Tivoria, these beings were known as Remnants.

The mercenaries uncovered the truth of what had happened, travelling to each of the cities and communes of Tivoria, and gathering the Keys to the Heart of the World - the place where the World Spirit was born, and died, and reborn as the Pantheon of Seven.

In that place they had the power to radically change the future of Tivoria - and change it they did. The seven Deities were called back to Tivoria, some coming willingly and some coming only at the behest of the mercenaries' great power. Several of Them were changed in Their nature, most notably the deities Khurshid

and Rachane, whose dark and twisted demesnes were returned in part to what they had been before the Speaking.

They also ensured that Tivoria would remain whole at the Final Dawn, safely separated from Port Miere, and that Tivoria would be closer to Primus in the metaphysical sense - ensuring that the plane would have the capacity for growth and development that it had lacked under the World Spirit.

But this was not the end of the mercenaries' work. For within their number was a most unexpected hero - an Unholy Champion by the name of Darren O'Neill. Once a selfish man, he had found himself amongst better company - as a Knight of the Land, and then again through traveling with groups of mercenaries such as the Tivorian Twelve. With each passing day, he had found it harder to justify his way of life - even his very faith.

The people within Tivoria were dead. What remained of them was nothing but a Remnant. And Darren had taken an oath to serve the land and its people. He had stood alongside his brethren and said the oath, day after day. It had crept its way into his heart - and it had led him to a plan. A plan that would involve that most mercenary of sacrifices. A sacrifice that, to his astonishment, he was not afraid to make. He was even willing to make.

So stood within the Heart of the World, Darren spoke the Word of Recreation - offering rebirth and renewal to all those who had died in Tivoria. He pushed into the Word all that he was - and then when that was not enough, he pushed again, one life after the other, until the Word had resonated throughout all of Tivoria.

Not all of the people of Tivoria remained within the plane, many of them having been lost to the ravages of the exostance. Nonetheless, by the will of the Second Speaking, almost 100,000 people were reborn. Even Evaristus, the Wish of Fortune - the Deity who had been consumed by Rachane, then the Devourer - was reborn into His previous form.

For this reason, Darren O'Neil remains exalted amongst the people of Tivoria, who universally regard him as the one to whom they owe their new lives.

The Cities and Communes of Tivoria

Uychaira, the Overcity

Once built within the top of a mountain, a subterranean city, Uycharia was severed from the earth some two hundred years prior to the shattering of Tivoria. The city, and the mountain peak within which it was built, was lifted into the sky. Previously known as the Undercity, it became known instead as the Overcity - for it floated within the sky over Tivoria.

This was done with purpose. For centuries before that, Uycharia had endeavoured to be a truly neutral city. As the other cities and the communes warred with one another, Uycharia stayed out of it. They maintained trade with the other civilisations where necessary to survive, but generally remained self-sufficient - empowered in this by the fertile nature of their land, which was near to a volcano (this was also part of the reason they moved - it was becoming active again).

As a floating city, Uycharia was able to move as necessary, staying away from conflict and truly acting as an independent nation free of allegiances or grudges. This rendered it quite isolated, however - and over time, their resources started to dwindle. Their city council was too afraid of the resurging war between Mivala and the communes to risk landing, so they began inputting increasingly harsh rationing - but this couldn’t last forever.

Eventually, they chose to follow the guidance of their city spirit, Ailurus. Ailurus directed the city to speak a Word of Creation in unison at an appointed time, telling them that this would cause life to resurge within the city. Instead, it destroyed the entire plane.

Since the Second Speaking, Uychaira have been far better off. Their Patron Deity, the Watcher of the Ages, is skilled with pact making. This has allowed the city to form agreements that have re-empowered the city's resources. The newfound proximity of Tivoria to Primus has also rejuvenated the ley lines within the city - though they will never be as powerful as before Uychaira was separated, they are nonetheless far stronger than they were.

MIVALA, THE FONT OF PROGRESS

Originally built upon the Pridik Lake at the center of the Mirivar continent, Mivala was once a floating city. Over time, however, its greed and determination for technological advancement led it to drain the lake so that it could expand into the space. It now occupies the whole basin of the lake, and this has led it to have an on-again-off-again war with Bresa, the Oceanic Commune, who understandably took it as an affront against nature.

Historically, many have seen Mivala's society as incredibly harsh, as it was greatly punishing to those who did not display genius in innovation. Those who did not have this sort of ingenuity lived there, of course, but they were seen as very much 'less than' - essentially in a caste-style system, albeit not one that was ever clearly defined. These people were taken into the Pridik Woods, which surround the lake, and executed - which has caused the Woods to become haunted and tainted with necromancy.

However, this is something that modern Mivala are endeavouring to move away from. Their new Patron Deity, Rachane, has been transformed and is no longer as driven as He was, nor as Setonix was. More and more, people are being lauded within Mivala for their development of 'things for the betterment of all', such as improved sewer systems and universal access to clean water.

They have a simple ruling council system which is a mixture of appointed, elected and inherited positions. Politics is not lauded, but is seen as an important tool in the progress of the city, enabling as it does the many steps and leaps forward.

It is unsurprising therefore that when its Great Spirit, Setonix, directed the Mivalans to speak the Word of Power, they did so happily on the assumption that it would ensure the progress of Mivala was far superior to that of the other cities and communes.

QADENA, THE SOUL OF CONJURATION

Situated on the continent of Mirivar along with the city of Mivala and the Ganta Commune, Qadena is the largest city in Tivoria. It is the sort of place that would be the capital city had the plane ever been a single state. It is a huge, sprawling place that is almost exclusively 'high end' buildings, with a ring of slums around the edge. There are very few people who are in between those extremes of wealth and prestige.

Qadena is known as the Soul of Conjuration for its strong history of magical scholarship and development. It is an exceptionally traditional society that places a huge amount of importance on legacy, station and skill.

This traditionalism manifests primarily in what is known as the 'Game of Leagues'. Qadena is home to dozens of different Leagues, which are best described as a mixture of political parties, noble houses and artisan guilds. Each League has a skill for which it is renowned, are often home to whole prestigious families, and is constantly vying to be more powerful than the others.

Every five years the most powerful League takes control of Qadena and acts as its ruling council. At the time of the Speaking, control was in the hands of the League of Chroniclers. It was they who were directed by the city's Great Spirit, Lacerta, to ensure that every League spoke the Word.

The Leagues had been researching a way to gain access to more magical power for many years, and Lacerta told them all that it would open Her to greater power that She could then pass to them. They spoke it in unison - and, as we all know, this broke the world.

Since the Second Speaking, Qadena has fallen under the Patron Deity Chibueze. Though not as focused on magical power as Lacerta was, Chibueze greatly favours the Game of Leagues and has encouraged them towards continuing it.

However, She does not approve of people seeking to rise above their station unjustly. All people have a place, and that place is determined by their birth and by their actions. Those who act unjustly, who besmirch their birthright or that to which they have ascended, are unworthy of the position. The right to rule is both ingrained and earned.

This has caused Qadena to be less ruthless about their ambitions - more focused on rising for the good of Qadena. A healthier competition - and one that is meeting with Chibueze's approval more and more as time goes on.

NADENA, THE FESTIVAL CITY

Situated on the continent of Evodran along with the Pheka Commune, Nadena is permanently engaged in celebration. A built up core of the city is surrounded by miles upon miles of permanent tents, yurts, and all manner of other semi-permanent lodging. Many people travel to visit Nadena, and its citizens constantly move around, changing the shape of the city with every passing change of festival.

As you might expect, the people of Nadena are outgoing and raucous. They are welcoming, but only if you're interested in participating in the festival - they're not quite as open to people who are boring. Nadena also have a very strong 'work hard play hard' ethic. *Everyone* helps with setting up the festival and clearing it up and changing to the next one. Everyone gets involved with ideas, and planning. They carry this attitude into everything they do, which means their armies are quite formidable.

Nadena is ruled over by the Master of Ceremonies, a position elected every year as part of a festival - obviously - wherein candidates are put forward from the lead organisers of each of the past year's festivals, and one is selected by vote. The vote consists of putting the potential Masters into stocks and throwing ripe tomatoes at the one they want to vote for. Whoever is judged by the previous Master to be most covered in tomatoes is elected.

Master of Ceremonies Urial created a great festival called the Chorus of Ascension, the culmination of which was everyone speaking a Word in unison - as it was a festival, people of course all participated. It didn't quite have the effect they intended.

However, since the Second Speaking, Nadena have been delighted to find their Great Spirit has returned to them as a new Deity. Returning to His original name of Calesta, the Festival Lord, the reborn Evaristus now stands as an amalgamation of His pasts. This has primarily resulted in a considerable increase in gambling within Nadena - to the mixed joy and frustration of all.

GANTA, THE ENDURING HEARTH

Situated on the continent of Mirivar, taking up its northern expanse, Ganta is the Arctic commune. The centre of the commune is a huge community located within a carved out iceburg, its outer regions similarly hidden within snow and ice to protect from the vicious weather of the permanently wintry region.

Ganta is known as the Enduring Hearth as, despite its harsh location, it remains one of the warmest and most welcoming communities in Tivoria. Though Ganta tends to keep to itself, only stepping into conflicts when absolutely necessary, it is probably one of the nicest places to travel if you want to rest and recuperate. And you don't mind the cold.

The Gantans prize family and blood, and are ruled by an inherited leader known as the Supreme Mugwump. This has been passing through the Teacir family for many generations now. It can change family, but only through a lot of ritual and ceremony or in absolute extremes (for example if the family are all killed in war, it will pass to their nearest blood relative or relative by marriage, etc).

Gantans are, as you might expect, quite powerful at blood magic - but never in the evil sense, rather in the bloodbonding and family sense. Their sense of family is quite strict. You are born into one family, and when you marry - which is required to gain a blessing on your relationship - you choose one of the two families for both of you to be part of. Whoever is marrying in is bloodbonded into the family and becomes part of it, fully leaving and severing their ties to their birth family.

Their Great Spirit, Raphus, offered the Gantans the Word of Creation as a way to strengthen the blood ties of their people, and they were more than happy to gather in their family units and speak it at the appointed time. Sadly it did not work out that way.

Since the Second Speaking, the Gantans have been coming to terms with the loss of Raphus. However they have wholeheartedly welcomed their new Divine, Chisomo, into their family. Though Chisomo, the Gift Unasked, is still learning the ways of His people, what is certain is that He cares deeply for them and that they in return hold Him in high esteem.

PHEKA, THE GREAT MOOT

Situated on the southeastern expanse of Evodran, Pheka is the desert commune. Once a nomadic people, the Phekans have over time developed a permanent camp around an oasis within the heart of the desert. Many of them still come and go, but they always return to Pheka.

The Phekans are a deeply spiritual people, first holding deep veneration of the Great Spirits and now placing the Pantheon of Seven on the highest of pedestals. It is said in Phekan scripture that the World Spirit stepped first into Pheka when it left the Heart of the World, and then separated to become the Great Spirits - who would only be reunited back where They had begun, at the Heart of the World.

When this was proven true thanks to the actions of the Tivorian Twelve, Pheka's wavering devotion resurged a thousandfold, even moreso for the miracle of their rebirth. It is a home to the hopeful, the religious, and the thoughtful. Even before the Second Speaking, the Phekans took devotion to another level. This has not changed. No moment goes without a thought to the Divine, and they hold great respect for all of the Pantheon.

An example of how deeply this runs: many centuries ago, Pheka joined in the Bresa-Mivala war, supporting their allies in Bresa for the affront against nature enacted by Mivala. However, they removed themselves from the war when Setonix - Mivala's Great Spirit - requested that they do so. It should come at no surprise then that just like everyone else, the Phekans spoke the Word of Creation when their Great Spriit, Peramel, asked it of them.

BRESA, THE EMBASSY OF NATURE

The only state not to be situated within one of the continents, Bresa is an underwater commune found within the Malothra Ocean - which lies between the two land masses. The commune live deep on the ocean floor, within huge air bubbles that allow them a safe and dry existence.

Bresa pride themselves on acting as a bridge between the other states, being an open and welcoming place where treaties can be brokered and so forth. This is not a pride that is built on imagination; Bresa has played a pivotal role in many moments of peace. Indeed the whole commune is named for the meeting hall at its centre - the Embassy of Nature.

Of course Bresa is not like Uychaira, neutral and pacifistic - they too have been part of their own wars, most notably against the city of Mivala, as recounted above. This articulates the core of what it is to be Bresa: search always for peace, but allow no wrong against Nature to go unavenged.

Their Great Spirit, Asteria, was the personification of this. When Asteria beseeched them to speak the Word of Creation, it was with the promise that the Pridik Lake could be restored. The Bresa hoped that it would quell the resurging war between them and Mivala, as well as right the wrong that had been done so long ago. It didn’t.

Now, they hold Tinashe, the Silvered Emissary as their Patron Deity. With Her help, they are learning to take advantage of how Tivoria has changed - and at Her behest, they have postponed the resurging war with Mivala, choosing to wait and see how Rachane will behave in His new form.

THE PANTHEON OF SEVEN

Once the World Spirit, these Seven Deities act as the Divine power holding Tivoria together - as well as existing as Deities in Their own right, and serving the cities and communes of Tivoria as Patron Deities.

It is worthy of note that none of these Divine manifest forms of any kind. With the exception of the Watcher, They speak primarily through Their Angels, who are universally fragments of the greater Divine rather than sentient being in their own right.

CALESTA, THE FESTIVAL LORD

When the Pantheon of Seven were unleashed upon the rest of the exostance, Calesta was known as Evaristus, the Wish of Fortune. His demesne was luck, risk and gambling - poised to be Lord to rogues, daredevils and tricksters everywhere. However, His own luck did not hold. He was consumed by Rachane, then the Devourer, and little of Him remained.

However, thanks to the actions of Darren O'Neil, Evaristus was given the chance to be reborn. Reality chose to return Him under the name Calesta, that which He had been called when He was part of the World Spirit of Tivoria.

Calesta's demesne is feasting and festivals, celebration and ceremony - with, these days, an added dash of luck and gambling. Though He is not as powerful as His siblings, having been only recently reborn, the passion and devotion of His people in Nadena will soon ensure that changes.

CHISOMO, THE GIFT UNASKED

The fundamental tenet of Chisomo's being is this: the world does not change for the better in a single action. Rather it is the small things, the little good deeds, the acts of charity that often go unrecognised, that will transform the world. Simple things, from asking how someone is, to offering them a drink - these actions rewrite the often harsh realities of the exostance with every kindly meant word.

Now the Patron Deity of Ganta, the Enduring Hearth, Chisomo is devoting Himself to learning the ways of His people and encouraging them along His path. He considers the Rebirth of Tivoria to be an opportunity to rebuild the foundations of society; to place those small good deeds within the fabric of reality, weave them inextricably into its form.

Chisomo looks favourably upon Chibueze, for when They were upon Primus, She shielded Him from the Devourer - were it not for Her intervention, Chisomo would surely have perished.

TINASHE, THE SILVERED EMISSARY

Scholars, spies and diplomats hold Tinashe in high esteem, for Her purview is the gathering and use of knowledge. Knowledge is a tool, not to be gathered for its own sake, but so that you can achieve whatever it is you require. Most commonly, Her followers use this for negotiation and diplomacy, or the more insidious sides of those coins - espionage and manipulation.

She is Patron Deity to Bresa, the Embassy of Nature, and has settled easily into that position. She has gained their trust and devotion quickly, being very similar in nature as She is to the Great Spirit Asteria with which they are more familiar.

Tinashe stands opposed to the Watcher of the Ages, for They view knowledge as something to be hoarded - whereas She sees it as a tool to be used.

THE WATCHER OF THE AGES

In many ways, it is thanks to the Watcher of the Ages that Tivoria is even capable of existing now. It was They who secured a pact with the Netter, such that the remaining hundred fragments of Tivoria would be gathered and kept safe. It was They who drew the attention of the Tivorian Twelve, prompting them to come and investigate the truth of the plane.

This suits the Watcher. Their demesne is observation, of course - but observation for two purposes. Firstly for its own sake, almost tautologically. This is the aspect of the Watcher that so upsets Tinashe, Their sister. The second side of the Watcher's observation is personal gain. When the Watcher acts, which is rarely and always calculated, They do so to manipulate the world at Their will.

The Watcher of the Ages never communicates through speech, and does not have any Angels. Instead They may be communicated with through writing upon pact-writing paper. When Their followers commune with Them, the answers are received not as voices in the mind but as if they are reading the words from a page.

Please note that the Watcher of the Ages is a gender-neutral Deity and as such Their correct pronouns are They/Them.

KHURSHID, THE ENKINDLED ONE

The Second Speaking enacted great change upon Khurshid. When She was reborn the first time, transforming from Peramel of Pheka into the Enkindled One, Her demesne was warped by the evil inherent in the actions of the World Spirit. Where She had once been a natural Spirit focused on the cycle of Life and Death, She became a doomsaying Divine whose focus was on the inevitable burning of the world.

Thanks to the actions of the Tivorian Twelve, She now rests far closer to her Great Spirit form. Having been summoned to Port Miere, Khurshid was slowly being consumed by the Devourer - and so, when the Twelve offered Her a way out of that inevitable doom, She took it, willingly accepting the transformation that it entailed.

Now, Khurshid possesses the demesne that She held as Peramel. She represents the juxtaposition of cruelty and kindness within the world - the natural duality of Life and Death. That one shall ever beget the other, a neverending cycle. Those who follow Her revere the enduring desert, the manifestation of Life-from-Death upon Tivoria. They rest in the balance between spirituality and ferality, devotion both to the cycle and seizing opportunity within it.

CHIBUEZE, THE ALMIGHTY

Foremost amongst the beliefs associated with Chibueze is this: all people have a place.

This place is denoted by two things: firstly by their birth, and secondly by their actions. Those who are born with power are meant to rule - but they must rule justly, or they besmirch that birthright. The right to rule must be claimed and held.

Those who are born to service are valued just as highly, for it is they who form the fabric of the world. Chibueze has no time for those who would ignore this fundamental truth; that those who follow contribute just as much as those who have followers. That in many ways all are servants; for even those who are in power serve those who stand beneath it.

She holds ambition also in Her demesne, encouraging it where it is done for the good of all, challenging Her people in Qadena to compete with one another to prove their worthiness as leaders and as servants.

RACHANE, THE ENDLESS ASCENSION

Before the First Speaking, Rachane was known as Setonix - a Great Spirit whose focus was on innovation and progress. This extended to a ruthless degree, His people being executed if they did not demonstrate sufficient ingenuity in their developments.

When He was transformed into a free Divine, Rachane became known as the Devourer. His already dark nature transformed by the evil act that led to the deaths of everyone on Tivoria, Rachane became little more than an animalistic force. He consumed first His brother Evaristus, then spent decade upon decade chasing after the others. Only thanks to Chibueze's intervention did Chisomo survive, and only thanks to the Tivorian Twelve were those two, and Khurshid, saved also from corruption and destruction.

It is no surprise then that Rachane's nature was changed dramatically with the Second Speaking of Tivoria. At the will of the Tivorian Twelve, He became no longer this feral force, taking instead a place within the world as the Endless Ascension.

His demesne now is progress for the good of the world, innovation for the joy of it, the bettering of all things with ingenuity and cleverness. His dark history stands as a reminder never to seek improvement for ill gain or for evil, and at His will the city of Mivala are seeking now to undo the darker side of their nature and seek a better world.

Tivorian Humans

It is now possible to start variant humans from Tivoria. These are the people who were given new life by the actions of the Wordspeaker Darren O'Neil, reborn through the power of his voice. Many of them remember nothing of who they were, and are simply trying to make a new life. Others remember something of who they were, and are conflicted about those memories - fewer remember everything, but there are those who do.

Tivorian Humans are as per standard humans in all ways, then additionally gain one set of the following powers. These represent which city you come from, and the Patron Deity of your city.

However, they cannot join Professional or Social guilds, nor can they ever be immune to holy or unholy words.

Gains Word of Creation 1/day – Acts as a published Holy word (Good, Neutral or Evil based on their

Qadena

Gains 3 mana of magical innates per table. These may be any standard elemental spell (except cantrips). Does not suffer casting damage for these innates.

At 1st level gains an Elemental cantrip that costs 1 TBLP to cast. May buy an additional Elemental Cantrip 1/2 tables for 50 points each costing 1 TBLP per casting.

Innates/Cantrips cannot be opposite to any colours owned.

Nadena
When a Faith/Dragon has a Holy Day (as per Divine Guidance) within 2 days (Before or after the current date) gains an innate True Believer of that faith. For Churches/Religions the character must be the of the same alignment as the church (EG on A St Michael day must be Goodly, for Tryst must be Evil). For Dragon Holy days the true believer allows the character to cast a standard spell of the relevant colour.

If multiple holy days fall in the same window gains multiple innates.

Ganta
Gains Kin and True Kin to all Ganta on dungeon. Gains Take killing blow 1/3 tables for other Ganta. On Table 7 can upgrade the take killing blows to be used for all Tivorians for 50 points.

Pheka
Touch of the Cycle, usable 1/15 minutes – Acts as Body Rot vs a flesh and blood target, additionally disintegrates the bones (meaning they require a reform before the regeneration works). Each use of this adds 1 EP to a pool of EP. The pool can be used to cast standard "Mother Nature" field evocations, and advanced Mother nature evocations equal of a level equal to the characters table (Counts as having the relevant field for these purposes). The pool can hold 3 EP plus 1 per table post 8th.

On table 10 can upgrade this to 1/5 minutes for 200 points.

Mivala
Gains +10% or 2 skill levels for standard makes. For advanced makes gains + 4%.

Bresa
Gains Mantic (neutral spirit/Ebony mana) Conceal Lie 1/4 levels, can upgrade this to permanent for 75 points on table 9.

Gains Psi scan and Probe at will, costing life as normal.

one scholar could record."

The Torsland Dales lie in the lands between The Rest and Halgar. The area has been settled since long before the time of the Sallow Princedoms. Whether by chance or for some reason as yet unknown to scholars, the area has a high number of places of mystical power, where supernatural workings are easier to perform. Over the years this has drawn all manner of strange groups and individuals to the area – each wave of which has tended to drive out others then be displaced in turn. Some have survived in nooks and crannies and the many hidden places of these lands, but most are long gone, leaving only the ruins of their temples, towers or settlements.

The legacy of those leaves these as dangerous lands to live in. The easternmost valleys are the most settled and protected, with several villages apiece. Deeper into hills and away from the main trade routes, the lands quickly become unsafe for common folk to travel. Goblins, hobgoblins and ogres are common, but so too are magical beasts and other things left over from the days of the magiocracies and before.

The Local Nobility

House Gallen are straightforward types who see their primary duty as being to protect the people on their lands from supernatural threats. They take great relish in hunting some of the magical beasts to be found up in the wild hills – the Baron's manor house contains many stuffed creatures such as Owlbears, Manticores & Wyverns. The family relish their hobby and have started to travel throughout Primus in search of novel creatures to hunt. Occasional attempts to capture and domesticate such beasts have often gone badly. Given there are many undead within ruins in the area, some of the house have become quite adept at hunting them too – they like to be seen as the people to call on if you have a dangerous haunting or a tenacious undead that won't stay in the ground on your hands. The one group they have never had much luck dealing with are the Twilight Fae, which is a source of some frustration.

The household retainers have long grown used to bizarre duties such as rigging up huge cages and traps, attempting to lug siege weapons up into the hills, trying to ensnare flying creatures with grappling hooks, dragging around dead cattle to be used as bait and similar. The Baron maintains a particularly fearsome pack of hounds to help in hunts, some say they are close to wolves than hunting dogs.

House Gallen are playable as human nobles of the blood – contact the campaign referees to have them signed on as a noble house or buy retainer.

The Ruins of Shendolave

The most famous of the ruined sites within the Dales. Shendolave was a large town during the period of the Magiocracies. It was turned mostly to rubble during the Chaos Wars and abandoned by any surviving inhabitants. As such it is a popular destination for both would be archaeologists and treasure hunters. The collapsed buildings and the tunnels beneath them spread over much of the valley. It is a dangerous place, with many of the wardings and bound guardian creatures of that era still present . Many of those go hunting for treasure there do not return and many more come back empty handed or with only some piece of rusty junk they would be lucky to exchange for a hot meal. But every so often some real treasure turns up, and that is enough to keep hopeful folk trying.

THE CLANS OF THE DALES

One the local traditions is that loose groups of families with distant blood or marriage ties still look on each other as relatives and allies. Each clan chief can call upon a good number of armed men and with the prevalence of mana and spiritual power in the region most have wizards or priests on hand too . They pay rent to the Baron and defer to his authority, but each has a lot of power on their own patch. Inter-clan feuds and the odd case of cattle or sheep rustling are common, but the Baron manages to keep a lid on anything more than the odd brawl.

Clan Kynnard

Descended from the former bodyguard of a sallow prince who retired here and taught his sons this skills, the members of Clan Kynnard have often made a living hiring themselves out as bodyguards. They make a point of staying out of political debates or passing judgement on those they guard. They are known also for being ready to turn up as an armed posse to help other clans being attacked by the local tribals – for this quite a few folks owe them a favour or two.

Clan Kynnard are Labyrinthian humans but may be Valdstyn, counting as hedge for abilities and progression (obviously, they aren't baronial, and do not progress/suffer limitations as baronial). They may not join a political or social guild but gain the following benefits. Take killing blow 1/day for anyone within 20 feet (they take damage based on the attacked person's defences/resistances OR their own defence/resistances, whichever is the worse), knockback 1/day, 1/day for 5 minutes they may grant any one ally the benefits of any distancing abilities they possess so long as they are within 10 feet (the ally does not need to wielding weapons for this, only the clan Kynnard member)

Weaver Mages

This being an area where sheep farming is a major industry, making this up into cloth and sewing it into clothing are also common. There is a tradition of wizardry among the clans that is skilled working magic into woollen goods and has a knack for scroll making due to the ready access to parchment. Magical items made from cloth are common – items of clothing, ritual mats, scarecrow like constructs.

Clan Cawsell

The Cawsells are one of the sheep farming clans to produce weaver mages. Of late they have been down on their luck a little after their flocks suffered from disease (and they claim raiding from the Gilfillans but they can't prove it). They spend a lot of time trying to guard their remaining flocks from the neighbouring goblins &

Clan Cawsell are available as PCs. They are as per Labyrinthian human. If someone wishes to be a weaver mage, they are as human wizard of a handbook colour but gain the following benefits – a 25% discount on the cost of making magical scrolls, MAC1 if wearing robes or clothing embroidered with mystical runes (MAC non-stacking with item MAC) and may cast animate scarecrow as a 3 mana grey glyph. They may increase the protection provided by their robes to MAC2 (total) for 50pts on table 3, and to MAC3 (total) for 75pts on table 8. They may not join a political guild or a wizardly professional guild

ogres.

Clan Gilfillan

"Rich as a Gillfillan" is a common saying in the Dales. They grew rich by sheep farming & like the Cawsells have many weaver mages, but greatly increased their fortune by lending money to the less fortunate at steep rates. For this reason many of the locals dislike them and their flaunting of their wealth winds people up even more. (they are not an appropriate PC option at this time)

Clan Malloch

The Mallochs are builders. They claim to have lived in the area since the time of the Old Republic and to have built many of the structures throughout the Dales, even in the wilder lands. Ever friendly and frequently ready to help people fix things or put up a new structure – not just farmers' homes but wizards towers, little chapels and the like. The Mallochs have discovered that the clay in the area has supernatural properties and can be

made into containers that trap spirits or elementals or figurines that are good for ritual foci. They sell these fairly freely and they are common throughout the area.

Their chief's home, called Stonehall, is ancient and was said to have been magically shaped from the hillside in a single night by the first members of the clan.

A PC member of Clan Malloch gains a Malloch Pot that holds a Fetch Spirit, Elemental or Nature Spirit, acting as a power store (stacking limitations as per other published items) that grants either 8 Mana, 6 Earthpower or 6 Spirits – they must have the ability to use the relevant power point to gain any benefit from it. They may buy a second pot for 50 pts on table 3 and a third for 75 pts on table 8. Pots must be phys-repped with a ceramic or pottery container with mystical symbols on it. If the phys-rep breaks any power left in that pot is lost for the remainder of adventure. They may not join a political or social guild, lose one level of resistance and may only attack in self-defence (not purest)

Clan Carnesir

Unusually for the local clans, these are mostly fire elves and half fire elves. The clan is famed for its skill at cooking, especially fiery food. They own The Crackling Hearth Inn, to which people travel from miles around for its famed cooking. Their fiery natures infect all they do – they are quick tempered and often get into heated arguments that flare up quickly, but equally are quick to warm to new friends (or to fall passionately in love) Lovers of all things that explode, the clan have a sideline in the manufacture of fireworks and caches.

*Must be fire elf or half fire elf. They are well equipped with 8 lembas per day and this lembas is so fine it cures half elves 3/1 each and fire elves 3/3 each. Such lembas is adventure temporary, and no cards are issued. Such increase does not apply to standard fire elf lembas made. They gain well equipped with 1*cache and 1*blinding cache. The clan replaces their political guild slot*

Clan Dalziel

A deeply religious clan, these are stern followers of Lazar. Less friendly than most of that faith, they preach that happiness is a sin to be avoided. Pleasures of the flesh are to be scorned, including alcohol. They hate all forms of corruption and are deeply suspicious of all nobles.

Local Gods & Cults

The Dales are home to a few small faiths that are unknown outside the area. In other places these are the sort of religions that make up the Independent Guild. However, here, even though their number of worshippers are tiny compared to churches that span Labyrinthia, the churches seem to have enough spiritual power from their shrines and holy places to support a full selection of miracles for their priests.
Some of the more prominent ones are listed here, but there are many others hidden away

Sorcha

Sorcha the Dark, Lady of War, Patron of Adventurers, Huntress of Beasts

A temple to Sorcha stands upon Harrowreve Field, the site of a great battle in the Choas Wars. It is said to have been founded in some of the victorious soldiers in gratitude for their patron's blessing.

Sorcha is a chaotic deity, a fickle goddess said to favour the brave and the bold. She teaches her followers to stand up for themselves, not to be overly bound by rules. She gives her followers access to dark powers but encourages them only to use them with good reason, not from spite or vindictiveness.

There's a lot of debate among her followers as to how she should be portrayed in religious imagery – as to whether she would have scars and heavy armour or be shown as the more alluring figure of some followers' imaginations. She is often pictured as having dark hair with a lighter streak.

Pre-requisites – must not have a self-defence restriction.

Ethos - Sorcha grants strength to those in need, but they need to stand up and use it. She has no time for bullies and little for rules.

Followers of Sorcha rarely marry – they say that anyone who expects them to turn down a better offer on the grounds of some words said in a temple ages ago clearly doesn't know them.

Sayings -
"No one can tell you what to do.", "Violence is always an option", "Fight your own battles", "Learn from conflict, struggle and grow", "Lift people up, don't drag them down.", "Be neither oppressor nor oppressed"

Miracle List (Chaotic Neutral)
1. Spirit Dart, Detect Spirit's Nature, Remove Rune of Power, Halt
2. Spirit of Seeing & Hearing
3. Spirit Shield, Protection from Spirits, Talk to Spirit
4. Spiritbolt, Create Ghoul, Communication, Control Ghoul
5. Spiritual Invisibility, Cause Grievous, Remove Voice of Power
6. Control Wraith
7. Pure Force

Denominational Miracle: Slayer's Inquiry

Verbal – "Lady of struggle, How do I defeat that?"

Sphere – Universal Cost – 3 spirits
Description: Must be cast after at least 30 seconds fighting a target (or assisting in fighting e.g. healing other combatants etc) Gains a major prayer about the target – how to harm/slay or otherwise defeat the target, and/or the impact and consequences of doing so. This is an informational miracle.

Currently a priest of Sorcha must battle-board the Faith as their professional guild to use the miracle list. They may purchase/learn their denominational miracle as normal.

Lazar
Renewal, redemption & rebirth, transformation and metamorphosis

Lazar teaches his followers to strive to be better people . That no matter what you have done in the past, you can always seek to renew yourself and redeem past failures.

The sect were pacifist in the past but now many are weapon using priests and are no longer restricted – they say they have had to learn to defend themselves because over frequent renewal was setting them too far back on the path.

For them, self-improvement is a mandate and great transformations (in game terms - such as multiracing or rebirth) are acts sacred to Lazar. They actively talk to the faithful about the importance of preparing for your next life, and how the right actions in this life will be tangibly rewarded in the next.
In the past there have been controversies where they have accepted someone into number as a redeemed sinner but the past victims of that person still seek revenge or justice

Miracle List (Chaotic good)
1. Cure wound, Detect Spirit's Nature, Dismiss Zombie
2. Cure Serious Wounds
3. Cure Disease, Talk to Spirit, Bless, Protection From Spirits, Cure Poison, Cure Insanity, Befriend Spirit
4. Heal, Wound Staunch, Control Ghoul
5. Remove Fear & Paralysis, Dismiss Wraith
6. Total Heal, Spiritual Freedom
7. –
8. Restore Life

Denominational Miracle: Rite of Renewal

Verbal – "20+ appropriate words"

Sphere – Universal Cost – 6 spirits
Description: Must be cast with at least 5 minutes ritual preparation in the manner of a restore life. It can only be cast on a dead being, and may only be cast on dungeon and within one hour of the targets death. It may be cast to achieve one of two effects and the caster must choose which they desire at time of casting. They may alter the verbal slightly to indicate which.
Caster chooses one of –
If willing, the target's alignment changes to neutral or good. Immunity to alignment change prevents this. If willing they may then also change their resurrection name.
Alternatively, the subject gains rebirth, even if not previously owned or a peon. If the target already owns standard rebirth, then such is upgraded to 'enhanced rebirth'.

Currently a priest of Lazar must battle-board the Faith as their professional guild to use the miracle list. They may purchase/learn their denominational miracle as normal.

Helak, the Herald of the Sun

Ethos – Bring light and warmth into the lives of all around

Helak is an easy to follow deity. He asks his followers to be kind, to protect the weak and help those in need. He does not ask his followers to eschew violence nor to crusade relentlessly against evil. They aren't completely opposed to all undead, but will happily fight those that are causing harm or making trouble. They tend to err on the side of seeing those undead that cannot enter daylight as a mark of real evil however.

They do have an annoying habit of being morning people & lecturing those slow to rise about how they are missing out on the day. Some can be annoyingly cheerful in their disposition.

Unsurprisingly some of their more powerful priests tread the path of holiness to study light and/or gold magic.

Symbol – An eagle flying in front of the sun, or a golden eagle.

Miracle List (Lawful Good)
1. Cure Wound, Spiritual Candles
2. Cure Serious Wounds
3. Cure Disease, Warming Touch, Protection from Spirits, Talk to Spirit, Dismiss Ghoul, Spirit Shield, Bless
4. Heal, Spirit bolt, Communication
5. Spiritual Invisibility
6. Total Heal, Dismiss Vampire, Light of Faith
7. –
8. Restore Life

Denominational Miracle: Sun's Blessing

Verbal – "Gentle Helak, let your wondrous power flow through us. Through your warmth and kindness may we be restored as we rest here"

Sphere – Universal Cost – 6 spirits Duration – 15 minutes Range - Touch
Description: May only be cast outdoors in daylight. Creates a calm meditational state within the target. If, upon casting this miracle, the target meditates for fifteen minutes (must be sitting down with their eyes closed and not using aware/greater aware med or similar), they gain the benefit of an hour's meditation but may not then gain any power for the next three hours. This miracle may be cast on self.

Currently a priest of Helak must battle-board the Faith as their professional guild to use the miracle list. They may purchase/learn their denominational miracle as normal.

Other Groups and Places

The Halflings of Sweeteberry

Many halflings live in the village of Sweeteberry and they are very popular with all around. They make and sell excellent food and high-quality beer, as well as tanis weed (and other herbal crops). They've also made a niche for themselves as problem-solvers locally. They've dug into all the tedious folk lore and are prepared to dress up as Morris dancers and prance around or whatever stupid thing is needed to drive off the hated twilight fae or protect the herds from scrote-bollock or willitbuggle and other such afflictions as plague the rural heartlands. They are quite adept at catching irritating thieving goblins and recovering stolen goods too.

As standard Halflings, including normal height restrictions. They gain the benefits of local lad tendency for free even if not a scout – and such is for the village of Sweeteberry and its immediate surrounding areas. They suffer -1 level of resistance to all effects due to over-indulgence in recreational substances, and are limited to basic tier of political guilds due to their commitments to the village.

The Twilight Fae

A perpetual bane upon the locals – some of the local faeries are masters of stealth and able to enter homes invisibly. Some unlucky people seem plagued by them and suffer no end of mischief, accidents and troubles at their hands. They can be quite vindictive creatures and have caused several deaths. The Baron's factor used to offer a bounty on them, but had to give up because no one could actually prove they'd killed one. They are not appropriate PCs at this time. The local peons have a great hatred of fae.

The Faeless Fair

Once per month, the village of Quarringheath holds a grand market day.

It is named in commemoration of the time the local clans grew especially tired of having the local faeries turn up on their doorstep wanting to play silly games and hired some mercenaries to seek out cold iron weapons and deal with them for good. Since then faeries have tended to stay out of sight.

The first market arose out of the mercenaries flogging off all the goods they looted from the dead fae, and since then the market has become known as the place to buy or sell unusual things.

While foodstuffs and mundane goods are sold, it specialises in the sale of more mystical goods. Alchemists and herbalists are common, Malloch pots and Weaver-mage parchments and cloths are sold. Often those who have been bold enough to venture into old ruins will sell whatever oddities they have dug up. Sometimes groups of would be archaeologists and tomb-robbers meet up here to plan an expedition into the wilder lands. It's known too as a place for adventurers to seek hire – the Baron's factor approves hires from local people under the authority of his hiring license. He assesses if those hired are competent for the job and not wanted by the law.

An unusual sport has grown up in that the local weaver mages often bring scarecrows to the fair and make them wrestle or fight, which is usually the subject of a lot of betting.

The Lekki Goblins

A cheerful tribe of goblins that the followers of Lazar claimed to have redeemed and are trying to rehabilitate by getting them to do useful jobs. They came to the area from the groups of goblins around Ickybiggle. They are grudgingly accepted in the area but often get blamed for anything going missing. Sometimes they forage the various old ruins and occasionally turn up something valuable to use or sell. Their skin colour is often blue or bluish green.

As standard goblins, may be goodly, may not be evil. If desired my claim the following benefits as their social guild. If so gains 20 ISP of adventure temp items (as per standard item rules, maximum of 12 ISP in any one item). These must be decided at the start of the day but can be spent on an item to be personalised

Ebonshade Goblins

More recent arrivals to the area, the Ebonshade goblins tend to pick on the Lekki goblins and push them about. The locals who can tell the difference view the Ebonshades as much more of a menace. The Ebonshades in turn get picked on by the hobgoblins.

They are playable but are standard goblins as per the published rules. They may not be goodly.

Mages of Dunchcliffe Tower

The magus Taskel came to the Dales to pick through the ruins. He soon decided it was safer to delegate the dangerous activities and offered to train as apprentices any who were prepared to do the task of routing around in grubby and dangerous ruins for him. He's taught his students much about how to get some use out of old and drained artefacts and to distinguish treasure from trash. Of late the apprentices have had some success building golems out of old scrap and matching these against the weaver mages scarecrows at the Fair. Other wizards however tend to look down on them as grubby pikeys.

Students of Taskel can be any labyrinthean race whose class is in the wizard bracket. They may not join a professional guild and lose one casting level. They may never aqyuire 'apprentice bonding'. They gain evaluate & enhanced evaluate as per tomb robber. They may buy rec spirit, ep & neuronics as per scout at +25% cost. 2/day they may recharge a handbook magical innate in an item - this takes 1 minute and costs half the mana it would take to cast the relevant spell.

Gallowsmarsh

Many herbs growth thick in Gallowsmarsh, making it popular with potion makers, but travelling here is dangerous – the few humans who live here are skilled at hiding and ambushes and have little concern for the Baron's law or the wellbeing of travellers. If they were not enough, dangerous large insects infest the place and deeper in are said to be a tribe of man eating frog people.

The Eternal Earth

Rumoured to be based somewhere in the wild hills is a small druidic sect. They preach very odd beliefs concerning judging the dead – that the worthy should be preserved in stone in eternal commemoration of their glory and that they unworthy should rot away where they can feed the land. Some of the poorer locals accept their services as undertakers.

While many look on them as a bit weird, they are grudgingly tolerated for some recent helpful deeds – particularly their work in the spring of IM 1011 – there was a bad plague in the Dales and the members of the sect cleared away disease ridden bodies no one else wanted to risk touching & their assistance in IM 1013 in fighting off a hobgoblin raiding party that badly threatened the outlying village of Dwelme.

Members of the sect may be of any EP wielding class. They gain the evocation petrification added to their list without needing pre-requisites. It counts as part of their base list for buying innates only. They gain familiar – snakes & serpents as per tables. They may not be a member of any social guild.

Harrowreve Field

The site of several major battles in the past, Harrowreve Field lies across the main route into the Dales from the Northwest (i.e. from the direction of Halgar). It covers a wide area, being the neck of the valley. The fords over the river here have been the scene of particularly fierce fighting many times. Not surprisingly the area is said to be haunted and travellers avoid it at night. A chapel to the local goddess Sorcha is nearby and sometimes serves as a refuge for travellers who find themselves still in the area at nightfall.

Wraithtree

The Hamlet of Wraithtree sits about a rise in the Bildteve Fens. Its closest main village is that of Ghulston. It lies beneath an ancient mound, said to have been built by the Tribes to honour one of their dead kings, upon this mound grows a single mighty and ancient tree, the like of which has not been seen anywhere else in the Empire, even those Druids who have examined it are unable to classify its type, saying it is unique. It never flowers but has long been revered by the people of the Hamlet from which they take its name, as being the guardian to the underworld of the Wraithking. Over many centuries local lore has lead the people to make little blood offerings within the hollow beneath its roots and to decorate the tree with grisly remains to appease the Wraithking and keep him silent in his slumber beneath them.

Early in IM 1011, having been warned by the Coven of Mourne, that the followers of Lichmourne were gathering at the Wraithtree the Church of Iron and Empire paid a visit to the village and the tree that gave it its name in order to uncover what the Lichmourne were doing.

They discovered that the peons had come under the mystic sway of Lichmourne, although to be fair, even when released from this sway their attitudes did not change much. The people, not uncommon in the vastness of the unexplored wilds of Primus, had never encountered representatives, or even heard of The Empire, in fact even the name Kesselharn was just a word to them. Nadriel quickly had the Church set about to "conquer" the village in the name of the Empire and bring it, if not directly under the control of the Liches of Bildteve, in the name of the Empress, and Wraithree is now very much considered a part of Nadriel's personal demesne and an extension of the village of Ghulston, although not all the Peons might see this as such.

It is said that the Church entered the Mound of Wraithtree on a total of four occasions, what truly happened within is known only to the Church but rumours abound of an alliance with long dead tribal champion now known simply as The Wraithking.

Wraithkin Peons: These peons are not without oddness, as is the nature of things they are touched by the undead, perhaps from blood heritage or simply just as a result of living where they are but they have some unusual racial abilities.

Race: As per Human or Peon in all respects except as below:

Alignment: May only be Evil

Life Scale: As per Human but at all times is calculated as one level lower due to their sickly life and unwholesome dwelling place.

Class: They can be any class available to a human except if a Spirit User may only belong to the Church of Iron and Empire and thus may not be any of the Hermit Priest Classes (e.g. Witch) unless they are aligned to the Church of Iron and Empire, which they may freely do.

Special:
1st Level: Immunity to Level Drain
6th Level: Wraithshield, 1/Day may, in a warcry style, shrug off a single weapon blow or a single effect that a Wraith would be immune to. On use they shimmer ever slow slightly becoming etheric for but an instant and the entirety of their eyes turning black.

NOTE: Hermit Subclasses may elect to be played as full members of the Church of Iron and Empire and must use their miracle list.

World of Teblor

The world of Teblor was the setting for a myths reffed in 2010 by Carlo and Paul Lilley – the world exists, linked to Primus by a portal created by the Imperial seers, and referees may set adventures there, although they are advised to check with its creators for more background. Many of the citizens have since emigrated to the Empire.

Overview

The world of Teblor is in many ways reminiscent of pre-settlement North America with a good combination of rolling plains, deep forests and ranging mountains. The mountainous lands provide reasonable pasture for flocks of sheep and goats and the flatlands are fertile enough to produce rich harvests of wheat and other crops. The world also has a great wealth of natural resources such are thick mineral deposits and forests of Ironwood trees.

The people of Teblor are, again similar to the Native Americans of the 19th Century but in appearance more like the Germanic Tribes of North-eastern Europe during the Dark Ages. They are divided into Tribes or Clans (but these can comprise and large number of people) and for the most part are territorial although there are a small number of nomadic tribes (although these are treated with a degree of distrust as it is felt that one cannot maintain a link with ones Ancestors if one is constantly on the move). An old Teblorian saying claims that tradition is cut from the stone of the world and will endure just as long. Perhaps as a result, the traditional practice of raiding and thieving from neighbouring clan's herds continues (although in a more ritualised and less lethal fashion than in bygone years) – symbolic of the peoples' strong links to their past. Physiologically the People of Teblor are much like humans but a much hardier, never reaching the level of comfortable living enjoyed by many citizens of the Empire

Religion

The religion of Teblor is broadly based around Ancestor worship but also the veneration of animal spirits – When one reaches adulthood one embarks upon a ritualised Spirit Quest to discover and forge a link with ones Spirit Guide ~ much like a Guardian Spirit which will accompany one through their life's journey.

Note – a separate in character document giving great detail on these beliefs and each of the spirit guides in particular should be available as a download from the Labyrinthe forum

Culture

Simple rural lifestyles typified by a high level of craft skills. Most tribes tend to have a craft speciality and then engage in trade with other tribes. Hospitality is considered of great importance and it is always considered the responsibility of the most senior tribesman present to provide food and shelter for any guest.

History

Much of Teblor's ancient history is marred by inter-tribal disputes and bloodshed ~ wars were an ongoing part of life and the tribes suffered as a result. However, since The Great Peace was enacted over a hundred years ago these conflicts have been reduced to symbolic ritualised 'raids' which have taken upon a festival-like quality. That was until approximately ten years ago.

Recent History (the last ten years)

In a series of unexpected and bloodthirsty moves a young tribal chieftain named Etterin of the Timber Wolf Tribe began subjugating the tribes of southern Teblor; naming himself 'High Chieftain' in the process. None could stand against him in battle as his skill with his war spear seemed unparalleled, nor could they stand against the legion of dark nature spirits which seemed to answer his call – dark spirits that which resided in the

hidden corners of the world after being forced back there by the more civilised tribes (think Dark Forest here). In fact, Etterin had found a Nagrech Shard within the mountains and, sensing its power, had forged it into a weapon. He had also called forth the Baccarlor from its slumber to once again haunt the land (The Baccarlor isa figure from Teblorian folklore – literally translating to The Dead Beast – it was said to prey on those who had disconnected with their ancestors and had lost their way in the world).

Etterin however, was overthrown and slain by a group of strangers from another world called Labyrinthia and his minions were, once again banished back to the deep forests – These Labyrinthians had arrived in the lands of the Running Dog Tribe (a short distance to the South of the Timber Wolves' territory) and quickly moved to negate the threat that Etterin posed and in doing so earned the gratitude of the Teblorian tribes. It seemed that these strangers wished to stay and, considering their past deeds, were warmly welcomed and in many ways become guests of the Running Dog Tribe and their Chieftain, Incan (incidentally, it was Incan's ancestor who had negotiated The Great Peace which was a great matter of pride for the people of the tribe).

Led by the well-respected Chieftain, Incan, the Tribe made Coursan and his men more than welcome; helping them complete their barracks, providing a great deal of local knowledge and trading with them for provisions and supplies. In fact, such was the strength of the bond that was forged between Coursan and his troops and Incan and his tribe that in the early months of IM1006, under an Imperial Mandate the Running Dog Tribe was officially granted the title of 42nd Imperial Auxiliary Legion as well as Incan and his closest circle of advisors being empowered as Retainers of the House Coursan. In return, Coursan and his second in command Ebron Castellmaine were invited to take part in a Spirit Quest; a rite of passage of sorts, in order to symbolically join the Running Dog Tribe, which they did.

In the early months of IM1010 the Imperial Fort was assailed by forces unknown and Leo Coursan and fifteen loyal Imperial soldiers who were stationed there were slain. The Fort could not be found by the tribesmen and they were once again haunted at night by the Baccalor.

In the Sumner of the same year a band of loyal Imperial mercenaries led by Lord Aramis DeVille and Baroness Miranda Winterhaven travelled to Teblor and crushed the threat to Imperial concerns there, in the process laying the spirits of the dead to rest and forcing the Baccalor back into its slumber, in turn earning the gratitude of the Running Dog Tribe and renewing and strengthening their ties to the Empire. A stable means of travelling from Halgar to the World of Teblor was also established and by way of showing their thanks for the sacrifices made and to honour the fallen, a number of the Running Dog Tribe have travelled to the Empire to

Teblorians are as published humans with the following exceptions - They may be warriors, rangers, archers, pathfinders, hermit priests, pure priests, spirit warriors (who may choose a hermit miracle list), druids, forest guardians, ley walkers or wizards. They gain life as a human appropriate to their class. They may not currently join churches other than The Church of Dead Heroes or Glass or similar imperial church at GSM approval.

They may multi-class (using a multiclass slot) to primal soul predator or prey as appropriate to their totem spirit - this does not take their multirace slot, and instead of the normal makeup restriction they must wear tribal war paint. Should this option be taken, any future multirace must be approved by the GSM for appropriateness. They may not take their normal multirace until table 8 if published, table 10 if non-standard however.

Being more open to the spirit world however, they lose a level of resistance to spirits, and may never benefit from more than one resistance to Touch of Death. They may not acquire neuronics, nor may they ever acquire any permanent total immunity.

Members of the Running Dog tribe have enthusiastically embraced Imperial culture and may join most guilds freely. They may not join anti-imperial guilds, nor may they join guilds specifically for non-imperials (if in any doubt, please check with GSM). Should they become outlawed, they will hand themselves in at the earliest opportunity.

live and serve.

The Running Dog Tribe

Living on the rolling hills of southern Teblor the Running Dog Tribe are known for the size of their sheep-herds and the mineral wealth of their ancestral lands. The people of Teblor are a fairly hardy bunch with those of the Running Dog Tribe particularly able shepherds and miners. All adults are able to use a bow and spear or sword from a young age and all have a strong sense of the Cycle of Life – of being part of a greater whole and that all life is linked – Very spiritual barbarians. The Tribe itself is very proud of the fact that they have been made an auxiliary legion and feel a great loyalty to the Empire despite never having been there, for them it is a huge badge of honour.

Main NPCs of the Running Dog Tribe

Incan, Chieftain of the Running Dog Tribe

Grandson of Fettel, the Chieftain who brought about The Great Peace, Incan has maintained the family tradition of wise leadership of the Tribe. Although his ancestry is a matter of some pride he is very keen to be judged by his own deeds and be remembered in his own right.

He still feels some guilt that he was not able to do more to prevent the rise of Etterin and the subjugation of his tribe but realistically there was absolutely nothing he could do to prevent it. The arrival of Leo Coursan, Ebron Castellmaine and their men was seen by him as a gift from the tribe's ancestors – a reward perhaps for their loyal devotion to the veneration of their past generations.

Over the next ten years Incan, Leo and Ebron became firm friends; the Tribe really taking to and accepting these strangers into their lives. After approximately six years the Tribe were proud to be awarded the title of 42nd Auxiliary Legion which was seen as a great honour with Incan himself granted the title of Sire. Furthermore Incan and his closest circle of advisors were empowered as Retainers to House Coursan.

In a return gesture Coursan and Castellmaine were invited to partake of a Spirit Quest to formally become a part of the Running Dog Tribe which they did with Incan proudly officiating over the ceremony.

Incan was fascinated by stories of this great Empire and the Empress who sat on a throne of glass and many evenings would be spent in the company of Leo and Ebron just talking about every small detail of Labyrinthia.

Personality-wise Incan is a stern but generous and warm-hearted individual in a Brian Blessed style – You probably wouldn't want to upset him but you know he enjoys good ale and a man-hug like the best of them.

Grayle the Spiritwalker

The spiritual leader of the Running Dog tribe, the age of this woman is a matter of some debate as she seems to age incredibly slowly, claiming that her link with the spirit world keeps her youthful. Another of Incan's closest advisors she also spent much time with the Imperial Troops, claiming that, spiritually they were much like children and had to be correctly educated in the Great Mystery of Life. She too will be hugely upset by their deaths and after some meditation upon the subject will tell the Party that the spirits of those slain are not are rest and are still suffering but cannot tell where or how (which should, hopefully lead them to the section in which they can release the shackled spirits of the Imperial Troops and Leo Coursan). She will lead those willing to partake in the Spirit Quests.

Ramen

One of Incan's most trusted advisors and confidantes, Ramen has a huge wealth of experience and knowledge

when it comes to the natural world – In modern terms he would be described as a Geologist and Prospector but his link with the raw materials of the Teblor mountains is far more spiritual than that. He spent much of his time helping the Imperial Troops with building their fort and formed a close bond with many of the men and will be greatly upset by their demise. A great teacher he had spent many years with the troops, opening their eyes, in a spiritual sense, to the world around them; showing them which stones and minerals could be found where and what they could be used for. In addition, he has had some success forming bonds of friendship with the Olasan people (despite their natural suspicion of males) through the instruction of where to find the best Ironwood trees which the Olasans have proved so skilled in crafting.

The Olasans

Refugees already transported from the now destroyed world of Olaso to settle on Teblor, many of the Olasans have since migrated again to move into the Empire itself.

Overview

The world of Olaso was in many ways reminiscent of the Egyptian Empire during its Golden Age, mostly comprising lush and verdant river valleys with well-developed irrigation systems producing bountiful harvests. Settlements were scattered and, bar the Imperial Capital, relatively small in size (comparable to an Imperial Town at the most – to have more than a few hundred living in one place was rare) with a single Matriarch acting as a steward for the settlement. Each trimester there is a gathering of these Matriarchs within the Imperial Capital where overall concerns were aired and discussed over a period of a week.

The Olasan men folk are no different in appearance to that of Labyrinthian Humans, the women; however, have strong feline characteristics. This feline aspect is considered a wondrous thing and the stronger the trait the nobler the bloodline as the Olasans believe that the First Empress was, herself a great lioness that took on the aspect of a woman. Whilst the society is certainly matriarchal, the men are not considered second class citizens but it is a man's place to prove his strength and virtue to earn the betrothal of a female, especially one of noble lineage. This is why the Olasan women tend to bestow their favour open the most capable of the men, oft ignoring pure aesthetics for what may be offered in other ways, be it skill at arms or intellect or craft. As a result, the Olasan calendar was full of regular tourneys and competitions for anything from art to archery to architecture.

Religion

Olasan faith, much like most of their society is matriarchal. Before the arrival of the World Eater they worshipped the Divine Empress but since the destruction of their world their prayers have gone unanswered which was obviously of grave concern to the Olasans. Perhaps this is why the concept of the Goddess Empress appealed to them so much when Coursan and Castellmaine spoke to them about it. Certainly for the Matriarch, who was at one time a priestess of the Olasan Empress (as many Olasan noblewomen are during their adolescence), the appeal of the Empress Goddess Truic Badrass Amora was great. And in a spiritual sense she saw this as a logical progression for her people and so, in a slightly different way to the people of Teblor, they were keen to learn all they could of her and the Cathedral to her in the central square of Halgar (in fact, Castellmaine had promised to take Nyalla to visit it at some point)

Culture

Strongly matriarchal society (but far less drastic than Drowe Society for example) with a preference for luxury and opulence amongst the wealthy ruling classes. These ruling classes consist of the small number of nobility as well as scholars and academics (who are highly regarded), however, the gulf between the rich and poor is small with even the ruling classes expected to have a trade skill and very little in the way of tithes paid to them. Given their fondness for ornamentation and beautification it is unsurprising that many of their skills fall into the fields of art and jewellery making.

History

The Olasan are not great ones for keeping histories or written records, much preferring works of art such as

murals, sculptors and monuments to capture images of the past and to remind future generations. As such their world was scattered with such and every house was decorated within with bright paintings and painted screens.

In IM1004 the skies above the world of Olaso darkened to a deep crimson which cast its bloody hue over all the land; crops failed, livestock died and many saw this as the end of their world. In short, it was; by IM1006 what was left of Olaso was consumed by the entity known as the World Eater. All bar one small village. Somehow this village was spared although beyond its borders was nothing but a vast emptiness and, although they had been saved from one fate it seemed that they were merely destined to fade away as their stores dwindled.

In IM1008 a strange man appeared in the village and spoke to the Nyalla, the Matriarch, explaining that he had a possible means of saving them although he wasn't entirely sure it would work. Weighing up the situation and considering the alternatives (of which there were basically none) she agreed and a ritual was performed. A great mist arose around the village followed by a bright piercing light from which all had to hide their gaze. When they were able to see again their village sat upon the low hills of a rolling valley and a sun blazed high in the sky once more.

The integration process was a little tricky considering that the people of Teblor were quite different from the Olasans (the matriarchal society being a bit stumbling-block) but with the strange man who had saved them who went by the name Leo of the House of Coursan, these issues seemed to be smoothed over and the relationships flourished. The world of Teblor having a great wealth of resources such as Ironwood which the Olasans of the village (which was famed for their skill with wood-carving) were able to work into trade goods which were particularly popular amongst the local tribes.

The Olasans did not suffer from the initial assaults which had slain the Imperial soldiers but were later assailed by forces unknown until they were aided by the Imperial Mercenaries who came to their rescue in the Sumner of IM1010. So well did relations develop between the Olasan peoples and the travelling mercenaries that Lord Aramis DeVille asked for the hand of the Matriarch's sister, Maya, in marriage, to which she accepted. Unsurprisingly links between the Empire and the Olasan people has continued to strengthen and with the secure link between the two worlds a number of Olasans have chosen to travel to the Empire.

Olasans are as published humans with the following changes:

They may be any published human class. Priests are restricted on the churches they may join to The Church of Dead Heroes, Glass or similar imperial church at GSM approval. Must have cat-like make-up, and must wear excellent & impressive costume. Base life is calculated as 1 level lower than a human of the same class.
They gain +1 DAC at level 6. As enthusiastic (and well connected) new members of the Empire they are fully able to join guilds. They may not join anti-imperial guilds, nor may they join guilds specifically for non-